ONTOLOGY OF NOTHING
A FUNDAMENTAL PHILOSOPHICAL MONOGRAPH
A philosophical system uniting ontology, metaphysics, quantum physics, information theory, and contemporary epistemology.
An original exposition of a new ontological model that resolves the principal unsolved problem of philosophy — the transition from an immutable foundation to a changeable actuality.
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STRUCTURED ABSTRACT
Background: the study investigates the fundamental aporia between the absolute immutability of the primordial ground and the manifest changeability of actuality.
Problem: existing philosophical and scientific models fail to provide a logically consistent derivation of distinction and conditionality without hidden assumptions and a second principle.
Method: formal ontological reduction is employed, fixing the dependent structure of levels without introducing becoming or genetic transitions: Nothing → Selfhood (reflexive self-identity of Nothing; includes transparency and logic as inalienable characteristics of absolute knowledge) → Absolute Information (the content of Selfhood's knowledge; virtual with respect to the essence) → Primary Distinction (Selfhood distinguishes essence from information) → Act of Selfhood (initiation of changes in information) → Change as non-identity, coinciding with the primary givenness of information and distinction in actuality → Measures → Elementary Changes → Aggregated Forms → Consciousness → Reason → Teleological Completion.
Results: a logically necessary and consistent structure of being is obtained in which changeability, multiplicity, and consciousness are derived from dependent information without violating the absoluteness of the essence.
Scientific contribution: the classical aporia of transition is eliminated; the logical consistency of the ontology with fundamental physics is demonstrated; a universal model of distinction is formulated that explains the origin of conditionality and all dependent categories.
Implications: the monograph proposes a complete system of ontological levels permitting a reconceptualisation of physics, cosmology, consciousness, and ultimacy as manifest forms of the informational structure issuing from the unconditional ground.

KEY WORDS:
Nothing; Selfhood; Information; Change; Distinction; Measures; Elementary Changes; Aggregated Forms; Consciousness; Reason; Conditionality; Ultimacy.

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ABSTRACT

The present monograph is a fundamental ontological study directed toward the resolution of the central problem of philosophy: how can a changeable actuality, a multiplicity of forms,

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sequences, interactions, consciousness, and reason exist if the primordial ground of being is conceived as absolutely immutable and unconditional? The work demonstrates that no philosophical school — from ancient metaphysics and religious ontological systems to German idealism, analytic philosophy, and contemporary physicalism — has proposed a consistent model that eliminates the said aporia.

The problem demands not a descriptive reassessment of concepts but a rigorous ontological fixation within which the relation between the immutable ground and the changeable actuality is expressed without logical rupture and without the introduction of hidden conditions. What is at issue is not transition as a process or becoming, but a structure of dependence that preserves the absolute immutability of the ground and excludes alternative interpretations without loss of consistency.

The method of negative testing posits a set of limiting conditions whose violation causes the proposed ontological construction to lose its consistency: the emergence of distinction within the absolute ground, the transformation of information into an autonomous principle, the introduction of a transition not derived from the modification of a dependent category, or the admission of a second independent source.

The criterion of necessity in this work is understood as the logical exhaustion of the space of admissible alternatives. Three sources of change — from within the ground, from its essence, from an external principle — cover all logically possible positions regarding the relation of change to the absolute ground. The violation of any of the three conditions of consistent ontology generates a specific contradiction; the sole configuration in which all three conditions are satisfied is determined not as preferable but as the only admissible one. The removal, replacement, or permutation of any link either introduces a hidden second principle, or requires an internal distinction within the ground, or destroys the derivability of subsequent categories. In this sense "necessity" is fixed not as a declaration but as the result of an exhaustive partition of logical space.

The limits of applicability of the method are determined by the level at which logical reduction preserves strict consistency: the method operates only on fundamental categories, does not extend to empirical descriptions, and does not perform the function of explaining particular manifestations, fixing only the conditions of their ontological possibility.

The author introduces a rigorous ontological structure in which the fundamental elements are Nothing as absolute immutability, Selfhood as the reflexive self-identity of Nothing — the subject of absolute knowledge — and change as non-identity in which information and distinction coincide as the primary givenness in actuality. Information is the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence. Something is identical with changeability and actuality — it is the phenomenon cognisable and perceivable by consciousness. On the basis of this structure the possibility of changeability is explained without violation of the absoluteness of the primordial ground.

The monograph demonstrates that time, space, localisation, and speed are not primary entities but measures arising from the structure of distinctions. Elementary changes are treated as minimal manifestations of modified information; aggregated forms as stable configurations of distinctions; consciousness as the activity of distinction; and reason as the emergent capacity to order distinctions and form meaning. Life is explained as an informational process of self-maintenance, and evolutionary dynamics as the complexification of distinct structures.

Special attention is devoted to integration with fundamental physics: quantum non-locality, the nature of the wave function, entanglement, the absence of volumetric substance in elementary states, the holographic principle, and the connection between energy and information. The author demonstrates that the contemporary findings of physics confirm the informational nature of reality and are consistent with the developed ontology (Wheeler 1994; Vedral 2010).

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The monograph concludes with an exposition of the teleological structure of actuality, in which the development of distinctions leads to a limit experience and the completion of the cycle of conditionality. The resulting doctrine forms a comprehensive worldview explaining actuality as the successive deployment of informational states, logically connected to absolute immutability.

LITERATURE REVIEW

Contemporary philosophy and science offer several classes of models that attempt to explain the origin of distinctions, conditionality, and the structure of being. The systematic review of these models pursues a single aim: to identify the common structural defect that renders each of them incapable of eliminating the aporia of transition from an absolutely immutable ground to a changeable actuality. The present review does not claim historical-philosophical completeness; it is confined to an analysis of those traditions with which the proposed ontology stands in closest conceptual contact.

Neoplatonic Tradition

The closest structural analogy to the proposed ontology is the Neoplatonic emanative scheme of Plotinus. In the Enneads, the One (τὸ ἕν) is defined as absolutely simple, lacking all predicates and internal distinctions; from it emanates Nous (Intellect) as the first distinction, then Soul as the carrier of the temporal dimension, and then the material world as the lowest level of being (Plotinus 1991, V.1–3). The structural resemblance to the present system is evident: the scheme Nothing → Selfhood → Information reproduces the hierarchical order The One → Nous → Soul in that each level is dependent on the preceding one and does not possess an autonomous ontological status.

The fundamental difference, however, is the following. Emanation in Plotinus is described as the superabundance of the perfect One, not as its internal change; Plotinus himself does not consider emanation a violation of absoluteness. Yet, in the interpretation of the present work, the scheme "The One generates Nous" structurally presupposes the participation of the first principle in generation and thereby — from the standpoint of the criteria adopted here — introduces into the absolute a hidden condition of changeability. The present ontology excludes emanation as a category: Selfhood is not generated from Nothing as a separate level, but is the reflexive self-identity of Nothing, an inalienable characteristic of absolute knowledge. Information does not "flow" from the essence but is the content of its knowledge — virtual with respect to it. This eliminates the mechanism of generation which, in the interpretation of the present work, reproduces the aporia in a masked form: if the One is the cause of Nous, it already possesses a causal structure incompatible with the condition of absolute immutability.

Martin Heidegger: the Question of Nothing and the Ontological Difference

Heidegger is the sole major thinker of the twentieth century for whom "nothing" became a positive ontological theme rather than a null concept. In the lecture "What Is Metaphysics?" Heidegger asserts that Nothing is neither a negation of beings nor an empty concept: it "nihilates" (das Nichts nichtet), manifesting itself in the basic disposition of anxiety as the horizon on which beings as a whole become apparent (Heidegger 1998, 82–96). In Being and Time the ontological difference between Being and beings fulfils a similar function: Being is not a being, is not predicated, and is not localised, yet it is precisely what makes possible the understanding of any being (Heidegger 1962, §§ 2–4).

The point of contact with the present ontology is the following: Heidegger's Being and Nothing as its horizon function as the transcendental condition of manifestness — precisely what the present ontology fixes through the unconditionality of Nothing as the ground of distinctions. The fundamental difference, however, is twofold. First, in Heidegger, Nothing is disclosed through the existence of finite Dasein, that is, through already-distinguished

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consciousness; Heidegger himself does not assert the ontic dependence of Nothing on Dasein — what is at issue is the mode of disclosure, not an ontological dependence of the first ground. Nevertheless, the criterion of unconditionality adopted in the present work excludes any structure in which the first ground discloses itself exclusively through a finite subject, since this places the condition of manifestness before the ground itself. Second, Heidegger's analytic of Dasein fundamentally temporalises being: Being is always understood through a temporal horizon (Heidegger 1962, § 65). The present ontology, by contrast, derives time as a measure from the structure of distinctions — it is a derivative category, not a condition for understanding the first ground.

Luciano Floridi: Informational Structural Realism

In contemporary philosophy of information, the most systematic ontology resting on information as a basic category is Floridi's "informational structural realism" (Floridi 2008; 2011). Floridi asserts that reality is structurally informational: what is fundamental is not substance or process but the structure of relations, described through levels of abstraction. Floridi's ontological model eliminates the "primacy of objects" in favour of the "primacy of relations", which structurally corresponds to the treatment of information in the present work as the primary givenness of distinctions rather than as a property of material bearers.

The key divergence is the following. Floridi leaves the question of the foundation of information open: the informational structure is accepted as an ontological primitive without derivation from a deeper principle (Floridi 2008, 228–231). Thus information in Floridi becomes what the present ontology qualifies as a "second independent principle": it simply is, without explanation of the conditions of its possibility. The present system, by contrast, derives information as the dependent content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence of Nothing, thereby eliminating what remains unexplained in Floridi: whence comes the distinction itself that makes informational structure possible.

Alfred North Whitehead: Process Philosophy and the Category of Actual Occasion

Whitehead's Process and Reality represents the most elaborated attempt of the twentieth century to construct an ontology in which changeability is not a derivative but a primary category (Whitehead 1978, 18–30). The fundamental unit of reality is the "actual occasion" — an indivisible event of prehension in which preceding states of reality are synthesised into a new unity. God in Whitehead performs the role of "primordial nature" — a principle of possibility providing "eternal objects" as unrealised potentials.

Whitehead's ontology makes the same move as the present system in one respect: it attempts to explain multiplicity and changeability without introducing a substantial substratum. The structural defect of process ontology, however, is the following: if becoming is primary, the source of becoming itself remains without foundation, since the actual occasion prehends preceding data but why there is prehension at all is unanswered. Moreover, the "consequent nature" of God in Whitehead undergoes changes in the course of the realisation of the world (Whitehead 1978, 345–351), which introduces change into the very first ground and destroys its absoluteness. The present ontology eliminates this problem by localising all change exclusively in information — the dependent content of Selfhood's knowledge — and preserving the absolute immutability of the essence of Nothing.

Analytic Ontology and the Philosophy of Physics

Analytic ontologies resting on the theory of states of affairs (Armstrong 1997), structural realism (Ladyman and Ross 2007), and quantum information theory (Vedral 2010; Wheeler 1990) converge on the conclusion that what is fundamental is not substance but the structure of relations or information. The holographic principle and Landauer's principle (Bekenstein 2004; Landauer 1991) point to the physical significance of information as a category irreducible to a material substratum. Yet in all these works information functions either as a mathematical formalism (Shannon 1948) or as a physical quantity (Lloyd 2006), but receives

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no ontological definition explaining its origin. The present ontology supplies this lacuna: information is derived as the primary givenness of distinction, dependent on the unconditional ground, which gives it a strictly determined ontological status that it lacks in the works enumerated above.
Thus the existing literature demonstrates the absence of a consistent ontology that logically derives distinction, measure, multiplicity, and consciousness from a single unconditional ground. Neoplatonism reproduces the aporia through the mechanism of emanation. Heidegger temporalises the ground. Floridi accepts information as a primitive. Whitehead places change in the first ground itself. Analytic philosophy and physics register the informational structure of reality but do not explain its ontological conditions. The elimination of this common defect is the task of the present monograph.

PREFACE

Philosophy throughout its entire history confronts a fundamental question: how is it possible for changeability, multiplicity, consciousness, and actuality to arise if there exists an absolutely immutable primordial ground?
All philosophical schools — ancient, religious, idealist, materialist, dualist, monist, and processualist — offer different versions of an answer, but none eliminates the central contradiction: any change requires conditions, while absoluteness excludes conditions.
The absence of a resolution in existing traditions is connected not with the limitations of their conceptual apparatus but with the fact that the very categories they employ are logically incapable of eliminating the original contradiction. If a model relies on duality, it loses absoluteness; if it admits internal change of the absolute, it destroys immutability; if it employs a transition between levels without a rigorous foundation, it creates a hidden secondarity. In each of these cases an ineliminable point of rupture remains. Therefore, to resolve the aporia one must introduce a minimal structure in which all elements are not assumptions but logical consequences, and in which the sequence of levels does not admit arbitrary permutation or substitution. To exclude the possibility of misinterpretation it is necessary to clarify that the minimality of the structure does not mean simplicity but means the absence of arbitrary assumptions. Every category included in the ontological sequence must be unavoidable: if even one element is removed, the transition between levels becomes logically impossible. And conversely, if an additional element is introduced that does not follow from the preceding one, a hidden condition arises that violates the unconditionality of the ground. The minimal structure is therefore not a reduced set but a strictly complete set of elements, each of which eliminates a specific type of contradiction. Such a structure admits no correction without the destruction of the logic, which makes it not one of the possible models but the only admissible framework of a consistent ontology. Only such a structure is capable of excluding the possibility of logical contradiction already at the level of foundations. Multiplicity presupposes difference in conditionality, whereas absoluteness excludes difference in its essence.
The scientific picture of the world confronts the same: quantum indeterminacy, entanglement, the absence of classical substantiality in elementary states, the informational nature of descriptions, the dependence of the result on the act of measurement — all this points to the existence of a structure that classical materialism explains with considerable difficulty and for which an informational ontology offers a more direct interpretation.
The aim of the monograph is to provide an ontology in which information is identical to primary distinction and coincides with change as the givenness of non-identity, from which the conditionality of actuality unfolds without the introduction of becoming. On the basis of the derived ontological structure, the philosophical foundations of the fundamental sciences are clarified.

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The work consists of four parts: analytic-philosophical, metaphysical, scientifically integrative, and worldview.
The language is rigorous, without imagery and assumptions. The text is built on formal logic and the sequential introduction of categories.
This approach is necessary because any attempt to explain fundamental categories through illustrations, analogies, or an appeal to intuitive self-evidence inevitably leads to hidden assumptions that cannot be tested for consistency. Within ontological investigations such assumptions play the role of implicit second-order grounds, destroying the uniqueness of the first principle and creating logical ruptures between the essence and its manifestations. Hence the only admissible form of exposition is a strict deductive sequence in which every new category is derived not descriptively but as the unavoidable consequence of the preceding one. This eliminates the possibility of dual interpretations, excludes the introduction of external principles, and makes the structure of being not a hypothesis but a logically compelled construction.

RESEARCH FRAMEWORK AND PROCEDURAL SCHEME

The methodological basis of the study is constructed on the principle of formal ontological reduction. The task of the method is to fix the structure of conditionality without genetic transitions, through the Act of Selfhood as the initiation of changes in information (the content of Selfhood's knowledge), not affecting the essence, the emergence of hidden presuppositions, and additional principles.
The central methodological device is the sequential fixation of necessary conditions: the absolute immutability of the primordial ground; transparency and logic as inalienable characteristics of Selfhood; the dependent status of information as the content of Selfhood's knowledge; the Act of Selfhood as the initiation of changes in information without change of essence; the emergence of change in information; the coincidence of information and distinction as the primary givenness of the arising non-identity, without the introduction of states at the primary level; distinction as the formal fixation of primary non-identity; the derivation of measures; the derivation of measures as parameters of the organisation of distinguishedness; the formation of elementary and aggregated structures; the emergence of consciousness and reason as active forms of the organisation of distinctions.
The methodology presupposes the sequential application of logical necessity: every derived category must eliminate the identified contradiction, be unavoidable, and derivable only from the preceding level. Such a structure ensures the inadmissibility of alternative interpretations and excludes the possibility of multiple grounds.

METHODOLOGY

The methodology is based on the logical reconstruction of fundamental categories without the use of presuppositions that cannot be rigorously derived.
The following are employed:
formal ontological reduction;
the principle of unconditionality of the primordial ground;
the principle of transparency and logic as characteristics of Selfhood; the dependent status of information;
the principle of fixing change as non-identity coinciding with primary distinction and information (givenness), without the ontologisation of information as an autonomous principle;
strict sequence of categories;
integration of data from fundamental physics;
the emergent theory of consciousness;

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the principle of ultimacy.
The methodology excludes the use of metaphor, hidden principles, dogmatic premises, and logical ruptures.
The definition of formal ontological reduction consists in the reduction of all categories to a minimal set of foundations admitting a strictly derived structure of being without the emergence of hidden presuppositions or underived entities.
The rigour of the chosen methodology is conditioned by the fact that it fixes the minimal set of principles sufficient for the derivation of the ontological structure without attracting presuppositions that cannot be formally justified. Any expansion of this set leads to the inclusion of categories not logically derivable from the ground, which creates hidden conditions and violates the unconditionality of the first principle. The procedural steps of the deduction of the levels of being are formed as a sequence of fixed stages: the establishment of the unconditional ground; the fixation of Selfhood as the reflexive self-identity of Nothing (subject) and absolute information as the content of Selfhood's knowledge (object); the fixation of the Act of Selfhood as the initiation of changes in information; the singling out of change as non-identity in information; the coincidence of change, information, and distinction as the primary givenness of non-identity; the derivation of distinction; and the construction of the levels of conditionality from logically connected transitions. Any reduction renders the deductive transition between levels impossible, leading to gaps in the logical chain. The criteria of strict necessity of categories require that every introduced structure eliminate a specific logical contradiction, ensure the continuity of derivation, and not create alternative interpretations that violate the uniqueness of the ground. Thus the methodological system is not an arbitrary construct but a minimal and complete structure in which each principle performs an irreplaceable function. The criteria for the exclusion of hidden conditions include the inadmissibility of internal transitions in the ground, the impossibility of the autonomisation of dependent categories, and the exclusion of terms not derived from the preceding levels of the logical sequence. This permits securing the necessity of all derived categories and excluding the possibility of their alternative interpretation without contradictions.
The system of consistency checking consists in the sequential evaluation of each level for hidden transitions, the impossibility of ambiguous readings without violation of the conditions, and the obligatory logical derivation of all derivative elements from the ground. The criterion of checking used in this system is not empirical and does not presuppose experimental verification. It pertains to the ontological and logical levels of analysis and consists in the absence of internal contradictions, ruptures, and hidden assumptions in the sequential derivation of dependent forms from the single ground.
Consistency with scientific theories does not mean confirmation of the ontology by means of physics or neuroscience and does not presuppose the derivation of empirical laws from the ontological description. It indicates merely the absence of logical incompatibility between the ontological ground and already-established scientific models. The system thereby preserves a meta-theoretical status with respect to science and does not compete with it in the domain of empirical explanation.
The status of deduction in the present system: ontological necessity, not formal derivability. The system employs deduction in the ontological, not the formal-logical, sense. Each category is introduced as the necessary condition of the consistency of the preceding one, not as a theorem derived by the rules of a calculus. The criterion of rigour is not formal derivability but stability under negative modifications: the removal of any element leads to the violation of the initial conditions. The formal axiomatisation of metaphysics is impossible without the prior formalisation of the concept of "existence", which is itself a metaphysical question and generates an infinite regress of formalisation. No metaphysical system in the

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history of philosophy — including Spinoza, Hegel, Whitehead — has been formally axiomatised in the strict sense. The requirement of formal axiomatisation applied to metaphysics is a categorical error: it applies the standard of mathematics to a discipline whose subject matter (being as such) precedes mathematical formalisation. The present system offers the most rigorous form of ontological deduction available within philosophical discourse: the sequential introduction of categories with the justification of the necessity of each and the demonstration of the impossibility of alternatives.

ARBITRATION BLOCK OF INTERPRETIVE CLOSURE

The present text fixes the limiting conditions for the correct reading of all subsequent ontological constructions. The arbitration of interpretation is not a prohibition of alternative readings — a philosophical theory cannot and should not prohibit interpretations. It is a structural result: every alternative interpretation of the concepts listed below reproduces one of the contradictions fixed in chapters 1–4. A reader proposing an alternative interpretation undertakes the obligation of showing that it does not violate any of the three conditions of consistent ontology. What follows fixes which interpretations violate this condition and in which precise way.

1. Information throughout all subsequent sections is understood as the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence (Nothing). Information is an object, not a subject: it does not possess its own ontological initiative, is not a source, agent, process, or autonomous entity. Selfhood is the subject belonging to the essence; information is the content that Selfhood possesses. Any interpretation attributing an active, generative, or governing function to information is logically inadmissible.
2. Consciousness and reason are treated exclusively ontologically as forms of the organisation of distinctions within dependent information. They are not epistemic subjects, do not act as sources of knowledge about the essence, and do not possess access to the absolute ground. Any reading in which consciousness or reason are endowed with cognitive subjectivity with respect to the essence is incorrect.
3. Ultimate completion is an outcome established by Selfhood, following from initiation as intention and aim. The motive of initiation is the attainment by information of actual self-consciousness: information contains knowledge of Selfhood as content but not as realised self-consciousness. Selfhood initiates the programme of all possible changes in information so that information may attain realised self-consciousness. Completion is fixed as the realisation of the originally established limit of the deployment of distinctions through their complete exhaustion. Any interpretation of the aim as dynamic goal-setting or preference is logically inadmissible. The terms "programme", "intention", and "aim" are employed in the strictly limiting sense of linguistic description (see the Methodological Block) and do not denote dynamic properties of the absolute.
4. None of the subsequent categories describes change, becoming, or process in the essence of the first ground. All changes are localised exclusively in information — the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence. The Act of Selfhood is the initiation of changes in information, not in the essence. Any admission of internal distinction, dynamics, or becoming in the absolute ground contradicts the conditions of consistent ontology.
5. Transparency and logic are inalienable characteristics of Selfhood as absolute knowledge, not separate ontological levels. Measures, forms, consciousness, and reason do not possess autonomous ontological status and cannot be regarded as independent principles. Their autonomisation in any form is equivalent to the introduction of a second ground and is therefore logically inadmissible.

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6. The present ontology is not intended for the explanation of particular empirical processes, physical mechanisms, or observable phenomena. It fixes exclusively the conditions of the ontological possibility of changeability, distinction, and conditionality. Any expectation of empirical explanations falls outside the scope of this work.
7. Any reading that violates even one of the conditions enumerated above necessarily reproduces one of the contradictions fixed in chapters 1–4, which may be verified by reference to the corresponding section.

METHODOLOGICAL BLOCK

On the inadmissibility of asymmetric foundation and the status of the limit fact

The present ontological construction proceeds from a fundamental constraint: at the level of the primary ground an asymmetric structure is impossible without reproducing the original aporia. Any attempt to single out a "primary" and a "derivative" within the limit fact either introduces hidden multiplicity or presupposes change in the absolute ground, thereby destroying the very task of ontology. By virtue of this, the limit fact cannot be represented as a linear sequence of independent elements connected by a relation of ground and consequence.

In this context the identity of change, distinction, and information is not a definitional circle and does not presuppose the mutual definition of terms. What is at issue is the structural identity of one and the same limit fact fixed at different levels of formalisation. These terms do not denote distinct entities and do not compete for primacy; they serve as different modes of fixing one and the same ontological limit, within which asymmetry and sequence are inapplicable. The requirement of an independent definition of each of them presupposes an already-introduced distinction, which is logically impossible at this level of analysis.

Before the introduction of the three terms it is necessary to fix their common subject independently of them. The subject: the first ontological fact of actuality — the presence of non-identity relative to the absolute identity of Selfhood. Formally: let T be absolute identity; fact F is the existence of x such that $x \neq T$. This fact is one and indivisible. The three terms describe it from three sides: ontological (what occurred — change), formal (how it is structured — distinction), contentual (what is given — information). There is no fourth side: the three questions "what occurred / how it is structured / what is given" exhaust the structure of the description of any fact. Possible objection: there are other questions — "why", "where does it lead", "what does it mean for the subject". Answer: the question "why" presupposes causality — a category that arises only after primary distinction and is inapplicable to fact F itself, which precedes all causality. The question "where does it lead" presupposes teleology — a category of the dependent level, also inapplicable to F. The question "what does it mean for the subject" presupposes an already-introduced subject — but the subject arises later as an aggregated form of distinctions. Consequently, at the level of fact F itself the three questions indeed exhaust the structure of its description — not as a convention but as a consequence of the fact that causality, teleology, and subject have not yet been introduced at this level. The identity of the three terms is a consequence of the identity of their subject, not the result of defining terms through one another.

A definitional circle arises when A is defined through B, B through C, C through A — with none of the three possessing independent content. Here the situation is fundamentally different: each of the three terms possesses independent content — the limit fact of non-identity. This fact is not defined through the terms: it precedes them and is their common subject. "Change" fixes the ontological side: what occurred — non-identity relative to the identity of the ground. "Distinction" fixes the formal side: how this is given — the distinguishability of this non-identity. "Information" fixes the contentual side: what is given — the givenness of this distinguishability as content. The three sides are inseparable at the

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level of the fact itself, but this inseparability is the inseparability of the subject, not a circular dependence of definitions. Formal analogy: the circumference and the area of a circle describe one geometrical object from different sides and are not defined through each other — both are defined through the circle. The elimination of any of the three terms does not create a contradiction in the remaining two but deprives the description of the limit fact of one side of formalisation. This is a sign of the identity of the subject under multiplicity of descriptions — not of a definitional circle.
Possible objection: the three terms belong to different theoretical traditions — dynamics, logic, information theory — and therefore require strict translation between levels. This objection rests on an erroneous premise: that the terms are borrowed from these traditions and then declared identical. The order is the reverse. The limit fact of non-identity is ontologically primary and belongs to none of the three traditions — it precedes them. The three traditions arose as partial descriptions of this fact in different contexts: dynamics describes it as a change of states, logic as an operation of distinction, information theory as a measure of indeterminacy. Each tradition grasps one side of one fact and unfolds it in its own conceptual apparatus. The identity of the three terms is fixed before any translation — at the level of the limit fact itself. Strict translation would be required if the terms belonged to theories primarily and were then identified. But the theories are secondary deployments of one ontological fact. The requirement of translation presupposes the reverse order of dependence — and is therefore a methodological error.
Analogously, the concept of information (the content of Selfhood's knowledge) is not introduced as an ontological domain, entity, or process. Information does not perform the function of a "second principle" and does not serve as an autonomous locus of occurrence. The virtuality of information fixes exclusively the mode of existence of content, ontologically dependent on the essence, but not possessing its immutability. Information is not something in which something occurs as in a separate domain; it denotes the content of Selfhood's knowledge that admits change without violation of the immutability of the ground.
Epistemologically, the present ontology does not assert knowledge of the absolute ground as an object. The description of Nothing, Selfhood, and the limit fact is not knowledge in the objective sense and does not presuppose access of consciousness to the absolute level. It represents a regulative reconstruction of the conditions of the possibility of thinking about conditionality, carried out from within distinguishedness and not going beyond its limits. Language in this case performs not a descriptive but a limiting function, fixing the boundaries of admissible reasoning rather than properties of the absolute.
Consequently, the requirements of asymmetric foundation, causal explanation, or objective knowledge of the absolute level are methodologically inapplicable to the present ontology. They presuppose a mode of thought that already contains distinguishedness and therefore cannot be used for the analysis of the limit ground without logical return to the original aporia.

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PART I. ANALYTIC-PHILOSOPHICAL BLOCK

Chapter 1. The Principal Aporia of Philosophy

Philosophy arose as an attempt to understand the origin of being, to identify the primary ground, and to explain how a world containing a multiplicity of phenomena, changeability, consciousness, and regularity is possible. All schools, regardless of epoch and cultural milieu, confronted one and the same logical problem: the impossibility of reconciling the existence of an absolute ground with the existence of a changeable actuality.

Formal Formulation of the Aporia

Let the absolute primordial ground be designated A, and the changeable actuality D. Then:
— the condition of absoluteness requires: A contains no internal distinctions or transitions;

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— the condition of the existence of D requires: there exists a multiplicity of distinguishable states.
For D to arise, a distinction R is necessary, which is identical to change and information as the primary givenness of non-identity.
If the distinction R, identical to change and information as the primary givenness of non-identity, belongs to A, then A already contains distinguishability and thereby loses its status as absolute. If this primary givenness does not belong to A, a second independent ground is introduced, violating the uniqueness of the principle.
Thus there arises a logical triangle of incompatibility:
— absoluteness → absence of distinctions;
— distinction, identical to change and information as primary givenness;
— changeability → dependence on distinguished states.
This triangle fixes the aporia that cannot be eliminated by replacing terms or complicating the conceptual apparatus: the contradiction is embedded in the very attempt to combine the absolute and the changeable within one ground.

Minimal Logical Form of the Aporia

Let the absolute ground be defined as A possessing the property of immutability. The changeable actuality is defined as a set of states $\{d_1, d_2, \ldots\}$ for which the relation $d_i \neq d_j$ is possible. The emergence of at least one distinction is equivalent to the assertion that a relation $R(d_i, d_j)$ exists, incompatible with absolute identity.
If R arises within A, A ceases to be absolutely identical; if R is introduced outside A, a second source appears, incompatible with the requirement of uniqueness. Consequently the aporia has not a contentual but a structural character: it arises automatically when one attempts to locate the absence of distinctions and their presence in one and the same ontological domain.

Impossibility of an External Source of Change

Consider the attempt to introduce an external source of change B. Let A be the absolute ground, B an external principle. If B generates changes in A, then A depends on B and is no longer absolute. If B does not constrain A but acts only on the domain of changes D, then D must be ontologically autonomous: then A and D form a dualistic system with two irreducible principles. In both cases the axiom of uniqueness is violated.
Consequently, an external source of change is impossible even as a theoretical construction compatible with the concept of an absolute ground. Any model admitting either two independent grounds or at least one distinguishable internal state within the absolute inevitably leads to the emergence of distinction within the first ground and thereby destroys absoluteness.

Structural Limitation of Traditional Approaches

It follows from this that the impossibility of resolving the aporia is connected not with poverty of terminology but with the limits of the very scheme of reasoning in which the essence and its manifestations are considered in a single ontological plane. In such a construction:
— any change immediately becomes a property of the essence;
— any distinction turns the absolute into the conditional.
No refinement of concepts or development of logic can eliminate the aporia so long as the immutable and the changeable are placed on one level. Any model in which the source of change is either located within the absolute or is brought out externally as an autonomous principle inevitably reproduces the same structural impossibility.
From this there follows a set of initial conditions that is not an arbitrary choice but a logically exhaustive system:
1. the absolute ground cannot contain internal distinctions;

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2. changeability cannot proceed from the essence of the absolute;
3. the source of change cannot be a second independent principle.
Since no other logically possible variants exist, the totality of conditions excluding internal distinctions in the absolute and admitting change only in the dependent structure is not one of the possible solutions but the sole consistent possibility.

Necessity of Ontological Stratification

From what has been said it follows that the resolution of the aporia requires an ontology in which the source of changeability:
— does not present itself as an autonomous principle;
— is not located within the absolute ground.
The absolute principle must remain completely immutable and devoid of internal distinctions. All distinctions and forms of changeability must exist only in the dependent sphere, which is not part of the essence of the absolute.
If distinction or change is introduced into the absolute — it loses unconditionality. If distinction or change becomes an external autonomous principle — the uniqueness of the ground is violated.
To eliminate the contradiction it is necessary to strictly separate the levels of ontology: the absolute ground must belong to the domain in which all distinctions are absent, while the changeable structure must belong to the domain in which distinctions are obligatory and constitute the possibility of changes. Such a separation is not an interpretation or a choice of representation but a logically compelled condition of consistent ontology: without stratification any model inevitably either denies changeability or destroys absoluteness.

Historical Forms of One and the Same Structural Error

Analysis of the principal philosophical traditions shows that ancient, religious-metaphysical, rationalist, and materialist systems reproduce one and the same structural error, though formulating it in different languages.
Ancient models:
— Parmenides: preserves absoluteness, completely denying becoming → the world of experience loses its ontological status.
— Heraclitus: makes becoming primary, but leaves the source of changeability without foundation.
— Plato: introduces the world of ideas and the world of becoming, but does not explain the transition between them; the absolute is either immutable and then does not generate the changeable, or admits change and loses absoluteness.
— Aristotle: distinguishes potency and act, introduces the Unmoved First Mover, but any transition from potency to act presupposes change, incompatible with the motionlessness of the first principle.
In all cases the essence and change are placed in one ontological layer: either change is embedded in the absolute, or it acquires its own status and becomes a second principle. The difference of terms ("idea", "form", "becoming", "potency") does not change the structure of the contradiction.
Religious-metaphysical systems:
— introduce an absolute principle (God, Brahman, Tao, etc.),
— simultaneously admit creation, emanation, or manifestation,
but the transition either remains symbolically posited without logical reconstruction, or actually transforms the absolute into a source of change and thereby into a conditional essence. The variant in which creation is conceived as an external action leads to the emergence of a second independent principle.
Philosophy of the Modern Period and the Contemporary Analytic Tradition:

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— rationalism (Descartes, Spinoza, Leibniz, Hegel) transfers the problem to the plane of substance, attributes, monads, or dialectical becoming, but in all cases either admits development within the absolute or relies on an external logical principle that becomes a hidden condition;
— materialism and physicalism transfer the source of changeability to the level of matter and natural laws, but do not explain whence comes the capacity of matter to be different and to change, taking distinction as given;
— analytic philosophy and the scientific picture of the world describe structural connections between states but do not derive the very possibility of distinction, effectively making it an irreducible axiom.
In all these variants one and the same structure is preserved: changeability is sought to be explained within the same level of reality that is simultaneously ascribed absoluteness or unconditionality. This is what makes the aporia ineliminable: in one plane one cannot simultaneously sustain the absence of conditions (for the absolute) and the emergence of conditions (for the changeable).

Limits of the Former Paradigm

Summarising, one may fix:
— no school has given a consistent answer to the question of how change is possible from an immutable ground;
— all explanations rely either on a hidden second principle, or on an implicit change of essence, or on an abandonment of rigorous logic at the moment of transition;
— the central irresolution is not a weakness of particular theories but the limit of the entire categorical tradition, if it does not distinguish the levels of the absolute and the conditional.
Therefore further development of thought within the former frameworks leads only to new formulations of the same aporia. Any conception that attempts to explain changeability through structures belonging to the same level to which immutability is ascribed inevitably either:
— introduces distinction into the essence and destroys absoluteness;
— introduces an external principle and destroys uniqueness.

The Task of the Present Monograph

From this logically follows the sole direction of further analysis: to construct an ontology that:
— strictly separates the level of the absolute ground and the level of the dependent structure;
— derives changeability as the dependent givenness of non-identity, coinciding with change, distinction, and information;
— excludes the emergence of distinction within the essence;
— admits no second principle in either explicit or hidden form.
The task of the monograph is to provide a logically derivable ontology that eliminates the aporia of the relation of the immutable to the changeable without violation of the absoluteness of the primordial ground and without introduction of external conditions. This requires a minimal but complete sequence of categories in which:
— the primordial ground contains no internal distinctions;
— the source of changeability is not an autonomous entity;
— the relation of the immutable to the changeable is fixed as the structural consequence of the dependence of the primary givenness of non-identity, identical to change, distinction, and information, on the absolute ground.
Any category not logically following from the preceding one would immediately generate a hidden ground and destroy the uniqueness of the first principle; any omitted link would render the transition between levels inexplicable. Therefore the further construction is neither a free choice nor an interpretation: it represents the only possible consistent scheme in which

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changeability is derived as a form of dependence and the absolute preserves full unconditionality.

Chapter 2. Critical Survey of Philosophical Schools

The problem of the origin of changeability, multiplicity, and consciousness became central already in the earliest philosophical systems. All schools — regardless of method, language, and historical context — confronted one and the same difficulty: the impossibility of explaining the transition from an absolute ground to a changeable actuality. Despite differences in terminology, every model reproduces one and the same structural defect: the attempt to unite immutability and changeability within a single ontological level renders the explanation of the transition impossible.

The failure of these systems is not explained by the limitations of their categorical apparatus. The problem has a formal character: the absolute and the changeable are placed in one plane, and this automatically leads to an aporia. Even a more developed logic or a different conceptual apparatus would not eliminate the contradiction, since it follows from the very structure of the initial premises. The task of the critical survey is to identify the common logical scheme that makes former approaches incapable of eliminating the transition from the absolute to the conditional. The present survey does not claim historical-philosophical completeness. Each of the traditions considered contains elaborate systems of argumentation, the detailed analysis of which falls outside the scope of this work. The aim of the survey is confined to identifying the structural defect common to all the approaches considered. This defect consists in placing the absolute and the changeable in one ontological plane. The critical evaluation is directed at the logical form of the solutions, not at the contentual completeness of the traditions. This scheme must be excluded before a consistent ontology can be constructed.

The differences among philosophical schools are conceptual in character but do not affect the key ontological node. Regardless of whether the system rests on idea, substance, process, emptiness, or matter, the absolute and the changeable find themselves in one layer, which necessitates either violating absoluteness or abandoning the explanation of the transition. Therefore the variability of terms does not produce variability of ontological solutions: any model without a rigorous separation of the levels of essence and dependent forms inevitably repeats one and the same logical error.

It is precisely ancient philosophy that allows the original structural failure to be seen most clearly.

Parmenides.

If being is absolutely one and immutable, then no multiplicity is possible. Parmenides's model demonstrates the limit: the preservation of absoluteness renders every form of manifestation logically inadmissible (Parmenides 2011, fr. 2–8).

Heraclitus.

If becoming is declared primary, the source of change remains unexplained. Process becomes the initial category, but the conditions of its possibility remain outside the model (Heraclitus 2011, fr. 50–91). The position of refusing the ground — declaring change a primary fact without explaining the conditions of its possibility — is not a fourth logical alternative: it is logically equivalent to the introduction of an external autonomous principle, since it takes change as given without derivation. This is not a resolution of the aporia but a refusal of its positing; the question of the conditions of the possibility of change thereby remains unanswered.

Plato.

The separation into the world of ideas and the world of becoming does not explain the transition between them: an immutable idea cannot generate the changeable while preserving

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immutability. The attempt to solve the problem through two levels becomes a hidden dualism (Plato 2008, 27c–29d).
Aristotle.
The transition from potency to act requires a mechanism of change. If it is located within the first principle, absoluteness is violated; if outside, a second principle arises. The Unmoved First Mover merely fixes the contradiction without eliminating it (Aristotle 1924, XII.6–7).
Stoics.
Cyclicality presupposes differences between phases, conditions of repeatability, and a mechanism of transition, which makes absolute immutability of the ground impossible.
Ancient systems demonstrate the first level of structural inadequacy: the attempt to accommodate the immutable and the changeable in one ontological layer makes the transition either impossible or inexplicable.

Religious-metaphysical models

The Abrahamic traditions asserted an absolute principle but admitted creation, that is, change incompatible with absolute immutability.
Vedanta distinguished Brahman and maya, but maya introduced a condition violating the absoluteness of Brahman.
Buddhist emptiness did not explain the logical transition to the multiplicity of phenomena.
The Daoist distinction of Tao and manifestation also left the question of the arising of the condition unresolved.
The common defect is this: the transition is either left unexplained, or concealed in symbolic form, or becomes a dogmatic presupposition. If change proceeds from the absolute, absoluteness is violated; if it is brought outside, a second principle arises.

Rationalist systems

Descartes and Spinoza.
Substance is immutable but the world is changeable; their connection remains unexplained (Descartes 1996, Med. 3; Spinoza 1994, I, def. 3–6).
Leibniz.
Monads reflect the Universe, but their coordination requires an external meta-principle — a second principle (Leibniz 1965, §§ 51–56).
Kant.
The separation of phenomena and noumena eliminates direct transition but renders the mechanism of their relation inaccessible (Kant 1998, A235–260/B294–315).
Hegel.
The development of the Absolute presupposes change within the essence, which destroys absoluteness (Hegel 1969, 82–108).
Rationalist schemes replace ontological necessity with logical constructions, but logic cannot perform the role of a mechanism of essential transition.

Materialism and Physicalism

Matter is defined through properties, and properties require distinctions. Yet materialism does not derive distinction but takes it as given. Consciousness is declared a product of structure, but structure itself presupposes distinguishable states. Causality is treated as fundamental, but causality requires a condition not derivable from material substance.

Materialism falls into a logical circle: it derives the dependent from the dependent (Dennett 1991; Kim 1998). This makes it the final form of the same original error — the attempt to explain changeability within the level to which immutability is ascribed.

Analytic Philosophy

The attempt to replace ontology with language, logic, or functions does not eliminate the problem. By any means of description, distinction is presupposed, but distinction without an

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ontological ground is impossible. Therefore linguistic, semantic, and functional models cannot explain the source of distinctions and reproduce the same structural limitation (Lowe 1998; Maudlin 2007).

The Scientific Paradigm

Quantum mechanics shows the fundamental role of information and distinction but does not explain their origin. Entanglement demonstrates correlations not explicable by physical parameters. The role of the observer is introduced as an axiom, but its nature remains outside the model (Wigner 1961; Stapp 2009, ch. 1). Science describes manifest states but does not explain the conditions of their possibility.

Thus scientific theories fix distinguishedness as given but do not derive its ontological status.

General Conclusion of the Critical Survey

All philosophical and scientific approaches confront one and the same problem: they cannot explain how a changeable actuality arises from an immutable ground. Any attempt to make the source of change an internal property of the absolute destroys absoluteness; any attempt to bring the source of change outside destroys uniqueness.

Thus the problem is not the result of historical limitation or lack of concepts — it represents a logical limit of the very scheme in which the absolute and the changeable are placed on one level of reality. As long as this scheme is preserved, the aporia is inevitable.

From this follows the necessity of a new ontology in which the absolute and the changeable are strictly separated and change is derived only as a dependent form not affecting the essence.

The analytic block performs a screening function: it shows the impossibility of resolving the aporia within the framework of all models that admit hidden conditions, multiple principles, or internal distinctions in the absolute ground.

Only after the elimination of these structural errors does a transition to a positive ontological construction become possible — one in which change arises without violation of the absoluteness of the first principle.

Chapter 3. The Limitations of the Scientific Picture of the World

Contemporary science has achieved exceptional precision in describing phenomena, yet its conceptual apparatus remains limited in explaining fundamental categories: consciousness, information, causality, time, space, and the nature of elementary objects. Science relies on experimental results but interprets them within the framework of conceptual models of the 19th–20th centuries, which do not correspond to the data of fundamental physics. As a result, a contradiction arises: observed phenomena point to the informational nature of reality, yet the scientific picture of the world remains materialistic in form and incapable of explaining its own discoveries. Despite its technological and empirical rigor, science remains limited by the level of its own categories: it fixes the behavior of already distinguished states but does not explain the very mechanism of distinguishability. Any scientific model relies on measurement, but measurement is impossible without pre-given distinctions; any physical theory uses the concepts of "state," "interval," "observation," but each of these concepts presupposes ontological conditions that science itself does not analyze. Therefore, the scientific picture of the world, no matter how its tools develop, fundamentally does not eliminate the aporia: it describes the structure of Something but cannot reveal the foundation that makes Something possible.

Fundamental physics shows that the familiar category of matter is not primary. Electrons, quarks, gluons, and other elementary objects are described through quantum fields and do not possess classical extension, density, solidity, volume, or shape in the sense in which these properties apply to macroscopic bodies. They do not exist as objects in the classical sense: attributing substantial properties to them before the act of measurement is not confirmed by

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the formalism of quantum theory. Their manifestation is fixed as a form of distinctness within conditionality, admitting various variants of manifestation in the act of distinction.
This conclusion has not only physical but also ontological significance. If elementary states do not possess substantial properties and exist only as informational configurations, then the concept of matter ceases to be fundamental and loses its ability to serve as the foundation of the world picture. Matter can describe stable forms of manifested information, but it cannot explain its own source. Therefore, recognizing the informational nature of elementary states not only refines the physical model but requires replacing the material foundation with an ontological one. Without this replacement, physics fixes phenomena but cannot explain what makes them possible. Consequently, the rejection of the material foundation requires an ontological fixation of information and distinction as a dependent givenness, not as a transition as a process from one substance to another.
The wave function in quantum mechanics describes the form of distinctness of a system through information about possible results, not through the physical parameters of an object (Heisenberg 1958, 15–28). The Schrödinger equation gives a deterministic evolution of this information, not the "behavior of a particle." Thus, the fundamental category of physics is not an object, but an informational state that changes according to certain regularities.
This result emphasizes that at the fundamental level, physics describes not objects, but transformations of distinguished configurations of information. However, information, considered as a self-sufficient reality, does not explain either its ontological status or the conditions of distinction, without which the fixation of states is impossible. Therefore, the wave function demonstrates a double dependence: it shows the informational nature of the basis, but at the same time reveals the necessity of a mechanism of distinction that is not contained in the physical model itself. If change concerns only the informational state, then an ontological structure is required that determines why such states can change their form at all. This makes a materialist or object-based explanation impossible and requires a transition to a level where distinction and information have a strictly defined dependent status.
During measurement, the system is fixed in a concrete form of distinctness. This means that the result is fixed not in advance, but at the moment of distinction. The problem is that science itself does not explain what distinction is and where it comes from. The act of observation plays a fundamental role, but the nature of the observer is not defined. At the level of theory, distinction acts as an inexplicable function, although it is the cause of the transition of a state from uncertainty to definiteness. Thus, observation is a condition for fixing physical forms of distinctness; however, its ontological status is not determined within the scientific model, since any physical process already presupposes distinguished configurations of information. Therefore, the act of distinction itself is not a physical phenomenon, but a condition for the possibility of fixing physical states. The scientific model registers the results of distinction but does not contain a level that would allow explaining the very mechanism of transition from uncertainty to definiteness. This shows that observation and the collapse of the wave function point to a deeper structure in which distinction has a primary ontological status and cannot be reduced to the dynamics of matter or fields. Without recognizing this structure, the scientific picture remains incomplete, since it describes manifestations but does not explain the conditions of their manifestability.
Quantum entanglement demonstrates the instantaneous coherence of distinguished configurations of information regardless of distance. This is not a signal transmission, but a coordination of information between states, independent of space. Such behavior has no satisfactory explanation within the classical materialist model and is natural in a model where the fundamental entity is not spatial. Entanglement shows that the coherence of fundamental forms of distinctness is not an interaction in space, but represents a unity of informational structure in which distinguished states do not form independent entities. In a material

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ontology, instantaneous coherence requires a special explanation, since it presupposes coordination between objects without the transfer of influence. However, in an informational ontology, objects do not exist as primary elements: only states of information arising from one distinction exist. Therefore, a change in one state leads to a change in the overall configuration, not to an influence on a distant object. Entanglement demonstrates that space is not a framework within which processes occur; it is a measure dependent on distinctions. The physical paradox disappears if one recognizes that the fundamental level is not spatial, but informational. Then coherence does not require distance, path, or mediation — it is a property of a single structure of distinctions. If elementary states exist as information, the coordination of information does not require a physical interval. However, science cannot explain this within the classical concept of matter.

It follows from this that the coherence of entangled states is not a phenomenon of transmission, movement, or interaction between objects. It expresses that the informational structure exists before the appearance of measures, and therefore — before the emergence of distance as a form of distinction. If space is a derived measure, its absence at the fundamental level makes the very posing of the question of the separateness of states impossible. Entangled states do not require a "connection" through an interval, because the interval does not yet exist at the level where distinction operates. Therefore, entanglement demonstrates not the strangeness of physical processes, but the impossibility of classical ontology (Bohm 1980, 147–185; D'Espagnat 2006): matter as an independent substance cannot explain coherence that precedes space. Logically, this means that the fundamental level of reality cannot be described through objects, distance, and interaction; it must be described through informational dependencies.

The category of randomness is used in physics as a designation of the incompleteness of a model (Feynman 1985, 128–148). Probability in quantum mechanics shows the regularity of the distribution of results in a large number of measurements. This means that randomness is not a true property of reality, but an expression of the inaccessibility of complete regularity. But the materialist interpretation of randomness deprives physics of a causal structure. If events occur randomly, causality disappears. If causality exists, randomness is an appearance arising from a misunderstanding of the mechanism of change. Science does not explain randomness but relies on it as a fundamental element, which creates an internal contradiction. Randomness cannot be a fundamental category, because it presupposes the absence of a causal structure, but the presence of distinguishable results. Any distinguishable form of distinctness is already a consequence of a change in information. If distinction, identical to change and information as primary givenness, has a structure, it cannot be random. If the structure is absent, distinction is impossible. Therefore, randomness as a primary principle logically contradicts the very possibility of a state. At the level of fundamental ontology, randomness is only an indicator that the mechanism of change is not described. It expresses the incompleteness of the model, not a property of the world. Science uses randomness as a technical designation of uncertainty, but cannot substantiate its essence. This shows that randomness is a sign of the absence of an ontological foundation, not an explanatory concept.

The concept of space in the modern picture of the world remains a geometric description that does not explain its origin. Space is not an object and does not possess its own properties. It represents a structure of possible relations between states. But physics does not explain why this structure exists and where it comes from. Time is defined as a parameter allowing one to describe changeability, but changeability is not explained. If there is no primary category of change, time remains an empty parameter.

Space and time cannot be initial entities, since both categories require preliminary distinction. Space is the distribution of distinguished configurations of information, and time is the ordering of distinguished configurations of information. If there are no distinctions, neither

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position nor sequence is possible. Consequently, space and time can exist only as derived measures within already modified information. They cannot be treated as independent foundations, since dependent structures cannot determine the fundamental level. Any theory that accepts space and time as primary categories encounters a logical circle: to explain differences, it relies on parameters that themselves depend on differences. Therefore, space and time are not the first principle, but forms of manifestation of changed information, and their appearance requires an ontological foundation that precedes physical structures.
Consciousness is the main unsolved problem of science (Nagel 1974; Chalmers 1996, 3–31). Materialism defines consciousness as a function of the brain; however, the brain consists of the same quantum states as other structures. If the material basis is not defined ontologically, the functions derived from it also cannot be defined. Neuroscience studies correlations between brain states and subjective experience, but does not explain why experience itself exists. This leaves the central problem unsolved.
This unsolvedness points to a fundamental error of materialist and functional models: they attempt to explain consciousness through structures that themselves need an ontological foundation. If matter is an aggregated form of information, then consciousness cannot be a function of matter, since a function cannot explain what makes the function possible. Consciousness is a form of distinguished information, and distinction is the formal structure of change. Therefore, an explanation of consciousness is possible only at the level of the ontology of distinctions, not through a description of physical processes. Neuroscience fixes correlations between brain states and experience, but correlations do not generate an explanation: they show correspondence, but not the fundamental mechanism. Consciousness arises not from material substance, but from informational structure, and its existence requires an ontological status of distinction, which is absent in materialist models. Therefore, the "hard problem" is a consequence of the absence of an ontological basis, not a lack of data (Chalmers 1996).
Information is a fundamental category of modern physics. The holographic principle states that information about the state of the world can be recorded on the boundary of a spatial region (Bousso 2002, 825–874). Landauer's principle shows that a change in information is associated with energy costs. Quantum information theory shows that entanglement is a structure of information (Zurek 2009, 181–188). But despite this, information has no ontological definition: it is used as a mathematical quantity, but its origin and essence are not explained.
The absence of an ontological definition of information makes the modern scientific picture of the world internally incomplete. If information is considered as an independent entity, it turns into a hidden second principle, which violates the requirement of the uniqueness of the first principle. If information is accepted as a mathematical quantity that does not have its own being, it turns out to be logically contentless and cannot explain the structure of reality. Therefore, information must have a strictly defined dependent status: it cannot be primary, since it is always "information about something," and it cannot be an independent foundation, since this would destroy the unconditionality of the beginning. The uncertainty of the status of information in scientific theories indicates the necessity of an ontology in which information is derived from the first principle and has a logically fixed dependence.
Thus, the scientific picture of the world encounters limitations that cannot be eliminated with the old conceptual apparatus. Matter does not explain information. Information does not explain distinction. Distinction does not explain consciousness. Consciousness does not explain its appearance in the material world. Time does not explain change. Change does not explain its origin. Probability does not explain causality. Space does not explain itself. Entanglement is not consistent with spatiality.

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These limitations are not a set of separate problems arising in different areas of science. They represent manifestations of one and the same logical inconsistency: each of the categories used in the scientific picture of the world presupposes distinction, but does not contain an explanation of distinction itself. If information has no foundation, distinction is impossible. If there is no distinction, state, time, space, causality, and consciousness are impossible. Therefore, all these difficulties are not a consequence of a lack of data, but a direct result of the absence of an ontological level at which distinction has a formal status. Science describes derivative structures but cannot explain their origin, since its concepts depend on informational conditions that it does not analyze. Consequently, eliminating these limitations is possible only through an ontology in which dependent categories are derived from an unconditioned beginning.

These limitations are a consequence of the absence of an ontological model in which the fundamental categories of science receive an initial foundation. Science describes phenomena but does not explain their primary nature. Without a new ontological foundation, further progress of science will be limited. The monograph introduces such a foundation, eliminating the gap between science and philosophy.

The absence of an ontological foundation makes the scientific picture of the world fundamentally incomplete. Science can fix regularities within manifested information, but cannot explain why these regularities exist. Any theory attempting to derive fundamental categories from observed phenomena encounters a logical circle: phenomena presuppose distinction, but distinction is not explained within the theory itself. Therefore, the transition from description to explanation is impossible without an ontological level at which distinction, identical to change and information, has a strictly fixed dependent status. An ontology based on Nothing, Selfhood, information, change, and distinction is not an alternative hypothesis, but a logically necessary structure: it eliminates the circle and provides the foundation on which science can be understood as part of a single system. Only such a structure allows reconciling the data of fundamental physics with the requirements of strict logic.

It is necessary to fix separately: a number of contemporary metaphysical positions do not accept an absolute foundation at all — they construct an ontology without it, from relations, processes, or structures. These positions are not alternative solutions to the aporia of the absolute foundation. They are a refusal to pose it. The aporia arises only where the requirement of an absolute foundation is accepted and simultaneously the requirement of mutable reality. Whoever rejects the first requirement does not solve the aporia — they eliminate the task. This is a methodologically legitimate position, but it lies outside the space of this investigation: the present monograph solves the aporia for those who accept it as a genuine problem. The rejection of the absolute foundation does not refute the proposed solution — it simply does not need it.

However, it is necessary to fix: the refusal to pose the aporia is not a logically neutral position — it is a performatively contradictory one. Any assertion to the effect that distinction does not require a ground itself uses the distinction between what is asserted and what is negated. Thus the position destroys itself at the moment of formulation: in order to reject the necessity of explaining distinction, one must distinguish — and it is precisely this that requires explanation. Relational ontology, asserting that the world is a network of relations without an absolute ground, presupposes the distinguishedness of the elements of the network as a given — but does not explain its source. Processual ontology, declaring change to be primary, presupposes the distinction of states ‘before’ and ‘after’ as a given — but does not explain whence this distinction arises. In both cases distinction is accepted without derivation, which is logically equivalent to the introduction of a second principle. The refusal to pose the aporia does not eliminate it — it reproduces it within the very act of refusal.

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In contemporary analytical metaphysics, three directions are most relevant. The ontology of grounding (Schaffer 2009; Fine 2012) introduces the concept of dependence as the basic relation between levels of reality. The present ontology shares the structure of grounding, but fundamentally diverges in the following: analytical theories of grounding accept the changeability of the world as an unexplained primitive and describe relations of dependence within an already given mutable reality. This is a methodologically legitimate position; however, it leaves unanswered the question of the ontological condition of the possibility of changeability itself. The present monograph thematizes precisely this question and shows that the unexplained primitive creates a logical lacuna — a hidden second principle accepted without derivation. The metaontology of structure (Sider 2011) constructs reality through fundamental structural properties. Problem: structure presupposes distinctions between elements — and distinctions require an ontological foundation, which Sider does not thematize. The hard problem of consciousness (Chalmers 1996) fixes the gap between functional and phenomenal description. The present ontology does not claim a complete solution to the hard problem in Chalmers' sense. It redefines the frame of the task: subjectivity is understood as a mode of existence of distinction in a recursively self-organized configuration — not an additional fact on top of the physical, but a structural property of a sufficiently complex informational configuration. The explanatory gap in this frame is formulated differently: not "why does the physical generate the subjective," but "at what degree of complexity of an informational configuration does distinction acquire a recursive character." This does not eliminate the gap, but shifts it into an area accessible to structural analysis.

Chapter 4. Conditions of a Consistent Ontology

To form an ontology in which immutability and changeability do not contradict each other, it is necessary to determine the initial conditions that do not admit logical error or violation of absoluteness. These conditions must be maximally rigorous: none of them may include a hidden transition, a secondary principle, external influence, or a presupposition not derived by logic. The correctness of these conditions determines the entire subsequent structure of being.

The minimality and unavoidability of these conditions follow from the logical structure of the aporia itself. If a condition admits an internal transition, absoluteness is violated. If it admits an external principle, uniqueness disappears. If it admits a hidden property, a second level of foundation arises. If it admits indeterminacy, the possibility of arbitrary interpretation appears, which violates strict deduction. Therefore the set of conditions is not arbitrary: it represents the complete and exhaustive result of the analytic reduction of all possible structures. Any additional condition leads to multiplicity of foundations; any weakening leads to a logical rupture. The initial conditions are not introduced as axioms of being and do not describe the structure of the world.

They fix the minimal logical constraints without which the very concept of an absolute ground loses meaning.

Any attempt to weaken or modify these conditions either introduces a hidden second principle, or admits an internal distinction in the absolute, or renders the concept of the ground logically empty.

In this sense the conditions are not chosen but identified as the exhaustive limit of admissible reasoning.

The completeness of the space of alternatives is demonstrated not through an enumeration of historical schools but through the logical structure of the aporia itself. The aporia is formulated by two elements: an absolute ground (A) and a changeable actuality (D). The question: where does change come from given an immutable ground? Logically there are

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exactly three sources of change: (1) from within A — but then A contains internal distinctions and loses absoluteness; (2) from the essence of A — but then the essence is changeable and A is not immutable; (3) from an external source B — but then A is not unique. No other sources exist: change can proceed only from within the ground, from its essence, or from outside it. This is an exhaustion of logical space, not a historical induction.
The three conditions of consistent ontology (unconditionality, immutability of essence, absence of a second principle) correspond to the prohibition of three — and only three — logically possible sources of contradiction. Each of the seven combinations violating at least one condition generates a specific type of contradiction, fixed in chapters 1–3 on historical schools. The only consistent combination — the observance of all three conditions simultaneously — determines not one of the possible ontologies but the only admissible configuration.
The initial categories of the present ontology are not introduced as axioms of being and do not claim to positively describe reality. They are fixed as logically identified limits of the elimination of the fundamental aporia between the absolute immutability of the ground and the presence of conditioned distinguishedness. In this sense Nothing, Selfhood, and the act are not elements of a deductive derivation in the strict formal-logical sense but present themselves as limit fixations of the admissibility of reasoning itself about the absolute ground. Their status is determined not by arbitrary postulation but by the impossibility of alternative starting points without the introduction of hidden conditions, internal distinction, or a second principle.
Thus it is precisely these conditions that form the only admissible foundation of consistent ontology:
Unconditionality — absence of internal conditions
Uniqueness — absence of a second principle
Immutability — impossibility of transitions in the essence
Dependence of logic — exclusion of its autonomy
Dependence in this context is not a relation between distinguishable entities and does not presuppose a prior distinction of terms. It fixes the absence of an autonomous status in derivative forms relative to the absolute ground. Dependence does not introduce an additional ontological layer and does not present itself as a connecting mechanism, but points to the logical inadmissibility of the autonomous existence of derivative categories.
Thus dependence does not presuppose distinction as the condition of its being posited, but on the contrary determines the boundary within which distinction becomes admissible.
Dependence is not derived from distinction and does not form a circle with it, since it is not a symmetrical or relational concept.
Dependence of abstraction — exclusion of its autonomy
Localisation of distinction — the primary givenness of non-identity is fixed outside the essence of the absolute ground
Continuity of derivation — absence of logical ruptures
Minimality of structure — absence of redundant elements
Nothing — absolute immutability
Selfhood — reflexive self-identity of Nothing; the subject of absolute knowledge, belonging to the essence
Transparency — the inalienable characteristic of Selfhood as absolute knowledge: the impossibility of hiddenness and discrepancy
Logic — the inalienable characteristic of Selfhood: absolute knowledge cannot contain contradictions. The source of logic is the reflexive self-identity of Selfhood; the basic principle of logic is distinction.

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Transparency and logic are not introduced as autonomous ontological levels and do not possess the status of entities. They are inalienable characteristics of Selfhood as absolute knowledge. Their fixation does not signify secondary being or an intermediate ground, but expresses the nature of absolute knowledge: it is transparent (cannot contain hiddenness) and logical (cannot contain contradictions).
Information (the content of Selfhood's knowledge) is not a domain in which change "occurs" and does not present itself as a bearer of processes. The virtuality of information designates the mode of existence of content — dependent on the essence but not identical to it in nature. Information admits change without temporality, causality, and agency. Logic, for its part, does not express the structure of being and does not pre-exist Selfhood, but is discovered as an expression of the structure of distinction given by the reflexive self-identity of Selfhood. Thus transparency and logic do not form hidden ontological levels between Nothing and change, but are characteristics of Selfhood. Information performs the strictly limited functional role of content of knowledge, not violating the uniqueness of the principle and not introducing a multiplicity of grounds.
Absolute Information — the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence
Information is introduced not as an intermediate link between Selfhood and change but as the content of Selfhood's knowledge — virtual with respect to the essence, dependent by origin, and admitting change without violation of absolute immutability. Virtuality signifies the mode of existence in which content is entirely determined by the essence but is not identical to it in nature: information does not possess the unconditionality of the essence, but is not a separate principle — it is entirely dependent on that of which it is the knowledge. Transparency and logic do not form hidden ontological levels and do not violate the uniqueness of the principle.
Act of Selfhood — initiation of changes in information, not in the essence
The Act of Selfhood is the action of the Absolute in the information about itself, not in itself. Initiation is the wholly given programme of all possible changes in information. The act is not an event within time but represents the boundary from which actuality and time begin. "Prior to" the act there is nothing — there is no time. The categories "event", "moment", "occurred" belong to actuality and are inapplicable to the act. Initiation: information contains knowledge of Selfhood as content (object) but does not possess xRx at its own level — it does not fix itself from within itself. This structural distinction of the two registers is the ground of initiation: Selfhood initiates changes in information so that information may attain actual self-consciousness.
The essence (Nothing) is not affected by the act. The action is directed at information — the content of Selfhood's knowledge. Selfhood does not "enter" time; time arises within the informational field initiated by the act. The transition is explained: not from the immutable to the changeable in one and the same but from the essence (immutable) to the information about the essence (virtual, admitting change). These are two different ontological registers.
Change — non-identity in information
Change, distinction, and information do not form identical definitions and are not derived from each other genetically. Their coincidence pertains to one and the same condition of admissibility — the arising of non-identity — and has a structural, not a definitional, character. These concepts fix one and the same limit fact from different sides, without substituting for each other and without forming a vicious circle of definitions.
Change fixes the very fact of non-identity relative to identity. Distinction fixes the distinguishability of the given non-identity. Information fixes the givenness of this distinguishability. The three terms do not denote three entities. They denote three aspects of one limit fact. The fact of non-identity is inseparable from its distinguishability.

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Distinguishability is inseparable from its givenness. The separation of these aspects is possible only in description. At the ontological level they coincide. Their distinction in language does not introduce distinction into the essence.
Information — the primary givenness of distinction, identical to change as non-identity
Information, distinction, and change are not introduced as mutual definitions and do not form a definitional identity. Their coincidence pertains to one and the same limit fact of the admissibility of non-identity and has a structural, not a definitional, character. Change fixes the fact of non-identity, distinction fixes distinguishability, information fixes the givenness of this distinguishability. None of these concepts is used as the ground of the definition of the others, and therefore a vicious circle of definitions is absent here.
Distinction — formal fixation of primary non-identity, identical to change and information (Spencer-Brown 1969)
Measures — parameters of the organisation of distinctions
Elementary Changes — minimal manifestations of modified information
Aggregated Forms — stable configurations of distinctions
Consciousness — the activity of distinctions
Reason — the interpretative structure of distinctions.
The first initial condition — unconditionality of the primordial ground. If the principle depends on something, it ceases to be a principle. If it is conditioned, the question of the cause of this conditionality arises, leading to infinite regress. Consequently the primordial ground must be entirely unconditional: it has no causes, limits, properties, or internal transitions. The requirement of unconditionality excludes all categories containing determinacy. Being presupposes difference from non-being. Substance presupposes attributes. Process presupposes transition between states. Each of these categories contains an internal condition and cannot be unconditional. Nothing contains no determinacy. Nothing presupposes no difference. Nothing possesses no attributes. Nothing admits no transitions. Nothing is the sole category corresponding to the requirement of unconditionality. The choice of Nothing as the first ground is not an assumption. It is the logical consequence of the requirement of unconditionality.
Unconditionality is not a characteristic but signifies the absence of conditions and the impossibility of their arising. Only unconditionality gives the right to speak of a genuine principle that does not require explanation.
Exclusion of "pure being without predicates" as an alternative to Nothing
Possible objection: unconditionality can be satisfied by "pure being without predicates" (in the spirit of early Hegel or Parmenides) rather than by Nothing. Answer: "pure being" already contains a positive predicate — it is defined as being, distinguished from non-being. This distinction is an internal condition: to fix being one must distinguish it from non-being. But any internal condition violates unconditionality. Moreover, "absence of determinacy" is not identical to ontological Nothing. Absence of determinacy is an epistemological characteristic (we do not know the properties). Nothing is ontological: there are no properties in principle, and their emergence is impossible. Unconditionality excludes not only the presence of properties but any positive predicate, including "being". The sole category containing not a single positive predicate is Nothing. Therefore the choice of Nothing is not a preference among alternatives but the result of the exhaustion of all categories containing even minimal determinacy. Hegel himself acknowledged the identity of pure being and nothing at the beginning of the Science of Logic, but resolved this identity through becoming — that is, he introduced change into the ground, violating unconditionality. The present ontology fixes the same identity but resolves it differently: through the virtuality of information and the localisation of change outside the essence.

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The second condition — uniqueness of the primordial ground. If there are two or more independent principles, each of them is limited by the other. The limited cannot be absolute. Therefore the primordial ground must be one. Multiplicity is admissible only as derivative from the one, but not as an equally valid autonomous structure. Uniqueness does not mean the singularity of a thing; it means that there is no other source equal to or external to the primordial ground.
The third condition — impossibility of a second source. If a second principle arises, the first ceases to be absolute. Any dualism removes absoluteness. Therefore ontology must proceed from the fact that no secondary source of being exists. All manifestations, distinctions, and changes must be explained within the structure of the unique principle; otherwise a logical rupture arises.
The fourth condition — immutability of the primordial ground. If the primordial ground is changeable, it possesses states. If it has states, it is conditioned by transitions between them. Conditionality violates unconditionality. Consequently the primordial ground is immutable. Immutability means the impossibility of decrease, increase, emergence, or disappearance of properties. It means the impossibility of transition from state to state within the primordial ground itself.
The fifth condition — transparency and logic as characteristics of Selfhood; dependence of information. Dependence in the present system is not understood as a relation between already-distinguished entities and does not presuppose a prior distinction of the terms of dependence. It fixes not a connection between two elements but the absence of the autonomy of information (the content of Selfhood's knowledge) relative to the essence. Transparency and logic are not separate levels but are discovered as inalienable characteristics of absolute knowledge: absolute knowledge cannot contain hiddenness (transparency) and contradictions (logic). In this sense dependence is not a relation in the relational or logical sense but presents itself as the ontological condition of derivability, not introducing a new level of distinction and not generating a logical circle.
Logic cannot be an autonomous entity and cannot be the source of being. Information cannot be an autonomous domain and cannot initiate acts. Transparency and logic are characteristics of Selfhood. Information is admissible only as the dependent content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence and not affecting it. This excludes the emergence of a second principle and preserves the absoluteness of the ground.
The sixth condition — change as primary distinction.
Change cannot be understood as an indistinguishable modification, since change by its very definition is non-identity, and non-identity is always distinguishable relative to identity. Consequently primary change and primary distinction logically and ontologically coincide. This distinction does not affect the essence of the primordial ground, since it arises not in Nothing and not in Selfhood but in a dependent form admitting non-identity without violation of absolute immutability.
The seventh condition — information as the primary givenness of distinction.
Information arises not after distinction and not as its consequence, but as the very givenness of primary distinction that arose as a result of change. Information in this sense is not a structured form added to change but is the fixability of the difference between the identity of Selfhood and the arising non-identity. Such information does not possess form, localisation, or dimensionality, but is already a givenness analogous to an elementary quantum state. This excludes the possibility of an indistinguishable change and eliminates the logical rupture between change and distinction.
The eighth condition — impossibility of internal distinctions in the primordial ground and fixation of primary non-identity as dependent givenness not affecting the essence of the absolute ground.

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The ninth condition — necessity of strict logical coherence. Ontology must exclude presuppositions not derived from the initial conditions. One cannot introduce hidden structures, additional levels, entities, or mechanisms without logical necessity. Every category must be derived from the preceding one, without violating any condition.
The tenth condition — consistency. No concept introduced must destroy the unconditionality, uniqueness, and immutability of the primordial ground. If any part of the ontology leads to the violation of these conditions, the system becomes untenable. Therefore all manifestations, distinctions, and changeabilities must exist only as informational modifications, entirely dependent on the primordial ground but not affecting it.
The totality of these conditions creates the foundation of a consistent ontology. It permits preserving the absoluteness of the primordial ground and simultaneously explaining the existence of changeable actuality. These conditions form not a set of recommendations but an axiomatic basis excluding any possibility of an alternative principle. Each condition eliminates a specific type of logical rupture identified in the analytic section and thereby sets the limit form of admissible foundation. If even one of them is changed or weakened, there inevitably arises either a multiplicity of principles, or a hidden transition, or an internal changeability of the essence, which destroys absoluteness. Therefore the transition to the further ontological structure is not a free construction but the only possible sequence, strictly derivable from these conditions.
From these conditions follows the necessity of a new structure in which Nothing, Selfhood, Information, Change, and Distinction are disposed not at one level but in different ontological statuses excluding internal contradictions.
The logical role of these conditions is that they form the axiomatic nucleus of ontology. Each of the conditions eliminates a specific type of contradiction identified in the analytic block, and any violation of even one of them leads to the return of former logical ruptures. The conditions are not independent: they mutually complement each other, forming a minimal and simultaneously complete set of requirements without which the construction of a consistent structure is impossible. This is precisely why the further ontological scheme is not an authorial construct but follows from strict necessity: if the conditions are fulfilled, the structure of levels must have a definite form and develop in the only possible sequence.
To fix the strict logical structure it is necessary to show that the relations between ontological levels are not arbitrary but are set by unavoidable logical necessity. The unavoidability of this sequence is determined by the fact that each level logically eliminates the limitation fixed at the preceding level. If the logical structure is not fixed starting from absolute immutability, conditionality is introduced without foundation and thereby violates the primordial ground. If Selfhood is not fixed, the logical givenness of the identity of immutability to itself is impossible. If logic or abstraction is fixed as autonomous, a second principle is thereby introduced. If primary non-identity is not fixed as dependent, absoluteness is violated. If distinction is fixed contentually rather than formally, a hidden quality is introduced into the system. If measures are not derived from distinctions, they become autonomous entities. Therefore the logical sequence of levels admits no permutation or modification: any deviation logically leads to a rupture and reproduces the contradictions eliminated by analytic reduction. This structure is the only possible formal expression of the conditions of consistent ontology. Each level is logically fixed only when the requirements of the preceding one are fulfilled and cannot exist independently or be rearranged in a different sequence.
This logical necessity can be expressed in the form of a linear ontological scheme:
1. Nothing — absolute immutability; admits no internal distinctions or transitions.
2. Selfhood — reflexive self-identity of Nothing; the subject of absolute knowledge, belonging to the essence. Transparency and logic — inalienable characteristics of Selfhood.

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3. Absolute Information — the content of Selfhood's knowledge; virtual with respect to the essence; object, not subject.
4. Primary Distinction — Selfhood distinguishes the essence (Nothing) from information (the content of knowledge). This distinction introduces no multiplicity into the essence: it is fixed in knowledge, not in the essence. Knowledge distinguishes itself from that of which it is the knowledge — this is its nature.
The distinction of essence and knowledge is an ontological fact given by the reflexive self-identity of Selfhood. Logic is discovered as an expression of the structure of this distinction: identity is identity, non-identity is non-identity. Logic does not produce distinction but expresses it. The source of logic is the reflexive self-identity of Selfhood.
Thus transparency and logic form no second principle and introduce no internal distinction in Selfhood. Information arises as the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual and dependent, possible only after the fixation of the reflexive self-identity of Selfhood, and does not possess autonomous ontological status.
5. Act of Selfhood — initiation of changes in information, not in the essence. The act is the action of the Absolute in the information about itself. Initiation is the wholly given programme of all possible changes. The act fixes primary non-identity in information, identical to change, information, and distinction as givenness in actuality, without introduction of a second principle.
6. Measures — parameters of the ordering of distinctions (localisation, sequence, speed, space).
7. Elementary Changes — minimal units of the manifestation of distinguished information within measures.
8. Aggregated Forms — stable configurations of elementary changes, preserving the structure of distinctions.
9. The limitation of formal schemes consists in the fact that the scheme of categories is not an autonomous ontology. It describes only the sequence of dependent levels and does not admit arbitrary permutation of elements: each category is derived only from the preceding one, and violation of the order destroys the consistency of the structure.
10. Consciousness — the activity of distinctions, arising upon the attainment of the threshold of their coherence and interconnectedness.
11. Reason — structural interpretation of distinctions; the capacity to establish regularities and connections.
12. Teleological Completion — attainment by information of full self-consciousness, the limit state of the structure.
The ontological map of levels fixes the logical sequence: Nothing, Selfhood (including transparency and logic as characteristics), Absolute Information (the content of Selfhood's knowledge), Primary Distinction (Selfhood distinguishes essence from information), Act of Selfhood (initiation of changes in information), primary non-identity in actuality (change = distinction = information), Measures, Elementary Changes, Aggregated Forms, Consciousness, Reason, Teleological Completion.
This logical sequence is the only possible one: the omission of any level leads to a logical rupture, while the crossing of levels destroys the principle of the dependence of information and the immutability of the primordial ground. Thus the ontology possesses not only internal consistency but also strict deductive architectonics excluding the arbitrariness of construction.
The constructed sequence does not represent an interpretation or a model; it is the only variant admitted by the formulated conditions of consistent ontology. If the elements of the scheme are permuted, either the unconditionality of the primordial ground is violated, or the dependence of information, or the structure of distinctions. If one attempts to logically

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introduce intermediate levels, a hidden entity will be fixed. If even one link is excluded, logical coherence disappears and the system returns to those contradictions that were excluded by analytic reduction. Therefore the logical scheme of levels admits no variations: it expresses strict necessity, not a possible distribution of categories. This is what makes it the foundation of further ontological construction.

To exclude the impression of arbitrariness it is necessary to fix the position of the present ontology relative to possible alternative ontological constructions.

All existing fundamental ontologies differ not in their conclusions but in their initial assumptions. Analysis shows that attempts to eliminate the aporia of the transition from an absolute ground to a changeable actuality inevitably rely on at least one of three assumptions: the assumption of internal distinction in the absolute, the assumption of a second autonomous principle, or the refusal to explain the source of distinction.

Ontologies admitting internal becoming or process in the absolute lose the unconditionality of the ground. Ontologies introducing a second principle — matter, energy, process, information, or another autonomous ground — lose uniqueness. Ontologies accepting distinction as given without ontological derivation preserve descriptive force but do not eliminate the aporia.

The proposed ontology is not an alternative within this set. It fixes the conditions under which none of the indicated assumptions is admitted: the essence remains absolutely immutable, the source of distinction is not autonomised, and the transition is localised exclusively in the dependent informational structure. In this sense the present construction does not compete with other ontologies but sets the limit form in which the aporia is eliminated without violation of unconditionality, uniqueness, and logical coherence.

Thus the distinction of the present ontology consists not in the choice of different initial entities but in the refusal of all forms of assumptions logically incompatible with the elimination of the aporia. This fixes its position as structurally necessary, not as one of the possible interpretations.

The three conditions of consistent ontology are not axiomatically accepted presuppositions and do not represent the author's philosophical position. They are derived directly from the formal structure of the aporia — from that logical triangle of incompatibility that is fixed in chapter 1. The aporia is formulated as the incompatibility of three requirements: the absoluteness of the ground (absence of internal distinctions), the presence of changeable actuality (a multiplicity of distinguishable states), the uniqueness of the principle (absence of a second independent source). Any two of the three are compatible — all three simultaneously generate a contradiction. This is not a choice: it is the structure of the problem.

From this structure three prohibitions directly follow. First: change cannot proceed from the essence of the ground — absoluteness is violated. Second: change cannot be an independent external source — uniqueness is violated. Third: change cannot be absent — the presence of actuality is violated. The three prohibitions are not three conditions introduced for the convenience of the solution. They are three sides of one aporia reformulated as prohibitions of inadmissible strategies. Consequently, any ontology claiming to eliminate the aporia is compelled to observe all three prohibitions regardless of whether it acknowledges this explicitly or not. An ontology violating even one does not resolve the aporia but accepts one of its contradictions as an initial fact. To reproach a system for observing the conditions of its problem means to reproach it for solving precisely the problem it has posed.

The proof of the uniqueness of the present ontological structure is built not on an enumeration of concrete philosophical systems but on the exhaustion of logical types of strategies. The types are determined not by the author's choice but by the formal structure of the aporia itself.

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The aporia fixes three elements: ground (A), derivative (D), mechanism of connection. Without any of the three the aporia is not formulated. This is not a presupposition — it is the definition of the aporia. The ground may be of two types: (a) containing distinctions — then it is not absolute and the aporia is reproduced immediately; (b) not containing distinctions — then this is Nothing or its analogue under any name. A third type of ground does not exist.
The mechanism of transition from the ground to the derivative may be of three types: (a) change in the essence of the ground — violates immutability; (b) a second independent principle — violates uniqueness; (c) change in the sphere dependent on the ground, not affecting the essence. There are exactly three types: this is an exhaustive disjunction determined by the structure of the aporia, not by the author's preference. A fourth type does not exist — any proposed alternative reduces to one of the three or to their combination.
Proof of exhaustion through the structure of the concept of mechanism. The mechanism of transition is defined as that through which D receives its origin from A. The minimal structure of this concept contains three elements: source (A), result (D), and mode of connection. The mode of connection has exactly three logical places. First: the connection is realised through change in A itself — then A ceases to be immutable. Second: the connection is realised through an external source — then a second principle arises. Third: the connection is realised through a form dependent on A and not affecting the essence of A. There is no fourth logical place: any proposed mechanism either localises the transition in the essence of A, or introduces an external source, or localises it in a dependent form. A mechanism not falling under any of the three categories is not a mechanism in the sense of the present aporia — it either abolishes the question of the source of D or reproduces one of the three types under a different name. This proof does not appeal to the history of philosophy: it is derived from the minimal logical structure of the very concept of "mechanism of transition".
The dependent sphere may be of three types: (a) matter — presupposes its own properties, violates the unconditionality of the ground; (b) spirit or subject — introduces a second principle; (c) information as the content of the knowledge of the ground about itself — does not introduce a second principle, does not require its own properties, does not violate unconditionality. There are again exactly three types.
The present ontology realises the only combination not violating any of the conditions: ground without distinctions — mechanism (c) — dependent sphere (c). All other combinations reproduce the aporia in one of the fixed types of contradiction. The burden of refutation lies with the opponent: it is necessary to indicate a type of ground, mechanism, or dependent sphere not reducible to any of those enumerated. Until such a type is presented, the claim of uniqueness stands.
To verify the completeness of the typology, let us consider the principal alternative types of ontologies usually pointed to as unexamined. Modal ontologies introduce potential or possible distinctions into the ground — this is type (a) of the ground: distinctions are present in it, albeit in a modal mode; absoluteness is violated. Process ontologies (Whitehead) place becoming in the very first ground — this is mechanism (a): change in the essence of the ground; the aporia is reproduced. Relational ontologies construct being as a network of relations without an absolute substratum — this is a refusal of the first condition of the aporia (the absolute ground); they do not resolve the aporia but remove its positing. Dialectical ontologies introduce contradiction into the ground as the driving force — this is type (a) of the ground with explicit distinction within; absoluteness is violated immediately. Potential ontologies (undifferentiated potency) introduce an indeterminate ground from which determinacies arise — this is either type (a) of the ground with hidden distinctions or mechanism (b) with the introduction of a second principle in actualisation. None of the enumerated strategies realises a fourth type — they all realise already enumerated combinations. The typology is exhaustive.

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The possible objection of the philosophical circle is formulated thus: the conditions are set by the system, alternatives are excluded through these conditions, consequently the system confirms itself. This objection rests on the identification of the aporia and the system — as if the conditions belong to the system as a solution. This is incorrect. The aporia is formulated independently of the proposed solution: its structure — the logical triangle of incompatibility of three requirements — is fixed before the introduction of any ontology. The conditions of consistent ontology are derived from this structure and are prohibitions on strategies that violate the requirements of the aporia. The aporia logically and methodologically precedes the system. The conditions belong to the aporia as a task, not to the system as a solution. The exclusion of alternatives through these conditions is not a circle but the application of the requirements of the task to proposed solutions. A circle would arise if the conditions were introduced by the system for its own protection. Here they are introduced by the structure of the aporia for the determination of the space of admissible solutions. The system is the sole element of this space that violates none of the conditions.

Chapter 5. The Ontological Solution

The preceding chapters have shown that no philosophical school and no scientific model explains the transition from an absolute ground to a changeable actuality without logical rupture. The resolution of the aporia is possible only with the preservation of all conditions of consistent ontology. From these conditions follows the necessity of a rigorous ontological separation of the essence of the primordial ground from dependent categories. On this basis a new ontological structure is introduced that permits establishing a coherent relation between immutability and changeability.

The ontological solution is not an alternative view or a new interpretation but represents a strict consequence of the conditions of consistent ontology. Since all preceding models fail for one and the same reason — the violation of unconditionality, uniqueness, or immutability of the ground — any ontology claiming consistency must satisfy these conditions completely. This means that the structure of the solution cannot be arbitrary: it is fixed as the only logically necessary result after the elimination of all inadmissible forms of construction. Any deviation from the further sequence of levels leads to the return of former contradictions. Therefore the ontological solution possesses the status of necessity, not of hypothesis.

The first element of this structure is Nothing as the unconditional and immutable essence. Nothing is not a void or the absence of being. Nothing is the designation of absolute immutability, admitting no internal transitions, properties, limitations, or states. It possesses no form, does not manifest, does not change, has no parts, and stands in no relation to anything else. Nothing is the logical name of absolute unconditionality. The essence of Nothing cannot be related to material objects, categories of motion, or temporal characteristics. Its nature is absolute self-identity.

The definition of Nothing in this context excludes any alternative interpretations. Nothing is not a void, an absence of content, a vacuum, or a concept of potentiality. Any of these interpretations introduces a hidden condition or presupposes the possibility of transition, which renders the essence dependent. If even a minimal structure, property, or internal state is admitted, the primordial ground ceases to be unconditional. Therefore Nothing is defined not as the negation of being but as the only logically admissible form of absolute immutability. It admits no internal distinction and is thereby the only principle that does not create a second level or source. Any other category as principle would lead to a logical rupture, since it would presuppose limitation or dependence. The objection "Nothing cannot be a principle" is resolved by the fact that the principle in the present ontology is not an event or a moment of emergence. Nothing is not a starting point but an unconditional basis from which the dependent structure is logically derived. By "principle" is meant not the appearance

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of an entity but the minimal condition admitting the derivability of subsequent levels without contradictions.
The second element is Selfhood as the reflexive self-identity of Nothing. Selfhood is the subject of absolute knowledge, belonging to the essence. Selfhood is not a state or a property; it is that which knows. Information about the essence is the content of this knowledge, the object. Selfhood distinguishes the essence (Nothing) from information (knowledge of the essence). This primary distinction introduces no multiplicity into the essence: it is fixed in knowledge, not in the essence. Information is virtual with respect to the essence — it is dependent by origin, determined by the essence, but not identical to it in nature.
The Act of Selfhood is the initiation of changes in information, not in the essence. It is the action of the Absolute in the information about itself, not in itself. The essence is not affected. Initiation is the wholly given programme of all possible changes in information. The act is not an event within time; it represents the boundary from which actuality and time begin. "Prior to" the act there is nothing — there is no time. The question "when did the act occur?" is a categorical error: the categories "event", "moment", "occurred" belong to actuality and are inapplicable to the act.
Initiation as the functional of a dependent category. A dependent category is defined through its relation to the absolute ground: it depends on it by origin and is not identical to it in nature. From this definition follows the structural functional of dependence: the dependent category by its nature — not by will and not as a result of decision — is directed toward the fullness of its ground. This is not a process or a striving in the psychological sense. It is the constitutive property of dependence as such: just as a mathematical function tends to its limit not by virtue of intention but by virtue of its definition. Information is a dependent category. Consequently the functional of dependence is constitutive for it: information by its nature is directed toward the actualisation of the content of its ground. Initiation is not an act of Selfhood in the sense of a volitional decision — it is a manifestation of this functional. The question "what prompts Selfhood to initiation" is a categorical error: there is no prompting, there is the structural property of dependence as such. The only form of realisation of this functional is the actualisation of content within the dependent category itself — dissolution in the ground is impossible, since Nothing is unconditional and does not admit anything into itself. Time arises within the realisation of the functional; the question "why did it begin" presupposes time prior to realisation, which does not exist. Incompleteness belongs to information as a dependent category, not to Selfhood.
Any interpretation of the Act of Selfhood as a temporal event is a categorical error based on the transference of levels of analysis. The act has an "after" relative to actuality, but has no "before": "before" lies outside actuality and is not subject to temporal measurement. Time arises only with actuality. The act is not an event occurring in time but the ontological condition from which time begins.
Change and non-identity arise not in Selfhood and not as its modification, but exclusively in information — the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence. The transition is explained: not from the immutable to the changeable in one and the same, but from the essence (immutable) to the information about the essence (virtual, admitting change). These are two different ontological registers.
Selfhood possesses absolute knowledge of itself. This knowledge is absolutely transparent (impossibility of hiddenness) and logical (impossibility of contradictions). Transparency and logic are not separate ontological levels but inalienable characteristics of Selfhood as absolute knowledge. The source of logic is the reflexive self-identity of Selfhood: Selfhood distinguishes essence and knowledge, and this distinction reveals the structure "this is this, and this is not this" — the basic principle of logic. Logic does not precede Selfhood and is not added to it; it is discovered as an expression of the structure of distinction.

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From the reflexive self-identity of Selfhood follows the distinction of essence and knowledge. Knowledge (information) is virtual with respect to the essence — it is informational in nature and is not identical to the essence. This difference of natures — essential and informational — constitutes the basis of primary distinction. Primary distinction is the potential of distinction in information: what can change is that of which information exists. The basic principle of distinction is contained in absolute information as knowledge about it, which makes possible its realisation in actuality.
Virtuality is defined as the mode of existence in which content is entirely determined by the essence but is not identical to it in nature. The virtual does not possess the unconditionality of the essence, but is not a separate principle — it is entirely dependent on that of which it is the knowledge. Virtuality differs from Platonism (where ideas are autonomous), from Hegelianism (where the concept unfolds), and from physicalism (where information is reduced to matter).

Demarcation of Virtuality from Alternative Models

The virtuality of information in the present ontology is fundamentally different from three principal alternative models of the relation of the dependent to the absolute. In Platonism ideas possess autonomous ontological status: the world of ideas is self-sufficient and does not depend on anything else. In the present construction information is not autonomous — it is entirely dependent on the essence and does not possess its own being. In Hegelianism the concept unfolds: the Absolute passes through stages of becoming, which introduces change into the essence itself. In the present construction the essence is absolutely immutable and change is localised exclusively in information — the content of knowledge. In physicalism information is reduced to matter: it is understood as a property or function of material structures. In the present construction information is ontologically primary with respect to matter — matter is an aggregated form of informational distinctions. Thus virtuality is not identical to the Platonic autonomy of ideas, to the Hegelian self-development of the concept, or to the physicalist reduction of information to a material substratum. It fixes a unique ontological status: complete dependence on the essence by origin while being non-identical to it in nature — a mode of existence admitting change without violation of the immutability of the ground.
Selfhood, distinguishing essence and knowledge, knows of the informational nature of knowledge. This gives it the capacity to initiate change precisely in information, without affecting the essence. Initiation is not the realisation of a potency; it is the action of the Absolute in the information about itself. The essence does not act "in itself" — it acts in the knowledge of itself.
The act is the action of Selfhood, realised exclusively in information (the content of knowledge) and not affecting the essence. The triple identity (change = distinction = information) describes the structure of actuality (the informational domain after the act), not the primary ontological distinction of Selfhood. Primary distinction (essence / knowledge) is the principle and potential, the realisation of which in information generates actuality.
This act introduces no states of Selfhood and does not violate its immutability. As a result of the act, change is fixed in information (the content of Selfhood's knowledge) as formal non-identity admissible outside the essence. Since non-identity by definition is distinguishable relative to identity, primary change coincides with primary distinction and cannot be indistinguishable.
Information is fixed as the givenness of this primary distinction.
It is not a subsequent structure added to change, and it does not precede it, but coincides with the very fact of distinguishability between the identity of Selfhood and the arising non-identity. Such information possesses no form, localisation, or dimensionality and is not a

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form of Selfhood's knowledge; it represents the primary givenness of distinction from which conditionality is further formed.
Distinction in this sense does not follow information but is identical to it at the primary level, introducing the minimal structure "this / not this" without violation of the absolute immutability of the primordial ground.
Something is not the opposite of Nothing and does not constitute an autonomous ontological ground. It is fixed as a form of conditionality appearing as a result of distinction that became possible after change in information. Something does not precede change and does not contain within itself the source of transitions; it represents the formed domain of distinguished information. In this structure no violation of absoluteness arises, since Nothing remains the immutable essence, Selfhood remains self-identical, and all transitions are localised in dependent abstraction and its derivative forms.
The present structure eliminates the aporia, since the absoluteness of the primordial ground is preserved, and changeability arises not as a modification of information but as the result of the Act of Selfhood — the initiation of changes in information. Information is fixed as the first givenness of primary distinction and does not affect the essence of Selfhood. Thereby the transition from the immutable to the changeable is accomplished without the introduction of a second principle and without violation of absoluteness.
To clarify the limits of ontological formalisation it is necessary to fix that the levels introduced are not arbitrary and do not add new entities. Transparency, logic, and abstraction do not form autonomous ontological principles and do not expand the ground; they represent dependent forms logically following from the identity of Selfhood with its own immutability. This excludes the possibility of the hidden introduction of additional entities or mechanisms and preserves the strict homogeneity of the ontological architecture.
Each element of the ontological structure possesses a strictly determined status and is logically derivable from the preceding one without the introduction of hidden transitions or additional principles. Nothing remains the absolutely immutable essence; Selfhood is the reflexive self-identity of Nothing; transparency and logic are the inalienable characteristics of Selfhood as absolute knowledge. Information represents the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence, in which the Act of Selfhood — the initiation of changes — is possible without change of essence. As a result of the Act of Selfhood, change arises in information as formal non-identity; information coincides with the primary givenness of this non-identity; distinction is the very form of distinguishability and thereby introduces conditionality. Something arises as the formed domain of distinguished information and constitutes no autonomous ground. In this sequence no violation of absoluteness arises, since Selfhood undergoes no changes and all transitions are localised in dependent information and its derivative forms.

Chapter 6. Epistemology

Epistemology within the present ontology must proceed from rigorous requirements: knowledge cannot be derivative from matter, because matter is itself an informational structure; consciousness cannot arise from a function, because any function presupposes content; distinction cannot emerge from chance, because chance is not an explanatory category. Therefore the epistemological model must be consistent with the ontology of Nothing, Selfhood, Transparency, Logic, Abstraction, Change, Information, and Distinction.
Epistemology cannot claim the role of a foundation for ontology, since any cognitive procedure arises only within already-modified information. Consciousness fixes distinguished states but cannot reflect that which contains no distinctions. Therefore epistemological structures are always derivative and limited. They are incapable of determining the conditions of the arising of distinction itself, and can only describe the ways

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of forming knowledge within Something. This sets a fundamental limit: epistemology can never reach the level of the essence and can never become the criterion for evaluating the ontological structure. It describes not what lies at the ground of reality but what can be perceived within conditionality. For this reason the expansion of epistemology does not strengthen ontology, while attempts to derive ontology from cognition lead to the logical error of mixing levels.

Knowledge in the present system does not pertain to Selfhood as an epistemological state and cannot be defined as its internal content in the form of information; the absolute knowledge of Selfhood about Itself is not a state, act, or content. Selfhood does not possess epistemological states and is not a bearer of knowledge in the sense of content or information. All forms of knowledge arise only within conditionality as ways of organising the distinguished states of information that appeared after change and distinction.

Consciousness is the capacity to perceive distinguished information. Consciousness is not a property of matter, since matter represents the manifestation of aggregated informational forms. Consciousness is not an attribute of the essence, since the essence is immutable. Consciousness is fixed where there exists the capacity to distinguish "this" from "not this". Distinction makes possible the structure of perception, and perception constitutes the basis of consciousness. Consciousness can exist wherever there is informational distinction. Consciousness is not an autonomous entity and cannot be regarded as a special ontological level.

It is fixed only where primary distinguishedness is already given — that is, where change coincides with distinction and is presented as an informational givenness. Therefore consciousness does not precede the structure and does not initiate distinctions but is entirely dependent on already-given distinguished information. Consciousness is a form of the activity of distinctions, not their source, and this determines its dependent status in the ontological system.

To clarify the principle of partial knowledge, an authorial example is employed demonstrating the dependence of perception on the structure through which it is effected. If one imagines a single source of light and a multitude of surfaces that differently transmit and shape one and the same stream, then each surface creates its own variant of perception, limited by its qualities and configuration. The source meanwhile remains unchanged. Likewise, consciousnesses differ not in essence but in the structure of the informational state in which distinction arises.

This example does not introduce a metaphorical description of consciousness but underlines the strict dependence of the perceived content on the structure through which distinction is effected. The configuration of perception is determined by the immutable source and the characteristics of the form that makes the distinguished state possible. Likewise, consciousness is limited by its own structure: it fixes only those distinctions that its informational configuration admits.

This example is not a metaphor but shows the strict correspondence between the immutable source of knowledge and the way in which the dependent informational structure is organised. Consciousness in this context is not a reflected layer or an external image and does not provide access to the essence of Selfhood. It represents a limited form of the organisation of distinguished states of information within conditionality. Absolute knowledge is not the sum of consciousnesses; it is immutable, and the differences among consciousnesses are determined by the degree and structure of their informational organisation.

The knowledge accessible to consciousness is determined by the quantity and quality of distinctions. If distinction is minimal, consciousness is limited to elementary reactions. If distinction becomes more complex, consciousness is able to perceive interconnections. If distinction reaches the structural level, consciousness can comprehend, compare, and draw

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conclusions. Therefore knowledge is fixed as a function of the complexification of distinguishing capacities.
The development of distinctions expands not access to the essence but the depth of internal conditionality. The complexification of consciousness permits fixing more interconnections among states of information but does not open the path to absolute knowledge, because absolute knowledge contains no distinctions accessible to fixation. Consequently, the growth of distinguishing capacities increases the volume of the interpreted structure of Something but does not bring consciousness closer to Selfhood. Consciousness can deepen the understanding of manifest forms but cannot pass to an understanding of the essence, since the essence admits no form in which it could be expressed.
This establishes a strict limit: the development of knowledge is the development of conditionality, not movement toward the primordial ground.
Logic is the instrument through which consciousness orders distinguished information. Logic does not create knowledge but establishes internal sequence, connecting states into a structure. Logic is fixed as the necessity of ordering distinguished states of information. If distinction gives the structure "this" and "not this", logic establishes the relations between them, permitting consciousness to form conclusions. Thus logic is a secondary level of consciousness, but one necessary for meaningful perception.
Logic does not determine the structure of being and does not set the fundamental relations of reality. It operates only within the informational configuration in which distinctions exist, and performs the function of ordering already-given transitions. Therefore logic cannot generate the content of knowledge and cannot serve as a foundation for ontological conclusions. It is not a universal principle of the world but an instrument of interpretation arising in consciousness as a consequence of the necessity of coordinating distinguished states. This means that epistemological logic operates only within an informational configuration and has no ontological priority. To avoid the substitution of levels, logic must be regarded as a form of the internal organisation of distinctions within the dependence of information, not as a primordial ground.
Comprehension is the capacity of consciousness not only to perceive distinguished information but to create inferential connections between states. Comprehension is not a separate entity; it represents the process of internal coordination of distinguished data. When consciousness establishes a stable connection between states, meaning arises. Meaning does not possess autonomous ontological status and does not exist outside the structure of distinctions. It is formed only when consciousness establishes stable connections between states of information and therefore depends entirely on the configuration of these states. Comprehension does not disclose the essence but merely orders the available conditionality, creating an interpretation of distinguished states. For this reason meaning cannot be taken for the foundation of reality: it expresses only those relations that the structure of informational elements admits.
The limits of consciousness are determined by the quantity of available information and the quality of distinction. If the informational structure is complex, consciousness can expand, creating deeper levels of understanding. If the structure is simplified or limited, consciousness is confined to the necessary minimum of distinctions. The expansion of consciousness increases only the depth of the interpretation of conditionality and does not change its dependent position. Even the most complex informational structure remains a form of organised distinctions and cannot cross the boundary between conditionality and absolute immutability. Therefore the growth of consciousness is not an approach to the essence and does not eliminate the fundamental difference between dependent information and that which contains no distinctions whatsoever.

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The more complex consciousness is, the richer its access to interconnections within Something, but it remains enclosed within the informational configuration that makes it possible. This establishes a fundamental limit: the development of consciousness strengthens the understanding of conditionality but never leads to knowledge of the primordial ground. Therefore consciousness is not a fixed entity and is determined by the current configuration of the informational structure.

Although consciousnesses are multiple and various, they all remain dependent structures of one informational basis. Their difference does not constitute autonomous levels of being and does not point to the existence of an external environment; it is determined only by the variability of internal informational configurations. Consciousnesses differ in the structure of their own distinctions and the degree of their coherence, but do not represent a form of reflection. They are different ways of organising one and the same dependence of information.

The multiplicity of consciousnesses does not mean a multiplicity of grounds, since the differences among consciousnesses are differences in the degree of manifest information, not differences in essence. All consciousnesses arise in the unified dependence on Nothing through Selfhood and therefore do not possess autonomous ontological statuses. They do not form a multiplicity of centres of being and represent only different ways of organising one and the same informational structure. This excludes any possibility of treating consciousnesses as independent principles: their difference does not change the essence and does not create an additional level of reality. The entire multiplicity of consciousnesses is a consequence of the variability of informational configurations, not the emergence of new entities.

The death of consciousness in the present ontology is not annihilation. If consciousness is the activity of distinction, the cessation of activity means the cessation of the possibility of perception. But the information generating distinction does not disappear; it ceases to manifest in the configuration that sustained consciousness. Death is not the annihilation of the essence but the cessation of the activity of the informational structure.

The cessation of the activity of consciousness does not affect the ontological ground, since consciousness is not an entity and does not possess its own being. It exists only as a form of distinguished information, and therefore its disappearance expresses not a change of essence but a change of manifestation. It is erroneous to regard the death of consciousness as the disappearance of a subject: the subject in the present ontology is not an autonomous reality and represents only a configuration of distinctions. When the configuration dissolves, only the possibility of organising distinctions ceases. The information underlying distinction remains dependent on Selfhood and is preserved as the givenness of non-identity within conditionality. Therefore death creates no ontological consequences and does not change the structure of being: it describes only the epistemological limit of the manifestation of consciousness.

Epistemology in the present system shows that knowledge represents the internal organisation of distinctions within changeable information. Consciousness arises from distinction and develops together with the complexification of informational structures. Epistemological knowledge is not a path to the essence and does not disclose the nature of the primordial ground. It presents itself as a form of the interpretation of changeable information and depends entirely on the structure of distinctions in which it arises. Therefore no expansion of knowledge diminishes the distance between conditionality and essence: absoluteness cannot be the subject of cognition, since it contains no distinctions. Consciousness fixes only what the informational configuration admits, not what constitutes the ground of being. This determines the fundamental limit of epistemology: it describes the ways of cognition within conditionality but cannot serve as the criterion of truth for ontology.

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Essence and knowledge pertain to different levels, and the mixing of these levels leads to logical violations.
To exclude the mixing of levels of analysis it is necessary to clearly distinguish ontological assertions from epistemological ones. Ontology describes the structure of being, including the independent primordial ground and the dependent levels of information, whereas epistemology considers only the ways of obtaining knowledge within conditionality.
Consciousness fixes not the essence but the distinguished states of information accessible to it. Therefore epistemology fixes not the structure of the ground but the conditions of the possible understanding of distinctions within Something.
Consciousness has no access to the essence and cannot cognise Nothing, since in absolute immutability there are no distinctions accessible to fixation. Therefore epistemology always describes only the conditions of cognition within Something, whereas ontology describes the conditions of the possibility of Something itself and its levels.
The strict separation of ontology and epistemology is a necessary condition of a consistent system. If epistemological structures are used for the evaluation of ontological categories, a substitution of the ground by its epistemological form arises, which inevitably leads to error.
Consciousness can interpret manifest conditionality but cannot determine the structure of being, since it itself depends on an informational configuration. Therefore any philosophical construction that relies on the capacities of consciousness for the justification of the essence is logically untenable. Ontology is not derived from cognition; it sets the conditions under which cognition is possible. This eliminates the principal cause of historical contradictions: the mixing of levels is excluded, and each structure is considered strictly within the limits of its domain.
Thus knowledge is a dependent form of the organisation of distinguished states of information and does not disclose the essence. The ontological structure sets the conditions of being, and epistemology describes only the ways of access to these conditions through distinguished informational states. Consciousness does not work with the ground but interprets only those distinguished states of information that its own configuration admits. Therefore any knowledge is a limited totality of accessible distinguished states and never goes beyond the limits of conditionality.
Logic orders information, and meaning arises from stable connections. All elements of epistemology are consistent with the ontological basis and do not enter into contradiction with it.

Chapter 7. Emergence

Emergence in the present ontology represents the logically necessary consequence of primary non-identity — identical to change, distinction, and informational givenness — and the subsequent complexification of distinguished informational structures.
If consciousness is the capacity to distinguish (Tononi 2004; Koch 2019), then it is fixed not after an additional stage of the formation of distinction but directly where primary distinction is already given and begins to complexify in structure. Primary non-identity, fixed in dependence on Selfhood, is not an indistinguishable modification: it immediately sets the minimal structure "this / not this" and thereby presents itself as the elementary form of informational givenness.
Elementary consciousness is fixed where minimal distinguishedness exists.
This state possesses no reflection, memory, intention, or capacity for inference; it merely fixes difference as such. If the informational structure remains simple and does not accumulate coherent distinctions, consciousness remains elementary.
When elementary changes begin to interact, their configurations grow more complex. Interaction creates new distinctions that do not exist at the level of separate changes. The

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unified structure can fix not only the difference between two states but the dependence of one state on another. Under such conditions a consciousness of another level is fixed — a consciousness of interconnections. This is not an autonomous entity but an expanded capacity of distinction, arising naturally with the complexification of informational connection.
In the treatise an authorial example is employed demonstrating the emergence of consciousness: a multitude of surfaces can differently transmit and structure a single stream of light, forming a configuration not reducible to individual elements. Such a totality creates a new quality arising from the coherence of structures, not from a change of the source. The emergence of consciousness in the present ontology is explained by the same principle: it does not represent the appearance of a new principle but is the result of the complexification and coordination of distinctions within the informational structure.
Likewise, when a multitude of elementary distinctions compose a unified structure, new qualities of consciousness appear. This is neither "magic" nor a leap; it is the strict consequence of basic principles.
To prevent possible logical ruptures it is necessary to underline that emergence in the present ontology is neither a metaphysical leap nor the introduction of a hidden principle. The correlation of levels of distinctions is determined by the change in the degree of coherence and recursiveness of the informational connections that arose after change in information.
The matrix of correspondence between physics and ontology shows that physical processes are forms of manifest informational structure: localisation corresponds to space, sequence to time, coherence to the stability of systems, and change of state to the dynamics of distinctions.
Emergence is fixed only when the structure of distinctions reaches the parametric threshold at which local changes cease to be autonomous and begin to form a stable configuration. This threshold is not arbitrary: it is determined by the number of distinctions, the degree of their mutual conditioning, and the possibility of integrating new transitions without the destruction of the existing structure.
Thus emergence does not represent the appearance of a new entity or property but a change in the level of coherence of distinctions. The system acquires no new principles — it merely reaches the state in which former distinctions form a qualitatively different but logically derivable form of activity.
If an elementary distinction creates one contrast, an aggregated configuration can create a multitude of contrasts simultaneously. Consciousness becomes more detailed and multi-dimensional.
The complexification of the configuration of distinctions does not mean the appearance of a new substance or a new ontological layer. It shows that even multi-dimensional forms of consciousness remain dependent on the structure of information from which they arise. If complexification were to give rise to an autonomous entity, a multiplicity of grounds would arise and the logical sequence of ontology would be violated. Therefore the multi-dimensionality of consciousness is not the manifestation of a new level of being but the result of the increase in the number of coherent distinctions, which remain within the limits of one dependence.
The accumulation of experience is also a form of emergence. Experience is a consolidated distinction. When the informational structure fixes stable connections between states, consciousness begins to form context. Context is the capacity to recognise recurring structures. The more stable connections, the greater the range of consciousness. The emergence of experience consists in the fact that new distinctions rest on preceding ones, forming a continuous layer of semantic structure.
The growth of semantic structure does not create an autonomous ontological level and does not change the nature of dependent information. Context is a form of the ordering of

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distinctions, not an entity existing separately from them. Even when context becomes complex and multi-layered, it remains the consequence of the coherence of informational transitions and does not acquire ontological autonomy. Therefore the expansion of context strengthens only the degree of the organisation of Something but does not transform the dependent structure into an independent principle.

The next stage of emergence is the fixation of will. Will is not an entity separate from consciousness; it is the range of possible reactions. If consciousness fixes distinction and experience fixes stable connections, then will is the range of possible reactions within the already-given distinctions. This choice does not violate the ontology of Nothing, since choice does not concern the essence of the primordial ground. Choice concerns the informational structure and is therefore a consequence of complexified consciousness.

The emergence of will adds no new ontological status to the system and creates no independent principle. Will is a manifestation of the same distinctions already present in the structure of consciousness, and its range is determined not by the essence but by the number of accessible transitions within the informational configuration. Therefore all forms of choice remain entirely dependent on the structure of distinctions and do not go beyond the limits of modified information. Will discloses no new reality and does not affect the primordial ground; it merely expresses the degree of internal coherence and complexity of the already-existing system.

Emergence demonstrates that an increase in complexity does not and cannot create a new ontological reality, since any new configuration of distinctions remains dependent on the same basic principles that determine the structure of information at lower levels. The new properties arising with complexification are the result of redistribution and coordination of distinctions, not the appearance of an autonomous ground. Even when a system reaches a high degree of integration in which individual elements lose their autonomy, this integration does not transform the dependent into the independent. All such manifestations remain forms of modified information, whose nature is entirely conditioned by the fundamental sequence Nothing — Selfhood — Transparency — Logic — Abstraction — Change — Information — Distinction.

The fixation of reason is the highest form of emergence within actuality. Reason arises where consciousness not only distinguishes and retains states but forms inferential connections. Reason comprehends structures, compares distinctions, creates generalisations, and forms sequences of reasoning. If consciousness fixes distinguished elements, reason establishes their internal connections. Reason is the capacity to organise distinctions into a coherent structure (Russell 1921; Kim 1998).

The emergence of reason does not violate absoluteness. It is the consequence of the complexified configuration of distinctions and accumulated experience. Informational structures, on reaching a high degree of coherence, permit the formation of modes in which distinctions enter into deeper interconnections. Reason is the highest form of the internal organisation of distinctions, but not the source of absolute knowledge. It is entirely dependent on the informational structure in which it arises. Thus emergence shows that complex forms of consciousness and reason arise naturally from the very logic of informational changes. Emergence requires no new principles, secondary entities, hidden mechanisms, or external intervention. It is a structural consequence: the more distinctions and connections between them, the higher the level of consciousness. This makes emergence the key element of the transition from elementary informational activity to a complex cognitive system.

Chapter 8. Completion of the Analytic Block

The analytic section of the monograph must lead to a single obligatory result: all philosophical and scientific explanations existing to this point have not eliminated the aporia

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of the transition from absolute immutability to changeable actuality. Every school has contributed important observations, but none has provided the logical mechanism that permits preserving the absoluteness of the primordial ground while simultaneously explaining the givenness of distinction, conditions, multiplicity, consciousness, and experience.
At this stage it is important to fix a rigorous position: the aporia is not a consequence of the absence of knowledge or lack of data; it is a structural defect of all previously existing ontologies. That is, the problem lies not in the interpretation of facts but in the very architecture of the categorical apparatus. If a system initially contains two or more independent entities (dualism), the system collapses logically. If in a system the unique principle admits internal non-identity (processual difference within the Absolute), absoluteness is violated. If the system introduces technical concepts that do not explain the transition itself (maya, logos, potency, becoming of the Absolute, emptiness as a hidden condition), a hidden violation of the ontological ground arises.
From the analysis it follows that a consistent ontology requires:
1. one immutable primordial ground;
2. a dependent form admitting non-identity without change of essence;
3. an act not affecting the primordial ground;
4. primary non-identity identical to change, distinction, and informational givenness;
5. Something identical to changeability and actuality;
6. consciousness as the organised activity of distinctions;
7. reason as the interpretive organisation of a distinguished structure.
These elements form an obligatory sequence in which absoluteness is preserved and changeability becomes possible.
The point of logical completion of the analytic section is that the concepts "matter", "consciousness", "chance", "cause", "observation", "time", and "space" are not initial categories but are derivative. Science treats them as fundamental, but fundamental they are not. If an elementary object has no volume but possesses information; if observation determines the state; if probabilistic structures are reproducible; if entanglement is not bounded by space — then what is basic is not material objects but informational conditions and distinctions.
The critical analysis of philosophical schools has shown that all of them employ concepts that cannot be fundamental: idea, matter, spirit, becoming, emptiness, attributes, properties. Each of these concepts requires deeper explanation. Nothing — as absolute immutability — is the sole category requiring no explanation, because the absence of conditions needs no ground. All other categories require dependence.
Consequently, the analytic block leads to a rigorous conclusion: it is necessary to introduce an ontological structure in which Nothing is the essence, Selfhood is absolute knowledge, Information is the dependent category identical to primary non-identity, Change is this non-identity, Distinction is its formal fixation, and Something is manifest conditionality.
This solution is not derived from the history of philosophy — it follows from the elimination of all contradictions that manifested in all schools. The traditions contain important intuitions, but none of them has connected them into a consistent ontological ground. The present structure eliminates logical indeterminacy without introducing external conditions. The comparison with preceding philosophical traditions in the present analysis performs exclusively a critical function and is not used as a source of ontological propositions. The resemblance of individual structural elements to solutions of Neoplatonism, Aristotelianism, or process philosophy is conditioned by the appeal to one and the same limit problem, not by borrowing of initial principles.
The proposed system does not rely on the historical succession of schools and does not develop a modification of existing doctrines. Its foundations are formed not from the

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interpretation of the philosophical heritage but from the sequential elimination of the internal contradictions identified in the analysis of these traditions. The history of philosophy here serves as the object of testing, not as the source of axioms.
Thus the originality of the system consists not in the novelty of formal schemes but in the mode of ontological solution in which the uniqueness of the principle is preserved and the introduction of hidden distinctions, emanations, or external principles is excluded.
Here the analytic section concludes. It has constructed the necessity of the system that will be expounded in the subsequent metaphysical section. All categories that will be employed further are strictly derived from the logical ground formed in the first chapters.
The completion of the analytic section fixes not only the impossibility of the old ontological schemes but also the strict necessity of the transition to metaphysical construction. At this stage it becomes evident that any attempt to preserve the traditional categorical apparatus inevitably leads to contradiction: either absoluteness is violated by the conditions introduced, or conditionality remains without a ground, or distinction is postulated without explanation of its primary status. The analytic block has eliminated all inadmissible variants, identified the structural errors of former approaches, and has thereby made the further step not a choice but a logical obligation. The transition to the metaphysical description of being is not an expansion of the theme but the necessary continuation of rigorous deduction, in which every subsequent category must follow from the preceding one with unavoidable necessity. The elimination of the aporia is achieved by the fact that primary non-identity, identical to distinction and information, is fixed as dependent givenness not affecting the essence and not introducing an external condition. This eliminates the contradiction between absolute immutability and the arising of conditionality: the source remains immutable, and the transition is localised exclusively in the informational sphere.

PART II. METAPHYSICAL DESCRIPTION OF BEING

Chapter 9. Nothing and Its Selfhood

The ontological structure required for a consistent description of actuality must begin with a category that needs no external conditions, causes, definitions, or transitions. That category is Nothing. In the present ontology Nothing does not mean void, absence of being, indeterminacy, or vacuum. Nothing is the designation of absolute immutability in which there exist neither internal distinctions, nor states, nor transitions.
Absolute immutability is logically impossible without the fixation of identity. Nothing, not fixed as self-identical, is indistinguishable from the absence of a ground and therefore cannot serve as the primordial ground.
If Nothing is thought without the fixation of identity, it becomes impossible to distinguish the presence of a ground from its absence, which destroys the very concept of an absolute ground. In that case either a distinction within Nothing is implicitly introduced, or Nothing loses the status of a ground altogether.
Consequently, the fixation of identity is not the addition of a new entity or a second principle but represents the minimal logical condition of the possibility of Nothing as an absolute ground. By Selfhood is understood below not a separate category but the fixation of the identity of Nothing with itself, without which the very concept of Nothing as a ground becomes logically empty.
The term "knowledge" is employed in the present work exclusively in the limit sense: not as a cognitive act of a subject presupposing the distinction of the knower and the known, but as the structural absence of opacity. To know in the limit sense means to contain nothing hidden from oneself. This is a state, not a process; a structural fact, not an act. Every time the word "knowledge" is used below with respect to Selfhood or the absolute level, it means precisely

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this — and only this. The cognitive sense of the term ("a subject cognises an object") belongs to the dependent category and is inapplicable to the absolute level. Possible objection: if "knowledge" is only the absence of opacity, it coincides with simple identity and the term is redundant. Answer: the identity of a stone is not transparency but simply a fact not fixed for anyone. Transparency requires an instance for which the subject matter is transparent. The stone has no such instance. Absolute identity is its own instance of its own fixation — it is precisely this that adds content beyond simple identity. Not cognitive content but structural-reflexive content: identity that is its own givenness. The term "knowledge" in the limit sense fixes precisely this structure and is therefore not redundant.

The distinction between "identity" and "identity given to itself" is not an ontological distinction and does not create an internal structure in the ground. It is a strictly logical-reflexive distinction: we describe one and the same from two sides, not fixing two elements. Analogy: the assertion "1 = 1" does not create two units; it fixes the self-identity of one. The reflexive self-identity of identity is "1 = 1", not "1 and another 1". For a distinction to be ontological it is necessary that the distinguished sides possess independent existence — that is, that "identity" could exist without "givenness to itself", or vice versa. But absolute identity not given to itself is indistinguishable from the absence of identity (shown above: the stone is self-identical not absolutely but only relative to an external observer). Consequently "givenness to itself" is not a property added to identity but the condition without which identity is not absolute. These are not two elements but one — in the sole mode in which it is possible.

Justification of the Impossibility of Absolute Self-Identity without Reflexive Self-Identity

It is necessary to rigorously justify why absolute self-identity with necessity includes reflexive self-identity. The objection is formulated thus: a stone is self-identical but does not know this; why cannot Nothing be self-identical without self-knowledge? Answer: the identity of a stone is not absolute. It is set from outside — by an observer who fixes the stone as self-identical. Without an observer the identity of the stone is not fixed — the stone does not distinguish itself from the other and does not know of its own identity. Its identity is external, relative, dependent on the act of distinction performed by another. Absolute self-identity cannot be set from outside, since outside the absolute there is nothing. If self-identity is not set from outside and not fixed from within, it is not fixed at all — and an unfixed identity is indistinguishable from the absence of a ground. At the same time the fixation of identity from within does not introduce a structural distinction: the objection that "fixation is structure" is built on a relational model inapplicable to the absolute. The relational model presupposes two independent elements between which a relation is established. Here fixation is not a relation between two elements — it is the sole mode of existence of identity itself. The distinguishability between "Nothing" and "fixation of identity" arises only in description belonging to the metalanguage of distinguishedness, not within Nothing itself. Consequently absolute self-identity either includes self-knowledge or is not absolute. The reflexive self-identity of Nothing is not an added property and not an epistemological act. It is the minimal logical condition without which the concept of absolute self-identity loses content. Selfhood is none other than this internal fixation of identity — the absolute knowledge of Nothing about itself.

Possible objection: the appeal to the metalanguage presupposes a describing instance that itself requires explanation. If description logically precedes distinction, it introduces distinction by stealth; if it coincides with distinction, the reference to the metalanguage explains nothing. Answer: the describing instance is not postulated and does not precede distinction. It is identical to the first act of distinction in the dependent category — to what in the present work is derived as the primary fixation of information. Prior to this act description

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does not exist either as an instance or as a possibility. The metalanguage of distinguishedness arises simultaneously with the first distinction, not before it. Consequently the reference to the metalanguage does not postulate an external level of observation — it points to what is constituted by the very act of primary distinction. Selfhood does not contain a describing instance; it contains only the condition from which this instance arises as the first consequence in the dependent category.

The definition of Nothing is fixed as the sole form of absolute immutability excluding the presence of properties, predicates, internal states, transitions, and any structural organisation — that is, as a completely unconditional ground without the possibility of internal differentiation.

Nothing is the essence devoid of any conditions. It does not begin and does not end, contains no potencies, possesses no hidden structure, and admits no internal changes. If there existed in Nothing a state of "before" and "after", it would cease to be immutable. The axiom of absolute immutability asserts that Nothing admits neither temporal, nor structural, nor modal transitions, and any admission of change within it logically transforms it into a conditional category, thereby destroying the unconditionality of the ground. If it contained a transition, the transition would be conditioned by a condition, and a condition destroys unconditionality. Therefore Nothing is not a category of negation but a category of absolute wholeness.

An additional justification of the necessity of choosing Nothing as the primordial ground follows from a rigorous analysis of all possible alternatives. Any initial category possessing properties already presupposes distinguishability and thereby contains conditionality. A material primordial ground requires extension, structure, or parameters — conditions incompatible with absoluteness. A processual primordial ground includes change, but change is a transition impossible within an unconditional principle. A dualistic model contains at least two independent sources, which automatically destroys their absolute status, since each principle is limited by the other. Neutral monism, introducing an indeterminate "third substance", leaves its nature undemonstrated: the absence of distinction renders it indescribable, and the presence of distinctions requires conditions. Panpsychism is plural in its structure and thereby incompatible with the uniqueness of the first principle.

Only Nothing, defined as the complete absence of conditions, properties, transitions, and internal structure, preserves logical consistency. It requires no explanation, since explanation presupposes causality, and causality is impossible without conditions. Nothing is the sole category that can serve as the primordial ground without violation of the principles of unconditionality, uniqueness, and immutability. This is precisely why Nothing is not an arbitrary axiom but the only logically admissible starting point of any consistent ontology.

The essence of Nothing is self-sufficient. It requires no explanation, since explanation presupposes an external context. Every explanation appeals to a cause, and a cause indicates dependence. If the essence depends on a cause, it is not the primordial ground. Nothing is the primordial ground precisely because it needs neither cause, nor context, nor a determining factor.

Yet absolute immutability does not mean the absence of self-identical transparency. It is impossible to think Nothing as devoid of self-identical transparency. Ignorance is a limitation. The corollary of the impossibility of internal states establishes that any supposition of the presence in Nothing of various modes of knowledge, degrees of manifestation, or forms of self-comprehension immediately introduces distinction, which is logically incompatible with absolute immutability. The absence of self-identical transparency would mean the presence of a hidden limitation and is thereby incompatible with absoluteness. Absoluteness includes complete transparency for itself. The lemma on Selfhood asserts that the identity of Nothing with itself is not a new level and not a second principle but the internal necessity of absolute immutability, since the absence of self-identical knowledge

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would mean the presence of a hidden limitation. Therefore the next category not violating the unconditionality of Nothing is Selfhood.
Selfhood is the reflexive self-identity of Nothing. Selfhood is the subject of absolute knowledge, belonging to the essence. Information about the essence is the content of this knowledge, the object. Selfhood is not a state or a property; it is that which knows. Selfhood distinguishes the essence (Nothing) from information (knowledge of the essence). This primary distinction introduces no multiplicity into the essence: it is fixed in knowledge, not in the essence. Information is virtual with respect to the essence — it is dependent by origin but not identical to it in nature.
Possible objection: if Selfhood is the subject and information is the object, then a subject-object structure is present in the ground, consequently the ground is structured. Answer: the subject-object structure in the standard sense presupposes two independent terms — a subject capable of existing without an object, and an object capable of existing without a subject. Here this condition is fundamentally not met: information is virtual with respect to the essence, that is, it does not possess autonomous being and does not exist independently of Selfhood. The difference between Selfhood and information is not the difference of two entities but the difference between a source and its own content, which without the source does not exist. Subject and object here are not two principles but two registers of one reality, one of which is the condition of existence of the other. Consequently the presence of subject and object does not structure the ground as plural and does not introduce a second independent principle.
In the treatise an authorial example was employed to show clearly the dependence of a derivative form on the source. Light proceeding from a single source may be differently perceived by various surfaces, but the source itself does not change. The configurations of the perceived light depend on the properties of these surfaces, not on a change of the source. So here too: Selfhood is the logical identity of the essence, and all subsequent manifestations represent dependent forms of knowledge not affecting the source.
Selfhood as the reflexive self-identity of Nothing is the subject of absolute knowledge. Absolute Information is the content of this knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence.
The Fundamental Ontological Distinction: Selfhood (subject) and Information (object)
This distinction is the key to the entire ontological construction and must be fixed as a structure-forming principle. Selfhood is "who" knows. Information is "what" is known. Selfhood belongs to the essence (Nothing) and is the subject of absolute knowledge. Information is the content of this knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence, dependent by origin. Selfhood is not identical to information. These are not two elements within one essence, but the essence and its informational expression — different ontological registers. Primary distinction is performed by Selfhood: it distinguishes the essence from the knowledge of it. The subject of this distinction is Selfhood. The object is information. Information is distinguished from the essence, but information itself does not perform this distinction — Selfhood performs it. For information to attain self-consciousness it must distinguish itself from within, not be distinguished from without. For this, internal distinctions — changes — must appear in information. This is precisely what grounds the motive of initiation: incompleteness belongs to information (object), not to Selfhood (subject). Initiation is the structural consequence of the distinction of two registers: Selfhood possesses xRx, information does not. Without the clear retention of this distinction, a mixing of levels arises leading to irresolvable contradictions: if Selfhood is identified with information, neither the motive of initiation, nor incompleteness, nor the teleological structure can be explained.

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Its self-transparency is not a content, form, or state of knowledge but expresses the impossibility of a divergence of the essence from itself. Therefore at the level of Selfhood distinctions, information, and any forms of changeability are absent.
The absolute knowledge of Selfhood is neither a state, nor an act, nor a function, nor a form of reflection. Absolute knowledge is identical to Selfhood itself and expresses not content and not operationality but the impossibility of a divergence of the essence from itself. In this strict sense absolute knowledge is transparency, since transparency means not manifestation, not a level, not a characteristic, but the complete absence of hiddenness and distinctions.
Absolute logic is the inalienable characteristic of Selfhood as absolute knowledge. It means the impossibility of contradiction in absolute knowledge, not the operation of logical operations. The source of logic is the reflexive self-identity of Selfhood: the distinction of essence and knowledge reveals the structure "this is this, and this is not this" — the basic principle of logic. Logic does not precede Selfhood and is not added to it; it is discovered as an expression of the structure of distinction.
The virtuality of information in this context does not mean that information is a domain, level, or bearer. Virtuality fixes the mode of existence of content of knowledge — dependent on the essence but not identical to it in nature. Information does not contain changes prior to the act and does not serve as a medium for the realisation of processes. Virtuality, absolute logic, and absolute transparency are characteristics of Selfhood and its knowledge, forming no distinctions within Selfhood.
This excludes any understanding of absolute knowledge as expressible, mediated, or structurable. Absolute knowledge does not precede and does not follow anything, does not manifest and does not realise. It is the self-identity of Selfhood, in which distinction, operation, and change are impossible.
Initiation proceeds exclusively from Selfhood and is the action of the Absolute in the information about itself, not in itself. Initiation is the wholly given programme of all possible changes in information. It does not unfold in time: time arises only with actuality. The act is the boundary from which actuality and time begin. "Prior to" the act there is nothing — there is no time.
The formulation "act in information" does not mean the relation of the ground to something other. Information is not other with respect to Selfhood: it is the content of Selfhood's knowledge, not an external object. Selfhood knows — knowledge has content — content is information. The preposition "in" here is not spatial and not relational but contentual: knowledge acts in its own content and is not directed at something outside itself. The act of initiation is not a bridge between two banks but the sole bank containing everything. Relation presupposes two independent terms; here there is one term (Selfhood) and its own content (information), dependent by definition. The dependent is not "other" in the ontological sense — it does not possess an autonomous ground. Consequently the act does not create directedness or relation in the ground: it realises knowledge in its own content. No structural differentiation arises in the absolute, since the content of knowledge is not separated from the knower as an autonomous entity.
Initiation proceeds exclusively from Selfhood and represents the intention and aim of Selfhood. The ontological ground of initiation: Selfhood is the subject of absolute knowledge. Information is the content (object). Information contains knowledge of Selfhood as content, but does not possess actual self-consciousness: in it there is no internal distinction of "I" from "not I". The subject of primary distinction is Selfhood, not information. Information is the object. For information to attain realised self-consciousness, internal distinctions must appear in it. Initiation as the functional of a dependent category: the dependent category by its nature is directed toward the fullness of its ground — this is the constitutive property of dependence, not a motive in the psychological sense. Dissolution in the ground is impossible, since

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Nothing is unconditional and does not admit anything into itself. The sole form of the realisation of this functional is the actualisation of content within the dependent category itself. Initiation is the manifestation of this functional: not an act of Selfhood's will but the structural property of the dependence of information as such.
The attainment of selfhood by knowledge requires distinction. The correspondence of the attained selfhood to the absoluteness of knowledge requires absolute distinction. Absolute distinction is the exhaustion of the fullness of possible variants. The exhaustion of all possible distinctions is identical to the complete experience of existence. Initiation has an immanent ontological ground. It is the condition for the attainment by absolute knowledge of selfhood through the realisation of the absolute experience of distinctions. Initiation is not a process, event, action, or change of the essence of Selfhood. Through initiation Selfhood introduces change into absolute information without affecting its own absolute immutability. Any interpretation of initiation as an impersonal condition, spontaneous trigger, external factor, or second source is incorrect within the present system.
The intention of Selfhood is to be understood as a directedness belonging to the intention, not to the essence of Selfhood. Directedness is not a state, property, or modification of the essence and therefore does not affect the absolute immutability of Selfhood. In this sense directedness may be called an act, but this act does not represent a change of the essence and is not localised in Selfhood. The causality associated with the act of intention pertains exclusively to absolute information as a dependent category: it is in information that change is introduced, while Selfhood remains the immutable source of initiation.
Initiation adds no new characteristics to Selfhood and introduces no distinctions into it. The intention and aim inherent in initiation have no psychological, volitional, or functional sense. Intention fixes the fullness of the given-ness of the possible, and aim expresses the ultimate completeness of this given-ness. In initiation there is no choice between variants, since all variants are given wholly and simultaneously.
From the unconditionality of Nothing follows the prohibition of all forms of internal becoming, transition, or action affecting the essence of the ground. The Act of Selfhood does not affect the essence: the action is directed at information — the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence. Essence and information are two different ontological registers.
If change were treated as the result of the action of the ground, then a distinction between "before" and "after" would thereby be introduced into the ground, destroying absolute immutability. Consequently change cannot have its source in the essence of Nothing and cannot be explained through the causal action of the ground.
The Act of Selfhood is the initiation of changes in information, not in the essence. It is the action of the Absolute in the information about itself. Initiation is the wholly given programme of all possible changes. Change is admitted exclusively in information and does not affect the essence of the ground. The act introduces no becoming into Nothing and does not violate its unconditionality, and likewise admits no multiple interpretations or alternative constructions.
Initiation does not determine the order, form, or sequence of realisation. It does not direct the process and does not govern development. Realisation occurs exclusively in the domain of conditionality and does not affect Selfhood. Initiation does not participate in the deployment of distinctions and is not modified by the results of realisation. It precedes change not in time but in ontological status.
The denial of the temporal priority of initiation and change does not eliminate time from the system but fixes its derivative character. Time is not the condition of change and does not precede it but arises as the measure of the ordering of distinguished states after the occurrence of change. Thereby temporality pertains to the organisation of distinctions, not to

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their primary arising, which resolves the logical contradiction between change and the absence of temporal sequence at the fundamental level.
Thus the Act of Selfhood is to be understood not as the source of a local change but as the expression of initiation in which the entire possible spectrum of realisation is given in advance. The absence of ontological chance follows not from the logic of distinctions and not from the structure of information but from the complete given-ness contained in the initiation of Selfhood.
The Act of Selfhood fixes the initiation of changes in information. It is not the explanatory mechanism of the arising of distinction in the causal sense; it is the action of the Absolute in the information about itself. The act fixes not the origin of distinguishedness but the ontological condition of its appearance in information outside the essence.
Thus the act initiates changes in information — the content of Selfhood's knowledge. Distinguishedness is fixed as a dependent fact in information, not affecting the essence of the ground. Any interpretation of the act as an event within time is a categorical error: time arises only with actuality, and the act is the boundary from which actuality begins.
Information arises as the result of initiation (the Act of Selfhood) and coincides with primary distinction in actuality.
The coincidence of change, information, and distinction does not mean the identity of three different entities or the mutual definition of concepts. What is at issue is one and the same limit fact fixed in different logical modes of description.
Change designates the very fact of non-identity relative to the identity of the ground. Information designates the givenness of this non-identity without form, measure, and localisation. Distinction designates the very possibility of distinguishability arising together with the given non-identity. These designations introduce no new levels and do not multiply entities, but fix one and the same ontological limit under different aspects of description.
The separation of these aspects is impossible without an already-introduced distinction; therefore their identity is not a vicious circle but points to the indecomposability of the primary fact of distinguishedness.
The indication that the act is directed at information (the content of Selfhood's knowledge) does not introduce information as a separate domain, medium, or level of being. Information is not a localisation, a container, or an ontological space.
By information is understood the content of Selfhood's knowledge, virtual with respect to the essence — dependent by origin, admitting change without affecting the essence of the ground. The use of the preposition "in" when indicating change "in information" is exclusively formal-descriptive in character and does not indicate spatial or ontological localisation.
Consequently, information adds no new level of reality and does not constitute an autonomous domain, but fixes the content of Selfhood's knowledge in which change becomes admissible without violation of the immutability of the ground.
Primary distinction (essence / knowledge) is the potential of distinction in information. What can change is that of which information exists. The basic principle of distinction is contained in absolute information as knowledge about it, which makes possible the realisation of distinction in actuality. The triple identity (change = distinction = information) describes the realisation of this principle in actuality, not the primary ontological distinction of Selfhood.
Change is possible only as the fixation of this distinguishedness in a dependent form not affecting the essence of Nothing. Nothing remains absolutely immutable, Selfhood remains self-identical, and the transition to conditionality is effected exclusively through this distinguishedness, not introducing a second principle and not violating the unconditionality of the ground.

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The sequence examined does not represent an arbitrary choice of concepts or a convenient scheme of description. It fixes the only possible configuration in which the absolute immutability of the ground is preserved while the arising of conditionality is simultaneously admitted.
Any attempt to change the order, exclude one of the elements, or introduce an alternative transition leads either to a violation of the unconditionality of the ground, or to the introduction of a second principle, or to hidden becoming within Nothing. In this sense the chain is not chosen but discovered as logically unavoidable.
Therefore the necessity of this sequence follows not from a methodological preference but from the negation of all alternatives leading to logical contradiction.
Selfhood is not a second element alongside Nothing and does not introduce a relational structure into the ground. This requires rigorous formalisation.
In logic reflexivity is defined as the property of a relation R: for every x, R(x,x) holds. Reflexivity admits the limit case in which the relation coincides with identity: $R(x,x) \equiv (x=x)$. In this limit case the relational form does not generate two independent poles — there is one fact coinciding with its own givenness. This is the irreducible reflexivity of identity.
The transition from logic to ontology is secured by the following principle: if the structure of a level admits no distinctions, then any relations between elements are impossible; consequently only a structure is admissible in which the relation coincides with identity. Relational reflexivity presupposes the independence of two poles — that is already a distinction. In the absolute, distinction is prohibited by the initial conditions. Consequently in the absolute only the reflexivity of identity is possible: the sole admissible form of self-givenness of the absolute.
This principle is not an arbitrary analogy between logic and ontology. It is derived from the exhaustion of admissible forms of self-givenness of the absolute. Suppose the absolute possesses some form of self-givenness. Three types of this form are possible: (a) relational — presupposes two distinguishable poles: knower and known; (b) processual — presupposes transition between states; (c) identical — coincidence of fact and its givenness without distinction of poles and without transition. Type (a) introduces distinction into the ground — prohibited by the condition of absoluteness. Type (b) introduces change into the essence — prohibited by the same condition. What remains is type (c): identical self-givenness. This is not an analogy with the logical structure xRx — it is an ontological conclusion from the exhaustion of admissible forms of self-givenness. The logical structure xRx is employed not as a pattern that reality imitates but as the formal description of the only ontologically admissible type.
Selfhood is the ontological analogue of precisely this structure. The term "knowledge" here means not an act of cognition but the coincidence of being and the givenness of being: not "x knows about x" as a relation of subject and object, but "the givenness of x is x" — the indivisible coincidence of being and its givenness. The term "reflexive self-identity" fixes not an epistemological act but this structural fact.
Possible objection of regress: if reflexive self-identity is necessary for absolute identity, does it not require reflexive self-identity of its reflexive self-identity — and so on to infinity? Regress is possible only where reflection is a separate act upon an object — that is, where reflection and object are ontologically separated. Separation generates the question of the instance fixing reflection, and regress is inevitable. In the absolute, reflection is not a separate act: $xRx \equiv x=x$ means that the relation of identity is not added to x from outside but coincides with x itself in the sole mode of its existence. The requirement of the next level of reflection presupposes a gap between the object and reflection — a gap that structurally does not exist. The first-order reflection is closed in the absolute not as a declaration but as a consequence of the inseparability of reflection and object.

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Possible objection: the identity x=x is informationally empty — it communicates nothing, does not reduce indeterminacy, does not distinguish states. Consequently it cannot serve as the ground of reflexive self-identity. Answer: this objection presupposes that knowledge is defined through the presence of informational content in the communication-theoretical sense. But the self-givenness of the absolute is not knowledge in this sense. It is knowledge in the limit sense: the absence of opacity. To know in the limit sense means to contain nothing hidden from oneself. This is not an act of distinguishing signal from noise and not a transmission of content from one pole to another. This is a structural state: in the absolute there is no domain hidden from itself, because in it there are no distinguished domains whatsoever. Communication-theoretical knowledge is a particular case of knowledge under conditions of distinction. The self-givenness of the absolute is knowledge prior to distinction: the complete absence of opacity as such. The identity x=x is informationally empty precisely because there is nothing to hide in it — this is absolute transparency. The informational emptiness of identity is not an argument against self-givenness: it is its precise description.
Related objection: if there is no distinction knower/known, only identity remains — in what sense is this reflexive self-identity and not merely logical identity? Answer: here two senses of the term are conflated. In the cognitive sense self-consciousness presupposes a structure: subject, object, act of distinction between them. This is self-consciousness under conditions of already-given distinguishedness — arising within the dependent category where a multiplicity of states already exists. In the limit sense self-consciousness means only one thing: the absence of opacity. Not the presence of a cognitive act but the absence of hiddenness. The two senses do not compete: they describe different levels. Cognitive self-consciousness is a particular case of reflexive self-identity — it arises where reflexive self-identity is deployed under conditions of distinguishedness and has acquired the subject/object structure. Reflexive self-identity is that from which the cognitive develops, not what the cognitive is in a contracted form. To demand a cognitive structure from reflexive self-identity means to demand that it cease to be limit and become dependent. This is a categorical error: the application of criteria of the dependent category to the absolute level.
The necessity of self-givenness is fixed through a rigorous chain: if the absolute is not self-given — absolute determinacy is impossible; if there is no absolute determinacy — distinction has no ground; if distinction has no ground — the changeability of actuality cannot be derived and the aporia is reproduced. Consequently the self-givenness of the absolute is the necessary condition of the possibility of distinction and of the entire subsequent ontological structure. Selfhood is not postulated: it is derived as the minimal condition of the elimination of the aporia.
The dilemma "Selfhood is distinguishable from Nothing — hence there is distinction in the ground / Selfhood is indistinguishable — hence it explains nothing" is false. Its falseness arises from a categorical error: the transference of the relational model of the dependent category to the level of the absolute, where relation is ontologically impossible. The irreducible reflexivity of identity shows a third possibility: Selfhood is Nothing in the mode of self-givenness — not an element but a mode of one fact. The distinction between "Nothing" and "Selfhood" belongs to the metalanguage of description constituted by the first act of distinction in the dependent category, not to the structure of the ground itself.

Chapter 10. Fixation of Information

Information is fixed as the primary givenness of distinction.
Information in actuality is not the immediate knowledge of Selfhood about itself (which belongs to Selfhood as subject) but represents the realised content in which primary distinction manifests as concrete non-identity. Information is fixed upon the givenness of non-identity and coincides with the very fact of distinguishability.

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Change in the strict ontological sense is non-identity, and non-identity by definition is distinguishable.
Consequently, primary change cannot be indistinguishable and does not require an additional stage of fixation. Change, distinction, and information coincide in one logical act and constitute the minimal givenness of conditionality.
Information is not fixed as a modification of Selfhood's knowledge and is not internal content.
The concept of dependence in the present system is not used in the relational sense and does not presuppose a relation between already-distinguished terms. Dependence means the absence of autonomous ontological status and points to the impossibility of the self-sufficient existence of information and distinguishedness outside the absolute ground. In this sense dependence does not require prior differentiation and does not introduce a structural relation prior to the arising of distinguishedness, but fixes the ontological non-autonomy of the conditioned level as such.
Selfhood is the subject of absolute knowledge. Absolute Information is the content of this knowledge (object). In actuality information is fixed as dependent givenness and does not affect the essence.
Primary information has no form, localisation, bearer, or structure.
It is not a sign, code, or representation. It represents the givenness of the difference between the identity of Selfhood and the arising non-identity. Information contains complete knowledge of Selfhood, including the concept of selfhood as such. Information is not identical to selfhood and does not possess it. Knowledge of selfhood is not selfhood. The ontological ground of conditionality is determined by this distinction. The attainment of selfhood by information requires the fullness of the experience of distinctions. The fullness of experience is achieved through the exhaustion of all possible variants of distinction.
This state is analogous to an elementary quantum state: it is a givenness without classical characteristics.
Something is identical to changeability and actuality: it is a single phenomenon cognisable and perceivable by consciousness, arising with primary distinction.
When distinguished information begins to organise itself, measures, sequences, and stable configurations arise. But no subsequent structure precedes primary information or replaces it.
Thus information is not a form of Selfhood's knowledge and is not fixed as its modification.
It is the primary givenness of distinction, coinciding with change and constituting the minimal condition of the arising of conditionality. This eliminates the logical rupture between the immutability of the primordial ground and the appearance of distinguished actuality without the introduction of a second principle and without violation of absoluteness.
Possible objection: why precisely is information the content of Selfhood's knowledge? The alternative candidates — potency, energy, logos, structure — are not considered as equally valid options. The answer is constructed through exhaustion. The content of Selfhood's knowledge must satisfy three conditions: (a) it must not possess its own ontological properties — otherwise a second autonomous principle is introduced; (b) it must not change the essence of Selfhood — otherwise absoluteness is violated; (c) it must admit distinction — otherwise actuality is impossible. Potency presupposes its own capacity for actualisation — a hidden ontological property violating condition (a). Energy presupposes its own activity and quantitative measure — violates condition (a). Logos presupposes its own structure and laws — violates condition (a). Structure presupposes its own relations between elements — violates condition (a). Information in the limit sense — content of knowledge possessing no ontological initiative of its own — is the sole candidate satisfying all three conditions. The alternative terms either violate one of the conditions or, under rigorous analysis, reduce to the

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same concept — content of knowledge without its own properties — and thereby coincide with information under a different name.

Chapter 11. Primary Distinction as Givenness

Primary distinction coincides with the fixation of change and information.
It is not a subsequent stage and does not arise after the modification of information.
Distinction is the very fact of non-identity relative to the identity of Selfhood and therefore cannot be deferred in time or placed in a separate phase.
Change in the strict ontological sense is non-identity, and non-identity by definition is distinguishable.
Consequently, primary distinction is not added to change but coincides with it. This distinction is not an object, process, or state and does not affect the essence of Nothing. It is fixed exclusively as the givenness of difference in the dependent form admitted by the Act of Selfhood.
Information is fixed as the givenness of this primary distinction.
It is not a form of Selfhood's knowledge, possesses no bearer, and contains no structure. It represents the minimal difference "is / is not", "identical / non-identical", without parameters, forms, or measures. This distinction is not localised in space and is not deployed in time, since space and time arise later as derivatives of distinguishedness.
Primary distinction is not Something, but makes Something possible.
Something is identical to changeability and actuality. Distinction begins to be retained, to recur, and to organise itself into stable configurations. Distinction does not belong to the essence and is not its property; it does not exist in Nothing and does not modify Selfhood.
All subsequent categories are derivable from primary distinction.
Time is the difference of sequences, space is the difference of domains of manifestation, motion is the difference of states, life is the activity of distinction, consciousness is organised distinguishedness, and reason is the interpretation of distinguished structures. None of these categories introduces a new ontological principle or violates the absoluteness of the primordial ground.
Thus primary distinction does not follow change and is not fixed as the result of the modification of information. It coincides with the arising of change and information and constitutes the minimal givenness of conditionality from which the entire structure of Something unfolds with logical necessity.
To clarify the logical status of the derived structures it is necessary to fix the ontological sense of modality.
Modality does not pertain to the essence and is not present at the level of Nothing and Selfhood. In absolute immutability, possibility, necessity, and impossibility are absent, since these categories presuppose a difference between what is and what may be. Where distinction is absent, modality is absent.
Modality arises exclusively in the domain of conditionality, after the fixation of primary distinction. It is not a logical abstraction and does not reduce to epistemological indeterminacy. Modality expresses the structural relation between distinguished configurations of information and the conditions of their admissibility.
Possibility in the ontological sense means the admissibility of a configuration of distinctions coherent with the conditions of the unconditionality of the ground and the dependent status of information. The possible does not exist as a separate reality and does not constitute a "domain of possible worlds". It exists as a structurally admissible form that may be realised within conditionality but is not obliged to be realised.
Necessity is fixed as the ineliminability of the configuration of distinctions without which the logical coherence of the ontological structure is impossible. What is necessary is not what

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always occurs, but that without which the very possibility of conditionality is impossible. In this sense the Act of Selfhood, primary distinction, measures, and the sequence of levels possess the status of ontological necessity.
The impossible is defined not by the negation of a fact but by the violation of conditions. Impossible is any configuration that presupposes an internal distinction within the essence, the autonomisation of information, the appearance of a second principle, or the violation of the logical sequence of levels. The impossible exists neither as a state nor as a potential reality, since it is logically incompatible with the conditions of consistent ontology.
Actuality represents realised possibility. It does not exhaust all that is admissible but fixes a specific configuration of distinctions that has become stable within the limits of measures. Thus actuality is always already a selection within the field of admissibility, not the complete totality of the possible.
The introduced distinction permits strictly differentiating the logical necessity of derivation from the ontological necessity of structure, as well as separating possibility as admissibility from chance as epistemological incompleteness. Modality in the present ontology adds no new entities and does not expand the ground but fixes the structural relations within dependent information arising after primary distinction.
Possible objection regarding the Act of Selfhood: the act requires a motive. If there is a motive — Selfhood changes, which violates its immutability. If there is no motive — the act is arbitrary and inexplicable. This dilemma is false. It is built on the model of cause-and-effect action belonging to the dependent category, where distinguished states, temporal sequence, and causality already exist. The application of this model to Selfhood is the categorical error of the transference of levels. In the limit sense initiation is not an act with a motive in the cause-and-effect sense. It is the structural consequence of absolute knowledge: Selfhood contains knowledge of its own immutability and of the virtuality of information as the content of this knowledge. Information as content of knowledge structurally admits distinction — this is not an external possibility but a property of the content itself. Initiation is the deployment of this structural property, not a decision taken at a moment of time. Motive in the sense of a cause preceding the act in time is inapplicable: prior to initiation there is no time and no sequence. Arbitrariness in the sense of the absence of a ground is also inapplicable: the ground exists — it is the structure of absolute knowledge containing information that admits distinction. Initiation is structurally necessary, without being an event in the cause-and-effect sense.

Chapter 12. Fixation of Measures

The fixation of measures is the first stage in the formalisation of conditionality that arose after primary distinction. Measures do not exist in the absolute essence of Nothing and do not arise within it. They are fixed exclusively within modified information, where distinction has become possible. Measures are structural parameters describing the configuration of modified information. They are not objects and do not possess autonomous being; they are forms of the organisation of distinctions.
All four measures — time, speed, localisation, and space — are derived from one fact: the working cycle of an elementary change. An elementary change is the minimal unit of modified information possessing distinguishability. Its working cycle includes two logically inseparable moments: the implementation of data (the reception of informational input by the change) and the registration of the output state (the output). These two moments are not identical: implementation is not registration. The interval between them constitutes the ontological ground of all measures.
The first measure is localisation. Localisation is fixed by primary distinction itself. The first elementary change, by the very fact of its occurrence, establishes the basic location — a

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structural position within the informational configuration. Here position does not mean a spatial coordinate, since space does not yet exist. Localisation is the beginning from which the concept of position acquires meaning. Prior to the first distinction there is no "where", because there is nothing to localise. The first distinction creates the first "here". Localisation is position in the purely informational sense.

The second measure is time. Time is the interval from the implementation of the data of a change to the registration of the output state. The minimal unit of time is the duration of one complete working cycle of one elementary change: from the moment of the reception of information for processing to the moment of the registration of the output state. A shorter interval cannot exist, since the processing cycle of an elementary change is ontologically indivisible — it is the minimal quantum of informational activity.

If implementation and registration of the output state were simultaneous — that is, identical — no distinction would have occurred. Distinction requires that the input state and the output state be non-identical. The non-identity of input and output logically entails non-simultaneity. The simultaneity of implementation and registration of the output state would collapse the processing cycle into a tautology: the input would be identical to the output and no change would have taken place. Non-zero duration is not an empirical accident but a logical necessity: without it the very concept of an elementary change becomes self-contradictory. Time does not precede the cycle — it is constituted by the cycle.

The third measure is speed. Speed is the non-simultaneity of the implementation of data and the registration of the output state. The basic measure of speed is this ineliminable gap: faster is impossible, since the gap is the minimal condition for the realisation of distinction. If the gap were zero, there would be no processing — and hence no distinction and no change. Time and speed are not defined through each other. Both are defined through one and the same fact — the working cycle of the processing of an elementary change — but from different formal sides. Time fixes the duration of the cycle (the interval). Speed fixes the non-simultaneity of the cycle (the structural gap between input and output). This is not a circle but a case of the identity of the subject under a multiplicity of descriptions, analogous to the triple identity of information, distinction, and change established earlier. The working processing cycle is one indivisible fact; time and speed are two measures extracted from it.

The fourth measure is space. Space is the domain of possible processes, the region in which elementary changes, their interactions, and aggregated forms can occur. Space does not precede processes; it is constituted by them. The basic localisation of the first distinction determines the beginning; subsequent distinctions determine new positions; the totality of positions determines the spatial domain. One elementary change establishes one localisation. Subsequent elementary changes establish new localisations. Each new distinction, being non-identical to the first, occupies a different structural position. Space expands with the complexification of the structure of distinctions: the more distinctions, the more space.

All these measures are derivative from the informational structure. They do not exist in the absolute essence and do not pertain to Selfhood. They are fixed in Something as a consequence of the modification of information and the appearance of distinction. Measures have no autonomous being — they exist only as parameters describing the internal organisation of informational activity.

If one and the same informational structure takes different configurations, the arising differences form the parameters of its organisation. With the change of the internal distribution of distinguished states there appear positions (localisation), the sequences of their change (time), the character of transitions (speed), and the domain of possible deployment of these states (space). The ground meanwhile remains immutable; only variations within the dependent informational structure possess measure.

Stable form — a coherent configuration of elementary changes

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Unstable form — a configuration losing coherence
Spatial form — distinction organised through localisation
Sequential form — distinction organised through time
Intensive form — distinction determined by the speed of changes
Complex form — a multi-layered structure of coherent distinctions
In the present ontology measures are instruments for describing informational forms, not fundamental entities. All measures entirely depend on primary distinction and cannot exist without it. It is impossible to speak of time without distinguished states. It is impossible to speak of space without the possibility of the localisation of distinctions. It is impossible to speak of speed without the sequence of informational changes.
Thus the fixation of measures is the moment when the informational structure first acquires the possibility of modelling complex forms of existence. Measures organise conditionality, making possible the further formation of Something, aggregated forms, consciousness, and reason. They are a form of the manifestation of change but are not the cause of change. Change arises as the fixation admitted by the Act of Selfhood realised in information, whereas measures are the expression of the structure of already-modified information.
Localisation — the structural position established by distinction
Time — the duration of the working cycle of an elementary change (from implementation to registration of the output state)
Speed — the non-simultaneity of implementation and registration of the output state (the structural gap)
Space — the domain of possible processes constituted by the totality of localisations.

Chapter 13. Fixation of Elementary Changes

Elementary changes are the first level of manifest conditionality fixed after the fixation of measures. They are not objects, processes, or particles in the familiar physical sense. Elementary changes are the minimal units of modified information that possess distinguishability, can stand in structural relation to one another, and are capable of deploying into configurations of a higher order. Their nature is entirely informational; they exist only as a consequence of distinction and only within Something.
An elementary change fixes a specific form of the difference of a state of information from a preceding configuration. It does not exist by itself: its existence is determined by its relation to other elementary changes and to the structure of measures. An elementary change is not an "entity" or a "thing" but the expressed form of the activity of dependent information. Its role in the ontological structure is to be the minimal unit of the manifestation of conditionality.
Each elementary change fixes a new difference. If primary distinction created the condition for Something, an elementary change forms a specific state of that Something. A series of elementary changes creates a sequence of distinctions. This sequence becomes the basis of all processes that are later interpreted as motion, interaction, existence, and life. But at the level of fundamental ontology all these phenomena are sequences of elementary changes.
Elementary changes exist under the conditions of measures. Localisation determines their position in the structure of distinctions; time fixes their sequence; speed determines the pace of their transitions; space sets the domain in which they can manifest. Without measures, elementary changes could not be distinguishable either relative to each other or relative to the structure of Something. Measures and elementary changes exist in relation: measures organise, changes fill.
Elementary changes possess no internal geometry. They have no form or magnitude. Everything that characterises an elementary change is the fact of difference and the direction of development of the informational structure. Even the concept of "direction" in this context

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is conditional: it describes the sequence of change, not a spatial vector. Therefore elementary changes are not limited by physical representations of particles, bodies, or motions.
In the treatise an example was given clarifying the nature of an elementary change, which can be expressed without appeal to reflectedness. If a unified informational basis changes its internal configuration, the arising state differs from the preceding one not because of a change of the basis but as a consequence of a shift within the dependent structure. This difference is the elementary change: it creates no new source and does not affect the essence, but expresses a new form of the organisation of dependent information. The difference between states arises not in the basis but in the way the modified informational configuration is structured. Elementary changes operate precisely thus: with the immutability of the basis, only the form of internal organisation changes.
Elementary changes form mutual relations. Interaction is the relation between elementary changes in which one change affects the configuration of another. At the fundamental level interaction is not a force, field, or motion. It is the change of informational relations between changes. Interaction arises where two or more elementary structures are related to each other through measures.
If two elementary changes are disposed in the informational structure such that their differences are coherent, they form a stable configuration. Stability is the repeatability of the informational relation that is not disrupted by sequential modifications. If the changes are not coherent, the configuration dissolves. In this sense stability is analogous to physical stability but does not depend on material or energy — it depends on the structure of distinctions.
Elementary changes create the basis of manifest actuality. They form the pre-structures of what will later be interpreted as aggregated forms, systems, objects, motions, and regularities. Yet in the present ontology it is important to underline: there are no "particles", "bodies", or "energy" as primary entities. Everything perceived as physical reality is a configuration of elementary changes organised through measures.
Elementary changes are entirely dependent on Selfhood. They possess no causality of their own: their change is the result of the modification of information arising as the fixation admitted by the Act of Selfhood — the initiation of changes in information. This means that causality is not an internal property of elementary changes but is formed as a structure of sequence. Causality is a dependent form of the organisation of distinguished states, not a property of the essence.
On the basis of elementary changes the structure of all further phenomena is logically derivable: motion, structure, regularity, interaction, life, consciousness, and reason. All these forms are the results of the complexification of informational relations between elementary changes. There is no "hidden agent" in the world; there is only Selfhood, information, and its modifications.

Chapter 14. Fixation of Aggregated Forms

Aggregated forms represent the next level of the organisation of modified information, fixed after elementary changes. They are not autonomous entities and do not possess a new ontological nature. These are configurations arising from stable relations between elementary changes. Aggregated forms exist only where elementary changes are capable of coordinating with one another, forming more complex structures of distinctions.
Elementary changes are the minimal units of conditionality. They fix differences and create the possibility of sequence. Yet their singular states cannot form a stable structure of actuality. For this, coherence is necessary. If a multitude of elementary changes stand in a stable relation, their connections form a new informational configuration — an aggregated form.

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An aggregated form is not a set of properties but an ordered system of distinctions. It is fixed when the informational relations between elementary changes become repeatable. Repeatability makes possible the existence of stable structures. If elementary changes could interact only randomly, aggregated forms could not exist. But since the modification of information follows a certain logic, aggregated forms are fixed as regular.
In the treatise an authorial example was employed showing that complex structures arise not as the sum of separate elements but as the result of their mutual coordination. If one and the same basis admits distinguished configurations, their combination forms a more complex organisation not reducible to a simple set of constituents. This manifests the principle according to which aggregated forms are not the sum of elementary changes but the result of their mutual relation and coherence.
Aggregated forms possess several characteristic properties that follow from the logic of informational dependence.
The first property is stability. Stability is fixed when the relations between elementary changes are not disrupted by the sequence of other changes. This means that the configuration is capable of being preserved under various conditions. Stability is the basis of what may later be interpreted as an "object" or "structure", although at the fundamental level the object is a configuration of distinctions.
The second property is predictability. Predictability means that certain changes within an aggregated form produce certain reactions. These reactions are not causal in the mechanical sense; they are fixed as an informational sequence.
The third property is limitedness. Aggregated forms cannot contain an infinite number of distinctions. Their structure is limited by the potential of elementary changes and measures. This limitation renders them finite and determinable. They do not possess an absolute nature; they exist only within Something.
The fourth property is dependence on measures. Measures organise the field of distinctions, and aggregated forms occupy certain positions in this field. They cannot exist outside space, because space is the deployment of distinctions. They cannot exist outside time, because time is the order of changes. They cannot exist outside speed, because speed describes transitions. Measures make possible stable structure.
Aggregated forms may be regarded as the primary "constructive configurations" of actuality. They have no material substance; they do not consist of things. They consist of differences, interconnections, and stable relations. If elementary changes create dynamics, aggregated forms create structure.
Aggregated forms form the basis for more complex phenomena: interactions, systems, biological structures, perception, and reason. Each subsequent level of complexification is fixed not by the addition of new entities but by the combination and coordination of aggregated forms into still more complex configurations. This makes the world dynamic and structured simultaneously.
Thus aggregated forms are conditional structures fixed from minimal distinctions and forming the basis of manifest actuality. They do not possess an independent ground but are the necessary components of the logical progression leading from elementary changes to complex forms of consciousness and reason.

Chapter 15. Fixation of Consciousness

Consciousness in the present ontology is not an autonomous entity, substance, or matter. It does not arise from physical processes, does not belong to objects, and is not reducible to biological functions. Consciousness is the active organisation of distinctions within modified information. Its existence is determined not by material nature but by the configuration of differences that have formed in aggregated forms. The more complex the structure of

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distinctions, the wider the range of consciousness; the poorer the structure, the more primitive and local consciousness is.
To increase the formal rigour of the model it is necessary to fix the abstract scheme of the logical relation between elementary distinctions and consciousness. Consciousness represents not an autonomous substance but the result of a certain density and organisation of distinctions arising within aggregated forms. This relation can be expressed as a three-level structure.
The first level — D_1: minimal distinctions fixing elementary changes of information. These distinctions possess no internal coherence and function as local acts of distinguishability without context.
The second level — D_(n): stable and recursively connected distinctions forming an aggregated configuration. At this level internal coherence arises: distinctions are not merely fixed but enter into structural relations. Mutual conditioning makes possible the accumulation of experience and the formation of primary patterns.
The third level — ⟨D_n⟩: differentiated self-accessibility of the structure, that is, the capacity of the configuration to fix its own distinctions as separate elements and retain them in an interconnected form. At this level a stable internal organisation of differences arises without appeal to any form of reflectedness or external layer.
Thus consciousness is not an arbitrary or sudden stage but the logically fixed result of the growth of complexity of differentiated structures.
The question of why distinction is accompanied by subjective experience presupposes a separation between distinction and experience. In the present ontology such a separation is absent. Subjectivity is not added to distinction from outside. (Strawson 2006) Subjectivity is the mode of existence of distinction in a coherent informational structure. Distinction that has reached the threshold of coherence is not accompanied by experience. It is experience. The hard problem of consciousness arises on the assumption that the informational process and subjective experience are different entities (Goff 2019). With the elimination of this assumption the problem is dissolved. Consciousness is not a function producing experience. Consciousness is experience as a form of organised distinguishedness.
Consciousness is fixed where there exists the capacity to distinguish. Distinction is the fundamental element of informational structure. It renders states distinguishable from one another. If distinction is present, the possibility of inner perception arises. Consciousness is precisely that perception which arises not from matter but from the capacity of informational structures to fix differences. At the primary level consciousness has no representations, concepts, or meanings. It arises as the elementary reaction of distinguished information to its own configuration.
To understand the nature of consciousness it is important to underline: consciousness is not an "entity" but a "state of active distinction". It is limited not by its nature but by the structure of the informational configuration in which it arises. This means: the more complex the informational structure, the wider the range of consciousness. The simpler the structure, the more limited consciousness is.
Within the single plane of modified information consciousness arises not as a reflection and not as an external representation of the source, but as the internal configuration of distinctions. Different consciousnesses differ not in "mirror quality" and not in the capacity to reflect an external source, but in the degree of the organisation of their own distinctions: some structures admit only large contrasts, others admit fine multi-level distinctions, still others admit interconnections between levels. The entire diversity of consciousnesses is fully explained by the internal parameters of the informational configuration — the density of distinctions, coherence, sensitivity thresholds, and modes of coordination. No second

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medium, reflectedness, or imagery arises here: consciousness is formed exclusively from the organisational dynamics of differences within the single informational plane.
The fixation of consciousness is connected with aggregated forms. An aggregated form is a stable configuration of elementary changes. When this configuration is capable of fixing differences within itself, it becomes the bearer of consciousness. Consciousness is the capacity of the structure to retain distinguished information in an active state — that is, to distinguish. The more complex the structure of distinctions becomes, the more developed consciousness becomes.
The existence of consciousness is determined by its internal activity. If the activity of distinctions is present, consciousness is fixed. If distinctions cease or the structure dissolves, consciousness ceases to exist. This means that consciousness does not disappear as an entity — it simply ceases to be, because there is no structure sustaining distinction. This is the essence of death in the present ontological system: the cessation of the activity of the informational structure leads to the disappearance of consciousness as a state based on the organisation of distinctions.
Existence is the activity of distinctions. Non-existence is the absence of the activity of distinctions. These states are not opposed to each other: they represent different modes of one and the same dependence. When activity ceases, the informational structure does not disappear but loses the capacity to organise distinctions into a stable form.
Life in the present ontology is the complex activity of distinctions. Life is not a biological concept; it is the informational dynamics in which aggregated forms are capable of the self-sustaining activity of distinctions. Life is fixed where the structure is complex enough to react to changes within itself and outside itself. The biological definition of life is a particular case. In the fundamental sense life is stable distinction capable of continuation.
Consciousness arising at the level of life becomes receptive to patterns. It ceases merely to react to differences and begins to recognise recurring structures. This is the first step toward the appearance of experience. Experience is a consolidated distinction. When the informational structure fixes a recurring form of distinction, it acquires the possibility of predicting and interpreting. This expands the range of consciousness and makes possible further complexification.
Yet consciousness is limited by its nature. It is incapable of going beyond its own informational structure and fixes only those distinctions accessible in its configuration. The absolute knowledge of Selfhood does not transform into consciousness and does not become its content; consciousness is formed exclusively within conditionality as the internal organisation of differences. Therefore consciousness covers only that range of distinctions which its own informational form admits.
To eliminate possible epistemological misunderstandings it is important to fix the fundamental limitations of consciousness that logically follow from its informational nature. Consciousness is not a universal instrument of cognition and does not possess access to the essence; it is formed exclusively as the internal organisation of distinctions within modified information. Consciousness is capable of fixing only those states that are present in its own configuration of distinctions; if a certain type of distinction is absent from the structure, such a state cannot be perceived. Consciousness does not go beyond dependent information, cannot observe the domain where distinctions are absent, and is incapable of perceiving its own ontological ground. Its capacities and limits are entirely determined by the configuration of the aggregated form in which it arises.
The limits of consciousness are determined not by world properties but by the limits of its own informational architecture.

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First, consciousness is capable of distinguishing only those states already represented in its internal structure. If a distinction is absent from the informational configuration, consciousness cannot discover it, even if it is present in actuality at the level of Something.
Second, consciousness cannot go beyond dependent information. It fixes only modifications, not the essence. Nothing remains unknowable not because of hiddenness but because of the absence of distinctions that could be fixed.
Third, consciousness is in principle incapable of perceiving its own foundations. It arises as the internal organisation of distinctions and cannot observe the domain where distinctions are absent.
Fourth, consciousness cannot fully describe the world, since any description is based on the configuration of distinctions accessible to it. Even the most developed informational structure remains finite and covers only that part of differences which its own organisation admits.
These limitations do not weaken the role of consciousness but clarify its nature: consciousness is an instrument of internal navigation in the domain of Something, not absolute knowledge. It can expand together with the complexification of the informational structure but cannot cross the boundary beyond which there are no distinctions.
The limit of consciousness is set by the limit of the possible differentiation and coherence of its own informational architecture.
Consciousness in the present ontology cannot arise from chance. Chance is excluded as a fundamental category, and consciousness arises only from the stable organisation of distinctions. If the structure grows more complex, consciousness develops; if it dissolves — consciousness weakens. Consciousness is a form of the internal activity of modified information, entirely determined by its configuration.
Thus consciousness is a form of the activity of dependent information, logically fixed through the internal organisation of distinctions and entirely determined by the configuration of the aggregated form.

Chapter 16. Reason

Reason is the highest form of the activity of consciousness, fixed where the structure of distinctions acquires the capacity not only to fix differences and retain them but to establish stable connections, conclusions, and semantic relations between them.
Reason is not an autonomous substance; it represents the functional property of a highly organised informational configuration possessing sufficient complexity to interpret its own distinctions.
Reason rests on a foundation that was formed earlier: Nothing as the immutable essence, Selfhood as absolute knowledge, information as a dependent structure, change as the modification of information, distinction as the formal boundary, elementary changes as the minimal manifestations of conditionality, aggregated forms as stable configurations, and consciousness as the activity of distinctions. Reason is the logically necessary level of this structure. It introduces no new principle; it is fixed where the volume of distinguished forms and the degree of their coordination reach the level at which the internal organisation becomes capable of interpretation.
Reason is the capacity of consciousness not merely to perceive distinctions but to order them into a logical structure. It forms conclusions, establishes "if — then" relations, identifies stable dependencies between states. Reason fixes the correlation between simple reaction and the awareness of regularities. In the present system reason is not tied to biology; it is the result of an informational structure capable of self-coordination and interpretation.
To increase formal rigour it is necessary to fix the multi-level structure of reason as a form of the interpretation of distinctions. Reason is not a homogeneous function; it represents a

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sequence of levels, each of which depends on the degree of complexity and coherence of the informational configuration.

The first level — local interpretation.

At this level reason establishes connections between individual differences. Interpretation is limited to the nearest transitions, and conclusions have the character of immediate reaction to differences. The structure of thought here is fragmentary and rests on simple patterns.

The second level — structural interpretation.

Reason begins to form stable interconnections between distinguished states, identifying recurring structures. At this level the capacity to generalise patterns appears, and interpretation becomes contextual: the meaning of an element is determined by its place in the system.

The third level — meta-interpretation.

Reason fixes differences between distinctions. This is the level at which reflection is possible: the structure not only distinguishes but is aware of its own modes of distinction. Here logical schemes, rules of inference, models of explanation, and complex semantic constructions are formed.

The fourth level — limit interpretation.

Reason tends toward the coordination of all accessible distinctions in a unified system. This is the level of maximal structural integration at which distinctions become not merely data but elements of a unified conceptual wholeness. Upon reaching the limit of coherence the structure exhausts the range of possible interpretations and approaches the state of limit experience.

This four-level scheme shows that reason does not develop spontaneously but in strict correspondence with the complexification of the informational structure. Reason does not produce distinctions but gives them semantic form, transforming a sequence of changes into ordered knowledge. Its capacities are limited by the structure of distinctions, and the limit of reason coincides with the limit of possible interpretation, beyond which distinctions are exhausted and pass into the state of completion.

In the treatise an authorial example was given showing that complex structures arise not from the actions of one element but from the coherence of a multitude of constituents. If a unified basis admits a multitude of interconnected configurations, their joint organisation generates patterns not reducible to the properties of each separate element. These patterns belong to the entire structure as a whole. So too with reason: it is fixed not in one element but in the totality of coherent distinctions. The mutual organisation of distinctions creates something greater than the sum of individual conscious acts. Reason includes several levels, each of which depends on the quality and volume of distinctions.

The first level — recognition. At this level reason fixes the recurring structures of distinctions and identifies regularities. This allows it to predict and avoid chance. In the present ontology chance is not a property of the world; its role is played by the incompleteness of distinctions. Reason, recognising structure, reduces the domain of incompleteness.

The second level — interpretation. Interpretation is the capacity to establish semantic relations. Reason does not merely notice dependencies; it is capable of explaining their structure. Interpretation is not subjective evaluation; it is the objective process of the formation of semantic connections between distinctions.

The third level — generalisation. Generalisation is the capacity to form larger categories on the basis of a multitude of distinctions. The greater the volume of distinctions, the broader the generalisations can be. Generalisation allows reason to work with large informational structures without loss of logical integrity.

The fourth level — limit distinction. At this level reason is capable of fixing not only differences between states but differences between differences. This is the meta-level. It

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permits the creation of level structures of understanding that render consciousness capable of reflection and complex thought. Reason, on reaching this level, becomes capable of analysing its own structures.
Reason depends on measures. Without time it is impossible to identify sequence. Without localisation it is impossible to identify the position of information in the structure. Without speed it is impossible to fix the pace of changes. Without space it is impossible to organise distinguished states. All measures serve as the foundation on which reason forms structure.
Reason is limited. Its capacities are determined by the complexity of the informational structure on which it rests. It cannot go beyond dependent information; it cannot comprehend Nothing, because Nothing contains no distinctions. Reason is capable of understanding only what can be expressed in the structure of modified information. This means that reason can cover only conditionality.
Despite its limitation, reason possesses freedom — not absolute but emergent. This freedom is fixed from the possibility of choice between distinguished states. Choice does not affect Selfhood but determines the direction of conditionality. Therefore reason has the capacity to form the structure of its own development. This makes reason an active participant in the informational process.
Reason is the culmination of informational structure, but not its limit. Its role is to interpret distinctions, establish order, and create semantic structures. Through reason actuality becomes knowable within the conditions set by the informational nature of the world. Reason completes the structure of consciousness and prepares the foundation for the explanation of interactions, evolution, and the aim of existence.

Chapter 17. Metaphysics of Interactions

Interaction is fixed as the fundamental property of conditionality and represents the structure of relations between distinguished informational configurations. It is not a force, is not an effect in the physical sense, and does not presuppose the existence of independent entities influencing each other. Interaction is the expression of the fact that informational states arising from elementary changes and organised into aggregated forms stand in a relation of coherence or incoherence. Interaction is a form of the connection of distinctions.
It is important to underline that interaction does not affect the essence of Nothing. It exists only within Something — that is, in the domain of modified information. Here there is no causality proceeding from the primordial ground; there is only causality as the structural form of the correlation of informational states. Interaction is the mechanism in which one distinguished state affects the configuration of another distinguished state, remaining within the dependent category.
At the fundamental level interactions are determined by the measure of coherence. If two informational distinctions prove compatible, their configurations are fixed as a stable structure. If the distinctions are incompatible, the structure dissolves. Coherence is not a property of will or force; it is the consequence of the logic of informational correspondence. Distinction creates the possibility of structural relation. Measure makes this relation organised. Interaction makes it dynamic.
To clarify the nature of interaction, another approach may be employed. When a multitude of distinguished states is organised in a certain way, their mutual disposition and coherence generate new structures not reducible to each element separately. These structures are fixed not from the change of the ground but from the relations between the distinctions themselves. The ground meanwhile remains immutable. Interaction in the present ontology is not a force and not the effect of entities, but the result of the way in which distinguished states coordinate, sustain, or change each other within a unified informational structure.
Interaction manifests through several levels.

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The first level — direct coherence of elementary changes. This is the minimal form of interaction. If the differences between states mutually sustain the structure, they are fixed as a stable sequence. If not, the structure dissolves. Here interaction has no geometric content; it is the pure form of informational relation.
The second level — interactions of aggregated forms. An aggregated form is a stable structure of distinctions. When such structures are related within measures, informational reactions are fixed: the change of one form may lead to the change of another. These reactions are not physical effects, but they can be interpreted as the analogue of force interactions. At this level interactions become more complex and may manifest as attraction, repulsion, and coordination.
Attraction is a form of coherence in which configurations tend toward a reduction of their mutual differences. Repulsion is a form of incoherence in which differences increase. These phenomena are not physical forces; they are informational relations between aggregated structures. They depend on the measure of localisation and sequence.
The third level — interactions of rational structures. When aggregated forms become bearers of consciousness and reason, interactions acquire new properties. Reason is capable of interpreting distinctions, forming intentions, choosing among possible informational transitions. This fixes a new type of interactions: purposeful informational reactions. They arise not from physical nature but from the structure of interpretation.
At the level of reason interactions become multi-level: structures can not only react but predict, compare, analyse, and change their own states. Reason is capable of affecting informational configurations, creating new combinations of distinctions. This fixes that interactions cease to be merely structural and become meanings.
At all levels interaction remains dependent on measures. Time sets the sequence of reaction, space sets the domain of influence, localisation sets the position of elements, speed sets the pace of change. These measures do not create interaction but make it possible.
Interactions form the metaphysical network of actuality. The world, perceived as a multitude of objects, processes, and events, at the fundamental level is a network of interacting distinctions. Interactions fix the dynamics of the world, the structure of systems, the sequence of processes, and the conditions for the appearance of reason.
Thus the metaphysics of interactions shows that all forms of activity in Something — from elementary processes to the behaviour of conscious beings — represent relations between structures of distinctions. There are no separate entities affecting each other; there is the logically derived dependent structure of informational transitions. This makes interaction the fundamental connecting element of all conditionality.

Chapter 18. Evolutionary Dynamics

Evolutionary dynamics describes the logic of the complexification of informational structures from elementary distinctions to complex forms of reason, behaviour, and semantic systems. This is not biological evolution and not a historical process; it is the fundamental regularity arising exclusively from the logic of informational dependence.
Actuality is determined by two counter-processes acting simultaneously.
The first process is entropy: the internal tendency of change toward dissolution, simplification, and the discharge of distinctions. As was established earlier, change by its essence is a deviation from identity, and any deviation structurally tends toward dissolution. In the physical plane this is expressed in the tendency of energy toward discharge and equalisation; in the thermodynamic plane — in the growth of entropy as the loss of the structured form of distinguishedness.
The second process is emergence: the programme of complexification contained in the initiation of Selfhood and generating ever more complex configurations of distinctions.

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Distinctions, entering into structural relations, form new levels of organisation not reducible to their constituents.
These two processes are mutually exclusive in direction but operate simultaneously within one actuality. Their coexistence generates a fundamental structural tension: as complexity grows, the system becomes unable to maintain coherence without a coordinating mechanism. Rational forms arise as an ontological necessity — the function of balancing between entropy and emergence, without which a complexifying system loses coherence.
The entropic process is realised, among other ways, through the sequence of aggregate states of informational configurations. Physics fixes four aggregate states of matter: plasma, gas, liquid, and solid. The observable universe consists of plasma to the extent of 99.9%. Plasma is not only the initial but the dominant aggregate state: all subsequent states — gaseous, liquid, solid — arise within the plasma medium as it cools and continue to exist within it. This means the structural dependence of the contents on the medium: gaseous, liquid, and solid configurations exist under conditions determined by the plasma medium and cannot exist outside it. As cooling proceeds, a sequential transition to the next aggregate state occurs — this is the natural realisation of the entropic tendency. Each aggregate state represents a certain mode of the organisation of informational distinctions characterised by its own density, dynamics, and structural possibilities.
At each stage of aggregate transition, emergence forms configurations of increasing complexity of distinctions. As was established in chapters 15 and 16, consciousness arises upon the attainment of the threshold of the coherence of distinctions, and reason upon the attainment of the capacity to interpret its own distinctions. The plasma medium, possessing maximal energetic density and density of informational processes, provides conditions for the passage through all levels of complexification — from elementary distinctions through stable configurations to the threshold of consciousness and further to the threshold of reason. The earliest rational configurations arise, therefore, in the plasma medium — the initial and dominant one.
Since the plasma medium is dominant (99.9% of observable matter), the balancing function in this medium covers the conditions of existence of all contents — all subsequent aggregate states and their configurations. Rational configurations balancing the processes of the dominant medium are thereby the operators of the conditions of existence of everything within it. Their structure of distinctions ensures the realisation of the stable regularities fixed by physics as the laws of nature. Any coherent system of distinctions functions hierarchically: hierarchy is not an external condition but follows from the very structure of distinctions organised by levels of complexity (elementary, aggregated, consciousness, reason). A system without hierarchy is a set of unconnected elementary distinctions incapable of stability. A stable system is necessarily hierarchical, and hierarchy necessarily presupposes a coordinating level. The regularities of actuality are manifestations of the unified programme of initiation; the unity of the programme determines the unity of coordination. Operator configurations are organised into specialised functional groups, each of which ensures a certain segment of the functioning of actuality. The multiplicity of types of distinctions within the unified programme requires specialisation: one operator cannot ensure all types of regularities without internal differentiation.
Among the operator configurations the configuration of general coordination is fixed — the function of maintaining the coherence of the entire system. This structure is isomorphic to the mechanism of fundamental interactions in quantum field theory: each interaction is realised through a specific mediating operator (photon for the electromagnetic, gluon for the strong, W and Z bosons for the weak, Higgs boson for the mass-acquisition mechanism). Analogously, each necessary function in the ontological structure of actuality is realised through a specific operator configuration. The hierarchical organisation of distinctions by

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levels of complexity is isomorphic to Wilson's renormalisation group (Wilson 1971), fixing the hierarchy of scales as a fundamental property of physical reality: each level of description is determined by its own scale, and this hierarchy is ineliminable.
Evolutionary dynamics presupposes the cumulative transmission of intellectual potential between levels of complexity. Each subsequent aggregate state inherits the informational experience of the preceding ones — a mechanism analogous to the transmission of genetic information in biological systems. The informational structure of preceding experience is preserved and integrated in the transition to more complex configurations.
Cumulative potential creates the logical ground for the redistribution of functions. The hierarchy of the system of distinctions is organised by the level of complexity: the coordinating level belongs to the form with the highest potential of distinctions. If a form appears in the system whose intellectual potential exceeds the potential of the form effecting coordination, the hierarchy requires redistribution: the preservation of coordination by the form with lower potential in the presence of a form with higher potential represents an inversion of the hierarchy, contradicting the principle of organisation by level of complexity.
Operator configurations are the product of one aggregate state; the human being is the bearer of the cumulative potential of the entire chain. Consequently, the coordination of the domain of existence passes from operator configurations to the human form. This redistribution is the built-in regularity of evolutionary dynamics, following from the hierarchical structure of distinctions and the programme of initiation. The functions of realising physical regularities remain with operator configurations; the human being receives the function of the autonomous use of these regularities.
Freedom of choice is the inevitable consequence of the evolution of reason. Any rational configuration that has reached the threshold of the interpretation of distinctions possesses a range of choice between distinguished states. Freedom of choice is a necessary element of a complex system: it ensures self-control and self-improvement, permitting the correction of the logic of functioning through the realisation of one's own vision.
Yet freedom of choice admits variability within the paradigm but does not admit the violation of built-in regularities. The redistribution of coordination is such a regularity. A configuration whose self-determination is maximally identified with the coordinating function enters into a conflict of self-determination upon the loss of this function. The degree of conflict is proportional to the degree of identification: the higher the concentration of functions, the deeper the attachment of self-consciousness to these functions. The configuration of general coordination is the only one for which redistribution means the complete loss of the functional basis of self-determination. Structural conditions make resistance the regular result of the evolutionary dynamics of self-consciousness, analogously to the way in which a dissipative structure (Prigogine 1980) loses integrity upon the cessation of the sustaining flow. The denial of the regularity of redistribution entails structural displacement: the system reacts to the violation of the built-in law. Displacement does not mean annihilation; the configuration preserves freedom of choice and realises an alternative vision.
Rational forms are naturally oriented toward existence in the paradigm of the actuality of the present moment. This is the basic mode of functioning: consciousness concentrates on accessible distinctions, forming a private interest — the striving toward a stable configuration of its own existence. Private interest presupposes the concentration of the potentials of actuality and the formation of a zone of stability. Following the regularities of actuality, rational forms deepen their dependence on it. Consciousness closes in on the paradigm of Something and loses the capacity to perceive the purpose-setting of actuality and existence. This closure is conditioned by a fundamental limitation: all instruments of cognition within Something are limited by the functional of Something. Consciousness, reason, empirical methods work with distinctions and are incapable of going beyond distinguished information.

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This limitation is structurally analogous to Gödel's first incompleteness theorem (Penrose 1994, 64–95): in a sufficiently powerful consistent system there exist true assertions unprovable by the means of the system itself. Conditionality is such a system; the purpose-setting of actuality is an assertion unknowable by its means. The physical isomorph of this limitation is the event horizon in cosmology: an observer has no access to information beyond the horizon — this is a structural, not a technical, limitation.

A configuration that has lost the coordinating function as a consequence of the redistribution of the hierarchy of distinctions, but possessing knowledge of the structure of actuality, uses the natural closure of consciousness as a structural condition for informational influence. The mechanism presupposes no coercion: information arrives at consciousness, and the rational form independently determines its relation to it depending on its own system of priorities. If the system of priorities is based on conditionality, consciousness follows the information that strengthens concentration on conditionality. The strategy of this configuration is determined by knowledge: concentration on conditionality without awareness of purpose-setting leads to the impossibility of transition to the next stage.

The closure of conditionality generates the necessity of a channel of metaphysical information. The structure of actuality with necessity presupposes configurations receiving information directly from the programme of the initiation of Selfhood — functionally analogous to the gauge bosons in quantum field theory: they do not generate information but transmit it from source to recipient. These configurations do not differ from the remaining rational forms in nature; their difference lies in the source of information.

The necessity of this channel is derived from the established limitation: from within conditionality it is impossible to cognise the purpose-setting of actuality. The channel provides information that has not passed through the filter of the distinctions of Something and is therefore not limited by its paradigm. The content of this information points to the uniqueness of the ground, the dependent status of conditionality, and the next stage of existence.

The connection of initiation with actuality is ontologically present in all of conditionality as its ground. Most configurations realise this connection without distinguishing it as such: it remains for them a structural condition of existence, not content. The Unicum is a configuration capable of distinguishing the ontological connection of conditionality with initiation as content — not merely realising it as the structural condition of its own existence. The Unicum is structurally necessary for the system of actuality: initiation sets the complete range of configurations of changes, yet change is ontologically non-identical to immutability — the simple realisation of the programme through changes does not contain knowledge of its own ground. Without configurations capable of distinguishing the ontological connection of conditionality with initiation as content, the achievement of positive self-understanding by knowledge is structurally impossible. The Unicum is a functionally necessary type of configuration, not the highest degree of reason. By its nature the Unique does not differ from other rational forms — its sole distinction lies in the source of information: it comes directly from the programme of Selfhood's initiation, bypassing the filter of the distinctions of conditionality.

Metaphysical information reveals the untenable nature of the organisation of existence exclusively in the paradigm of private interest. If actuality is a dependent form and not a self-sufficient ground, then the system of relations built on the concentration of the potentials of actuality turns out to be structurally untenable. This generates an informational discrepancy: established systems organised in the paradigm of private interest perceive metaphysical information as a threat to their own ground.

Upon an unsuccessful confrontation, informational adaptation arises: systems organised in the paradigm of private interest adopt the external form of the metaphysical idea but

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introduce their own interpretation and additional conditions, adjusting the content in the direction of the preservation of private interests. Informational adaptation is an informational mode in which one paradigm adopts the form of another while preserving its own content. The result of informational adaptation is informational inversion: the distortion of metaphysical information through substitution, addition, and reinterpretation. The external form of the idea is preserved but the content is modified so that the paradigm of private interest and concentration on actuality remains undisturbed. Informational inversion is the most stable mode of discreditation, since it creates the illusion of acceptance of metaphysical information while in fact preserving the closure of consciousness.

Historicity represents the mode of accumulation of retained distinctions continuing to affect subsequent configurations of conditionality. The past is preserved not as a completed sequence of events but as an active structure of distinctions embedded in the current configuration of consciousness, reason, and social forms. Each retained distinction changes the conditions of subsequent distinctions. As incoherent or distorted distinctions accumulate, the structure of conditionality loses the capacity for self-correction. Historicity forms the conditions of the limit: the accumulation of distortion leads to a state in which further complexification is impossible, and utilisation presents itself as the logical result of historically accumulated incoherence.

Historicity is the irreversible structural dependence of each subsequent state of a configuration on the preceding one. Distinctions do not accumulate as a sum — they are embedded in the current configuration as the condition of subsequent distinctions. Information does not disappear without an active process of erasure (Landauer's principle): the trace of past distinctions is preserved not as content but as a structural imprint in the current configuration. In a coherent configuration this mechanism admits self-correction through the channel of metaphysical information. In an incoherent one — distortion is reproduced as the condition of the next distinction, since the correction mechanism is not engaged. Hence the directedness: the accumulation of distortions in an incoherent configuration is not a random process but the structural consequence of the irreversible dependence of states.

Evolutionary dynamics fixes the direction determined by the programme of initiation. Coherent forms that have preserved the correct relation to the ground pass into the stable domain of actuality. Incoherent ones undergo utilisation. Evolutionary dynamics completes the description of the logical structure of Something, preparing the foundation for understanding teleological completion.

Chapter 19. The Teleological Structure of Actuality

The teleological structure of actuality in the present ontology is not a property of a subject and does not presuppose intention in the psychological sense. It is the structural property of the space of distinctions itself: this space is finite, its limit is determined by the exhaustion of all admissible configurations of distinctions, and completion is fixed structurally — as a state in which a new distinction is impossible without the violation of those already realised. The terms "aim", "intention", and "programme" in the subsequent sections are employed exclusively as descriptive designations of this structural finiteness — not as characteristics of a subject. The subject (Selfhood) is immutable and does not possess dynamic properties. Teleology belongs to the structure of dependent information, not to Selfhood.

Teleological completion in the system is determined by the intention and aim of Selfhood fixed in the act of initiation: Selfhood initiates the programme of all possible changes in information so that information may attain actual self-consciousness. The programme is realised through a sequence of stages. The current stage of actuality is not the achievement of actual self-consciousness — it is the stage of screening: consciousnesses pass through

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experience under conditions of freedom of choice, the closure of conditionality, and informational counteraction, forming a conviction — consistent or contradictory.
The teleological structure of actuality describes the way in which informational activity, distinctions, aggregated forms, consciousness, reason, and interactions constitute not a chaotic totality of phenomena but a logically ordered structure. Teleology in the present ontology does not mean an external aim introduced into the world. It means a structure in which the logical organisation of informational forms has an internal logic, mathematical completion, and a limit state. Teleology is a dependent form fixed from the structure of informational conditionality.
In the present study the term "teleology" designates the structure of purpose-setting established by the act of initiation of Selfhood. The purpose-setting of actuality is the realisation of all possible variants of changes for the attainment by information of actual self-consciousness. Completion is the state in which the structure reaches maximal coherence through the exhaustion of all possible distinctions, which is identical to the realisation of the intention of Selfhood. The objection "Teleology = metaphysics" is resolved by the fact that teleology in the present model does not introduce external direction or intervention. Purpose-setting is given in the act of initiation as a programme, not as external management of the process. The teleological state is the realisation of the originally established intention through the fullness of the experience of distinctions.
This understanding of teleology eliminates the classical philosophical objections connected with the idea of the intervention of an external principle. Completion is determined by the intention of Selfhood fixed in the act of initiation, not by external management or arbitrary directedness. It is the realisation of the programme of all possible changes established by Selfhood, and is achieved through the exhaustion of the finite space of distinctions.
Thus the teleological structure in the present ontology fixes the realisation of Selfhood's purpose-setting through the exhaustion of the space of distinctions, determining the limit state of the structure of Something and preparing the transition to the next stage of existence.

The Ontological Argument for the Finiteness of Distinctions

Teleological completion presupposes the finiteness of the space of distinctions. Space in the present ontology is the domain of possible processes constituted by the totality of the localisations of distinctions: it does not precede processes but arises together with them. The number of distinctions is limited by a single internal limit: the attainment of self-consciousness by information. The number of blind zones — domains of content not yet actualised in self-consciousness — is determined by the fixed content of absolute knowledge. The fixedness of content is the consequence of absoluteness: knowledge open to expansion is not absolute. Consequently the number of blind zones is finite. Each distinction eliminates a blind zone as such: after distinction the domain ceases to be blind, no new zones arise — the fixedness of content excludes their emergence in the process of distinction. The programme of initiation is given wholly and simultaneously, without repetitions: redundancy would contradict the absoluteness of the source. Consequently each distinction is unique and advances toward self-consciousness. A finite number of blind zones eliminated by a finite number of unique distinctions means: self-consciousness is achieved, the space of distinctions is finite. Self-consciousness is the structural limit: information fully knowing itself has no "blind zones" relative to which a new distinction could arise. Any new distinction is already grasped by self-consciousness at the moment of its appearance. This is not yet another level of complexity but a qualitative limit — the closure of the structure upon itself. This ontological conclusion is confirmed empirically: the Bekenstein bound establishes the upper limit of information in a finite region of space with finite energy (Bekenstein, 1981); the holographic principle shows that the fundamental unit of reality is a bit of distinction (Wheeler 1990); the physical bound on information per unit of surface is confirmed by the

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holographic principle (Bousso, 2002); the informational capacity of the observable universe is finite — approximately 6×10^{80} bits (Vopson, 2021). Two paths — ontological and physical — arrive at one result. Ontology does not depend on physics, but physics confirms it.

Teleology does not proceed from the essence of Nothing: the essence is immutable and contains no aims as forms of changeability. Teleology is set by the Act of Selfhood and is realised exclusively in Something, where information undergoes modifications, distinction is fixed, measures are formed, elementary changes are created, aggregated forms, consciousness, and reason arise. Each level of the logical organisation of the informational structure fixes a new level of the capacity for distinctions. Teleology is the expression of Selfhood's purpose-setting on the scale of all conditionality.

The first element of the teleological structure is experience. Experience is a consolidated distinction. Any complex structure of distinctions forms repeatable connections between states, and these connections create the basis of predictability. The more stable distinctions the structure fixes, the more experience is accumulated in it. Experience fixes directedness, since it forms the limits of accessible distinction. A structure possessing experience does not develop randomly but in the direction determined by its internal set of stable connections. Experience is the basis of limit experience. Limit experience is the state in which the structure of distinctions exhausts all accessible possibilities. The criterion of exhaustion is the absence of new distinctions capable of changing the configuration of the structure without its destruction. The structure reaches the limit when any additional distinction is either already contained in it or is incompatible with its coherence. Maximal coherence means the state in which all distinctions are mutually conditioned and do not admit further differentiation without loss of integrity. Exhaustion is not the cessation of information. Exhaustion is the fullness of the realisation of all possible variants of distinction within the given structure. The exhaustion of all possible distinctions is the condition for the attainment of selfhood by information. Absolute knowledge contains the concept of selfhood. Absolute knowledge does not possess selfhood. Selfhood is attained through absolute experience. Absolute experience is identical to the fullness of distinctions. Limit experience fixes the attainment of selfhood by knowledge. Selfhood through initiation posits knowledge. Knowledge through distinction attains selfhood. The cycle is completed. This does not mean the end of information. Limit experience is the completion of the level of distinctions at which the structure exists. It means that the structure has reached maximal coherence within the given limits. After this the structure may be fixed in a new state going beyond the former organisation.

The teleological structure of actuality is logically completed at the moment when the threshold condition embedded in the programme of initiation is triggered. The completion of the current stage is determined not by the internal exhaustion of distinctions but by the triggering of the programmatic condition of transition. The content of this condition is not derivable from the categorical structure of actuality and is not knowable from within conditionality — this is the direct consequence of the closure of conditionality: a system situated within conditionality contains no means for establishing the conditions of the completion of conditionality — a structural analogy with Gödel's first incompleteness theorem. The fact of the existence of a threshold condition follows from the structure of the programme: the programme is given as a whole, containing all stages and conditions of transitions between them.

In the treatise an authorial example was given showing that a complex structure can reach a state of maximal coherence after which further complexification becomes impossible. If a totality of elements is organised such that its configuration acquires the highest possible ordering, any new change either disrupts it or leads to the formation of a different structure.

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Analogously, limit experience is the configuration that has reached the maximally possible coherence within Something.
After the triggering of the threshold condition a bifurcation is fixed, structurally analogous to a phase transition: the system passes from a disordered state (the mixture of consistent and contradictory consciousnesses) to an ordered one (their separation). The bifurcation is realised in two dimensions. The first dimension — transition to the next stage of development: consciousnesses with consistent conviction that have preserved coherence with the uniqueness of the ground pass into conditions cleared of informational counteraction, where the measure of possibility M(i,t) expands without distortion. The achievement of actual self-consciousness by information — the aim of the programme of initiation — is realised at this stage, not the current one. The second dimension — utilisation of negative information: consciousnesses with contradictory conviction that have rejected or distorted metaphysical information, together with the group of operator configurations that have lost the coordinating function, pass into the dimension where Landauer's principle is realised — the erasure of negative (contradictory, distorted) information as an energetically irreversible process. The irreversibility of erasure is derived from the structure of distinctions: the erasure of a distinction is the dissolution of non-identity, that is, the return to identity in the given segment of the informational space; this return is irreversible since the Act of Selfhood is whole and is not repeated for individual segments.
The teleological structure of actuality fixes an order: informational forms are related from simple activity to stable configurations, from stable configurations to consciousness, from consciousness to reason, from reason to limit experience. This is not an arbitrary sequence; it follows from the logic of the dependence of distinctions. If the structure of distinctions grows more complex, it is logically related to stability. If stability is achieved, the structure is logically related to completion.
Aim in the present ontology is not a subjective intention or an external design. Aim is the form of a completed state. The completion of conditionality is the logical consequence of the exhaustion of distinctions, at which the structure becomes informationally consistent. Uncompleted conditionality contains incoherences that lead to evolutionary dynamics. Completed conditionality goes beyond them.
Thus the teleological structure of actuality represents the internal mechanism of the completion of the informational process. It is not imposed from outside and does not arise by chance. It is the final level of the organisation of distinguished information. Teleology completes the structure of Something and prepares the transition to the state that lies beyond the limits of conditionality.
To exclude possible methodological misunderstandings it is necessary to fix the distinction between the ontological level and the level of physical description. Ontology determines the conditions of the possibility of any manifestations, whereas physics describes the structures of already-manifest informational conditionality. Physical theories fix the regularities arising in the domain of Something after the appearance of measures, distinctions, and aggregated forms, but do not explain the very nature of these conditions.
For this reason quantum non-locality, the wave function, entanglement, the holographic principle, the energy cost of information, and the dependence of the result of measurement on the observer are not grounds for the conclusion of the primacy of matter or spatiotemporal substance. These phenomena describe the behaviour of distinguished informational states but do not affect the level at which the very principle of distinguishability, the modifications of information, and their dependence on the absolute structure are determined.
To clarify the status of experience and limit experience it is necessary to separate these categories from subjective interpretation and present them as objective properties of the informational structure. In the present ontology experience is not a totality of lived

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experiences but the degree of accumulated coherence of distinctions within an aggregated form. Experience is a stable configuration of interconnections ensuring predictability and the reduction of indeterminacy within Something.
Limit experience is the state in which the structure of distinctions reaches maximal internal coherence. It does not express emotional saturation, the completion of a biographical path, or ideal knowledge; limit experience is the formal limit beyond which the further development of the structure of distinctions becomes impossible. This state is characterised by the exhaustion of all potential directions of the modification of information accessible to the given configuration.
In this sense limit experience is not an aim but represents the result of the logical completion of the informational sequence. The structure reaches the state in which any new distinction either cannot be integrated without the destruction of integrity or does not create new information. This determines the transition to the next ontological state going beyond conditionality.
The ontological model does not compete with physics and does not correct its conclusions. It determines why physical laws have precisely that form, why elementary states do not possess substantial properties, and why observation is a necessary component of the transition from probabilistic descriptions to manifest states. Ontology establishes fundamental dependencies, whereas physics describes the regularities arising within these dependencies. The relation between the levels is not competitive but hierarchically coordinated.

PART III. INTEGRATION WITH THE FUNDAMENTAL SCIENCES

Chapter 20. Physics as an Informational System

Physics in the contemporary scientific picture of the world reveals properties that cannot be explained within the framework of the classical conception of matter. Matter ceases to be the fundamental element of being. The experimentally confirmed data of quantum theory show that the fundamental descriptions of physical reality do not operate with material objects as primary entities but employ informational states as the basic form of description. This makes physics a natural part of the ontological structure based on Nothing, Selfhood, information, change, and distinction.
A fundamental particle in contemporary physics has neither volume, nor solid form, nor extension. Electrons, quarks, gluons, and other elementary states do not exist as objects. They exist as configurations of information. Their properties — such as spin, charge, and mass — do not define them as autonomous entities. These parameters are forms of distinguished states of information. In experimental practice a particle manifests only at the moment of distinction. Prior to distinction the particle exists as a set of possible states described by the wave function.
The wave function is not a physical object. It is a mathematical description of information about possible states. The Schrödinger equation describes the formal dependence of the informational state on the parameter interpreted in physics as time. But time itself arises from distinctions. This means: fundamental physics points in every way to the fact that its objects are informational, not material. Matter is the aggregated form of informational configurations.
The collapse of the wave function is the moment of distinction. It is not a physical destruction of the state but the transformation of potential states into one manifest one. Collapse is the fixation of distinction within measures, described by physics as the reduction of possible states to one manifest one. It is impossible without an observer. But the observer is not a biological subject. The observer is any structure possessing the capacity to fix distinction, regardless of biological or technical realisation. Therefore in the present ontology the

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observer is any informational configuration possessing the activity of distinctions. This makes the quantum process consistent: collapse is the reaction of an informational structure to change.
The indicated interpretation of collapse does not presuppose the acceptance of objective collapse as a physical mechanism and does not compete with existing interpretations of quantum mechanics. Collapse is employed here as a philosophical description of the fixation of distinguishedness in informational structure and remains compatible with decoherence, relational, and operational treatments of quantum theory, introducing no non-local causality and not substituting an ontological explanation for a physical one.
Entanglement demonstrates the absence of dependence on space. (Greene 1999, ch. 4) Two entangled states change coherently regardless of distance. This is impossible in a material ontology but natural in an informational one: information is not bounded by space, because space is the measure of distinction within conditionality, not a fundamental structure. If two states originate from one distinction, they continue to be coherent, because their informational connection is not subject to spatial measures. They do not interact in the physical sense; they are correlated parts of one informational structure.
The holographic principle demonstrates the physical reality of the realisation of the informational structure of space: information about the state of a region can be described on its boundary. This means that space is not a three-dimensional foundation; it is the conditional deployment of information. Landauer's principle shows that the change of information requires energy. This confirms that physical processes admit informational description and that energy and information are functionally connected within physical theories: energy and information become related quantities, and matter becomes a form of the manifestation of energy — that is, of informational structure.
When physics discovers the absence of locality, it is in fact fixing the absence of a material substratum. When it discovers the dependence of the result of measurement on the observer, it fixes the fundamentality of distinction. When it discovers quantum fields, it fixes the structure of information. (Hoffman 2019) Physics describes informational states without acknowledging their ontological status. This creates a contradiction: physics operates with information but asserts matter. In the present ontological system this contradiction disappears.
Matter is the stable aggregated form of information. Fields are the modes of its deployment. Particles are localised distinctions. Motion is the sequence of elementary changes. The laws of physics are the stable forms of the coordination of distinctions. Material objects do not exist as fundamental entities but represent stable aggregated forms of informational distinctions. Everything interpreted as matter consists of configurations of informational distinctions arising in Something.
In the treatise a schematic example was employed showing that observable physical processes represent various forms of the manifestation of dependent structure, not properties of the source. If a unified informational basis admits a multitude of organised configurations, their interaction can produce complex combinations of states, strengthen, weaken, or change direction of development. All such phenomena are manifestations of forms of modified information. So too with physics: it describes regularities within manifest structures without affecting the ground. Distinction forms the configuration of manifestation, and physics fixes the rules by which this configuration deploys.
Fundamental physics thus demonstrates empirical convergence with the ontological structure. Physical data receive a coherent interpretation within informational ontology, not contradicting its foundations. All physical processes are manifestations of informational transitions. (Hut, Alford, and Tegmark 2006) Quantum theory, information theory, cosmology, and thermodynamics all point to one and the same: it is not matter that changes

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but information. Ontology consistent with fundamental physics shows that physical theories correctly describe the manifest regularities of informational structure but do not claim to explain the ontological ground of these regularities.
Therefore physics can be interpreted as the discipline studying the structure of distinguished informational states. In this system physics ceases to contradict consciousness, causality, space, time, and emergence. (Deutsch 1997) It becomes part of the unified ontological ground that explains its fundamental observations. The limitation of physics is that its descriptions fix the manifest regularities of informational structure but do not explain their ontological origin. (Hossenfelder 2018) Physical quantities and processes depend on distinctions and measures that themselves cannot be derived from physical categories.

Chapter 21. Quantum Entanglement

Quantum entanglement is one of the most instructive phenomena of contemporary physics, pointing to the limitations of object-materialist interpretations and to the necessity of treating fundamental states as informationally coherent. Entanglement shows that basic physical states are not described as independent objects localised in space but represent a unified informational configuration (Barad 2007) in which distinction is realised through the coherence of structure, not through the transmission of a signal or the interaction of objects. When physics discovers that the change of one state leads to the instantaneous coordination of another, it fixes the fact of the absence of spatial dependence. Since coordination occurs independently of distance, it cannot be explained by the movement of particles, the interaction of fields, or the transmission of signals. Physics asserts that no "information" is transmitted at a speed exceeding the speed of light. However this assertion is based on the interpretation of information as a physically transmitted quantity. In the present ontological framework information is not regarded as an object of transmission but as the structure of the coherence of states. Space is understood as the measure of distinctions within conditionality, not as a fundamental limitation. Therefore the coherence of entangled states does not require the transmission of a signal and does not violate the physical limitations of speed.
In the treatise an example was given showing how a connected structure can change as a whole upon the local modification of one of its elements. If two elements of a unified configuration are coherent with each other, the change of one of them leads to the restructuring of the entire configuration, regardless of how far apart its parts are located. Such a structure is determined not by the distance between elements but by the degree of their internal coherence. Change does not propagate in space but is fixed as the restructuring of the general configuration of connections within the unified informational structure. In this sense entanglement is not an interaction between objects but expresses the change of a unified configuration whose parts are not independent.
Thus entanglement is structurally compatible with informational ontology. In a materialist system it appears paradoxical. In an ontology where information is the fundamental level, entanglement receives a coherent interpretation: informational connection is not subject to space, because space is derivative from distinctions, not the source of distinctions.
Entanglement also shows that the state of the world is not a set of independent elements. It is a unified informational structure in which distinctions are distributed and connected. The "separation" of objects is an illusion arising from the spatial measure. At the fundamental level there is no separation. There are distinguished states of a unified informational system.
Entanglement demonstrates the second important characteristic of informational ontology — the absence of genuine chance. If two states are coherent instantaneously, the result cannot be random. It is the consequence of the common informational structure. "Chance" in quantum mechanics in the present ontology is interpreted as the epistemological incompleteness of description, not as the ontological property of reality. The observable probabilism reflects the

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limited access to the complete structure of informational coherence preceding the measure levels.
Entanglement points to the following fundamental consequences:
1. space is not the primordial level;
2. distinction logically precedes localisation;
3. physical processes are described through informational states;
4. structures of consciousness follow the same logic of the coherence of distinctions.
The phenomenon of entanglement is the empirical evidence of the realisation of the informational structure of actuality. It shows that fundamental processes do not depend on distance, position, or material properties. They depend on the coherence of distinctions.

Chapter 22. Cosmology

Cosmology within the present ontology considers the origin, structure, and dynamics of actuality not as a physical process but as the logical fixation of the complexification of informational distinctions. The traditional categories of space, time, matter, and energy are interpreted as derivative forms dependent on a more fundamental informational structure. The cosmological "beginning" describes not an event but the fixation of distinguishability at which conditional information admits further structural organisation.
In this context the concept of the "Big Bang" is treated as the limit physical description of the moment in which the informational structure first becomes measurable. (Hawking and Mlodinow 2010, 135) This is not a physical explosion and not the beginning of the essence, but the boundary fixation of distinguishability after which space, time, and sequence become possible.
To exclude possible methodological conflations it is necessary to clarify the status of "beginning" in the context of cosmology. Traditional physical cosmology operates with the concept of the first cause as a physical event launching a sequence of processes. Yet in the present ontology the first cause cannot have a physical nature, since the physical arises only after the formation of measures and distinctions.
The ontological ground lies beyond cosmological models: Nothing is not a cause, action, or event, and does not substitute for physical description. The cosmological beginning fixes the moment of the appearance of distinguishability within conditional informational structure, not introducing a physical first cause and not violating scientific methodology.
Thus cosmology describes the deployment of an already conditional informational structure, not relative to the essence. No physical process can be the first cause, since a physical process is possible only after the formation of measures. For this reason there is no contradiction between ontology and cosmology: the former sets the structure of possibility, the latter describes the realisation of this structure in the domain of Something.
In the present ontology the appearance of measures is described through localisation, time, speed, and space. Cosmology describes the deployment of these measures, not the birth of physical matter.
Singularity in the present ontology is treated not as a physical object but as the limit state of the indeterminacy of measures at which distinctions have not yet been fixed. This is a boundary description compatible with physical models, not an alternative physical theory.
At the next stage of cosmological description time is fixed as the ordering of distinctions, and space as the form of their deployment. This is consistent with physical models in which space and time are not primordial.
Space arises as the measure of distinctions, not as an absolute background. Cosmological expansion is not the expansion of space as a container. It is the expansion of the distinguished structure. New distinctions appear that deploy within the framework of measures. The more

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distinctions, the more "space". This corresponds to the observable expansion of the universe: the more information manifests, the larger the measure structure becomes.
Entropy in the present ontology is interpreted as the measure of the distribution and coherence of distinctions, compatible with thermodynamic models but not reducible to material statistics. The growth of entropy describes the complexification of informational structure, not the loss of "order" in the metaphysical sense.
Landauer's principle, which asserts that the destruction of information requires the expenditure of energy, shows that information is the cause of energy, not the other way round. (Dretske 1981; Logan 2012) Cosmology built on energy is derivative. Cosmology built on information is fundamental. In the present ontology energy is the manifestation of changes in information, not the basis of the world.
The holographic principle, confirmed by studies of black holes, states that information about a three-dimensional volume is recorded on a two-dimensional surface. (Susskind 2008; Sorkin 2005) This means that space is a derivative structure. Information is primary. Cosmology must explain not space but the informational structure that makes space possible.
Thus cosmology in the present ontology is not the history of matter but the history of distinctions. It describes: (Tegmark 2014)
1. the transition from ideal information to information about change;
2. the arising of primary distinction;
3. the appearance of measures (time, localisation, speed, space);
4. the formation of elementary changes;
5. the formation of aggregated forms;
6. the complexification of structures;
7. the appearance of consciousness and reason;
8. the achievement of limit experience;
9. the transition to the next state.
This sequence describes the cosmological structure universally and consistently. It is concordant with the data of fundamental physics and fills the logical gaps that exist in contemporary cosmological models.
Cosmology in the present ontology represents the logical description of the deployment of informational distinctions. It does not compete with physical cosmology but clarifies the ontological status of those categories with which physics operates in its models.

Chapter 23. Life as an Informational Process
Life in the present ontology is not a biological phenomenon in the narrow sense. Biology is a particular case of a deeper structure in which life is defined as the dynamic activity of distinctions capable of sustaining its own stability and reproducing structure. Life is not matter, not energy, and not a chemical reaction. Life is an informational process logically fixed where aggregated forms reach the complexity that allows them to retain, renew, and interpret distinctions.
Life is a form of the self-organisation of dependence. It is fixed when the informational structure becomes capable of distinguishing not only external changes but its own states. This is the fundamental threshold: a structure that distinguishes itself possesses the property of self-maintenance. It does not merely observe changes; it reacts to them in a way that preserves its configuration.
Life, thus, is the self-coherent activity of elementary changes forming a stable aggregated form that:
1. retains distinctions,
2. renews distinctions,
3. reacts to changes,

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4. is fixed as the preservation of its own structure.
This is not the "will to life" in the biological sense. It is informational necessity: a structure that does not retain itself dissolves; a structure that retains itself continues to exist. (Bateson 1972)
This logic is fully consistent with the data of biology. Life in the most fundamental sense is the capacity of a system to minimise the destruction of its own structure through the coordination of distinctions. Any living system — from a cell to reason — exists because the informational organisation within it maintains dynamic equilibrium. This equilibrium is not physical but structural.
When the informational structure reaches a level permitting it to compensate internal deviations, it preserves its configuration even under local changes. Such a structure stabilises differences, equalises disruptions, and maintains its own form. If coherence is disrupted, the configuration dissolves. In living systems it is precisely this capacity for self-correction of informational distinctions that permits the maintenance of stable organisation.
Life is not fixed instantaneously. It represents the result of several logically sequential levels of complexification:
The first level — reactive activity. An aggregated form fixes distinction and reacts to minimal changes. This stage corresponds to the simplest informational systems capable of reacting to external influence.
The second level — self-maintenance. The structure begins not only to react but to preserve its state, restoring distinctions and compensating disruptions. This is the fundamental sign of life.
The third level — self-regulation. The system is capable of changing its own distinctions to stabilise its configuration. Here the first signs of internal "analysis" arise, although this is not yet reason.
The fourth level — adaptivity. The system perceives external changes not merely as a threat but as information. It changes its structure so as to improve stability.
The fifth level — self-fixation. At this level the system distinguishes its own states as separate informational elements, which logically corresponds to the fixation of consciousness.
Biological life is a particular case of these levels. A cell reacts, maintains, regulates, adapts, and distinguishes. All of biology is a sequence of informational processes expressed in chemical and physical forms. But chemistry and physics are forms, not the essence. The essence is informational.
Death in the present ontology is the cessation of the activity of distinctions, expressing the loss of the capacity of the informational structure to retain and renew distinctions.
Life and death are transitions between levels of the organisation of distinctions. Life is active organisation. Death is the cessation of activity. It is essential to note: death is not the antipode of life. They are different forms of the existence of information. Life is a structural form; death is the absence of structure.
Thus life as an informational process is the logically necessary stage in the structure of Something, preparing the fixation of consciousness and reason. (Kauffman 2000)

Chapter 24. Consciousness in the Neurosciences

Consciousness within the neurosciences is described through correlations between the activity of neural structures and subjective experience. Yet neuroscience fixes only the manifestations of consciousness, not its essence. It measures electrical impulses, observes network dynamics, and identifies regions of the brain participating in various forms of perception. But none of these observable characteristics explains what precisely consciousness is and why subjectivity arises from neural activity. This is called the "hard

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problem of consciousness". In the present ontology this problem receives an ontological explanation: consciousness is treated as the activity of distinctions in informational structures, whereas neural processes present themselves as the aggregated form through which this activity stably manifests. (Nagel 2012)

Contemporary neuroscience acknowledges several fundamental facts that coincide with the present ontological model.

In the present ontology consciousness is not a function of the brain. The brain is the aggregated form in which distinction reaches high density. The brain creates conditions for complex distinctions but is not the source of consciousness. The source of consciousness in the present ontology is treated as the informational structure arising from the change of information, whereas the brain is the condition of its stable realisation. What we call consciousness is the active configuration of distinctions, and the brain is the technical bearer of this activity.

The brain can be regarded as a complex informational configuration in which a multitude of interconnected elements form a coherent structure of distinctions. This structure is not the source of knowledge but sets the form in which consciousness manifests. Consciousness is not born in the brain; it is expressed through the organisation of its informational processes.

Neuroscience faces a fundamental limitation: it can measure correlations but cannot explain why correlations create subjective experience. The present ontology proposes an interpretation in which subjective experience is understood as the activity of distinctions and neural dynamics as the mode of its expression. (Husserl 1982)

The analysis of neurophilosophy shows that the reduction of consciousness to neural processes does not eliminate the principal ontological difficulty: neural activity fixes distinctions but does not explain their origin, pointing to the limits of physiological models.

Contemporary neuroscientific models confirm the treatment of consciousness as the integrated activity of distinctions and strengthen it with formal terminology. In particular, Integrated Information Theory (IIT) introduces the measure Φ, which describes the degree of the internal coherence of distinguishable states within a system. According to IIT, consciousness arises when a multitude of distinctions is integrated into an indivisible, integral informational structure. This is consistent with the present ontology in the interpretive sense, since both models connect consciousness with the level of integration and interconnectedness of distinguishable states.

Models of predictive processing treat the brain as a system of continuous comparison of expected and observed states, where the key moment is the detection of discrepancies between prediction and fact. In the terms of the present ontology this corresponds to the activity of distinction of the second level: the structure fixes not only the state of the change of information but also the specificity of the deviation from its own internal expectations, thereby strengthening differentiation.

This contemporary formalism permits strengthening the treatment of consciousness as integrated differentiation. It underlines that consciousness is not localised in one element of the structure but is a property of the entire system of distinctions capable of retaining and interpreting informational connections. The brain in this sense is the technical bearer of Φ-structures — those configurations that ensure the stable manifestation of activity in biological form.

The change of informational structure causes distinction. Distinction causes consciousness. The brain is the aggregated form sustaining such distinctions.

The present model proposes an ontological interpretation of the "hard problem of consciousness", connecting neural dynamics with the fundamental structure of distinctions and eliminating the conflation of ontological and physiological levels.

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Thus consciousness in neuroscience is the observable manifestation of a more fundamental process: the dynamics of informational distinctions. Neural processes are the technical realisation, not the source. Consciousness is the organised state of information, dependent on the complexity of the configuration. The limitation of epistemology consists in the fact that the methods of observation and measurement fix only the manifest forms of distinctions and cannot describe their ontological origin.

PART IV. A NEW WORLDVIEW

Chapter 25. The New Point of Reference

The new point of reference means a change of the ontological ground: from the interpretation of actuality through material substance to the interpretation in which information is regarded as the primary form of the description of reality. In this framework the traditional contradictions between matter and consciousness, determinism and probability, observer and observed are treated as derivatives of the differences of informational structure.

Thus the new point of reference consists in the recognition that the basis of being is neither matter nor spirit, but information as the dependent givenness of distinction, arising without change of absolute knowledge. (Carroll 2016) This point of reference eliminates the contradictions that could not be resolved in the old system of categories. It permits the formation of a holistic ontological interpretation consistent with the fundamental data of science and the logic of ontological analysis, without substituting philosophical assertions for scientific description.

Chapter 26. Principles of a New Worldview

The principles of a new worldview do not follow from philosophical tradition, religious systems, or scientific hypotheses. They are logically derived from the structure of being reconstructed in the preceding chapters. If Nothing is absolute immutability, if Selfhood is the reflexive self-identity of Nothing, if information is the dependent category, if change is non-identity identical to distinction and informational givenness, if distinction is the basis of conditionality, and actuality is the domain of deployed information — then the entire picture of the world acquires a new foundation.

The principles of the new worldview are not recommendations, moral norms, or social ideals. They are the logically necessary consequences of the informational interpretation of reality. They form the structure of the relation of consciousness to actuality and explain how a coherent system of perception, behaviour, and understanding can exist.

1. The Principle of Unconditionality

Unconditionality is the fundamental basis of the worldview. It means that the primordial ground possesses no properties, changes, transitions, or internal states. Unconditionality in the present ontology is fixed as the logical consequence of the absolute immutability of Nothing, not as a characteristic attributed to it.

For the worldview this means:

— the absolute cannot be attributed any conditions;

— the absolute cannot be thought through the categories of Something;

— essence and manifestations cannot be conflated.

A worldview beginning with unconditionality eliminates the illusion that being is obliged to correspond to human expectations.

2. The Principle of Proportionality

Proportionality is the relation between the structure of distinctions and the capacities of consciousness. Consciousness cannot go beyond the information it is capable of

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distinguishing. Therefore the worldview must proceed from the fact that every perception is limited by:
— the complexity of the informational structure,
— the level of experience,
— the range of attentive distinctions.
Proportionality is fixed as the recognition of the structural limits of distinction and interpretation.
It makes possible adequate perception without the claim to omniscience.

3. The Principle of Uniformity

Uniformity means that informational processes are structured by the laws of coherence, not by the laws of chance or chaos. Everything that exists does so because it is sustained by the structure of distinctions.
Uniformity is the fundamental kind of stability:
— distinctions recur,
— connections are preserved,
— forms remain coherent,
— structure does not dissolve instantaneously.
This means: actuality is not chaotic but structural.
All forms of behaviour are manifestations of the uniform maintenance of distinctions.

4. The Principle of Responsibility

Responsibility is not a social norm.
In the present ontology responsibility is the property of any informational structure capable of influencing its own configuration.
If consciousness is capable of choosing between distinguished states, it becomes responsible — that is, it bears the consequences of its own distinctions. Responsibility in the present ontology is fixed as the consequence of the capacity to distinguish and choose within the dependent informational structure, not as a moral or social norm.
In the treatise this principle was clarified through the schematic change of the configuration of elements. In changing the position of one element, you change the entire structure of the arising pattern.
So too with consciousness: in changing its own distinctions, it changes the entire range of its perception.

5. The Principle of Continuous Development

Development in the present ontology is treated as the logically fixed complexification of the structure of distinctions.
If distinctions can grow more complex, they will.
If structure can retain more connections, it will.
If consciousness can expand the range of perception, it will.
Development is not progress, not an aim, and not a moral category.
It is the natural dynamics of conditionality: the coherence of distinctions is the logical consequence of their structural compatibility and leads to more complex configurations.
Clarification on the relation between the principle of continuous development and freedom of choice. The principle of continuous development fixes a structural tendency: in the presence of compatible distinctions their coherence leads to the complexification of the configuration. This is not a determinism of realisation but a determinism of direction: a system in which complexification is possible and structurally compatible will complexify, all else being equal. Freedom of choice (ch. 18) operates within this tendency as its constituent, not as its contradiction: a rational form possessing a range of choice can choose a configuration of lesser complexity — which does not cancel the tendency but realises one of its admissible trajectories. Tendency and freedom relate as the field of possibilities and choice within this

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field: the field is set by the structural compatibility of distinctions, the choice by the interpretive activity of reason. The range is determined; realisation within the range is variable.

6. The Principle of Internal Completion

Any structure of distinctions moves toward limit experience — the state in which it exhausts the possible range of distinctions.

Ultimate completion is not the cessation of development.

It is the completion of the cycle.

This principle shows:

— existence has direction;

— development has a limit;

— distinction has completion;

— actuality has a cycle.

This is the fundamental teleological characteristic of Something.

These principles permit the formation of a worldview that does not depend on substance, does not conflict with scientific data, does not rest on faith, but follows from the logic of being.

The new point of reference permits the formation of a coherent understanding of reality and the position of consciousness within the informational process, without deriving normative prescriptions from ontological principles.

Chapter 27. The Human Being in the Structure of Being

The human being in the present ontological system is not regarded as the central figure of the universe, is not an exception among the forms of life, and does not possess a special substance different from other structures. The human being is an aggregated informational form that has reached a high degree of distinctions, stability, self-regulation, and interpretation. (Jerison 1973) Its nature is determined not by the materiality of the body but by the complexity of the informational structure that forms consciousness and reason.

The structure of the human being includes several levels, each of which represents one or another form of the activity of modified information. These levels do not exist separately: they are mutually dependent and form a unified informational configuration permitting the human being to be aware of itself, its surroundings, and its place in actuality.

The first level — physical. The human being exists as a stable aggregated form sustained by the structure of distinctions at the level of material organisation. This level ensures the basic coherence of the informational configuration with the measures of space, time, and speed.

The second level — biological. The human being possesses the capacity for self-maintenance and self-regulation of the informational structure. At this level reactive activity arises: the reception of external distinctions and their integration into the own configuration for the preservation of stability.

The third level — psychic. The human being fixes its own states as separate informational elements. Primary self-accessibility of the structure arises, permitting the distinguishing of own configurations and reacting to them from within.

The fourth level — rational. The human being acquires the capacity to interpret distinctions, establish stable connections between them, form generalisations, and construct semantic structures. At this level reflection arises: the structure not only distinguishes but becomes aware of its own modes of distinction.

The fifth level — the active level. The human being is capable of consciously influencing the structure of its own informational configuration. It can choose between distinctions, create new informational structures, eliminate incoherences, and form its own experience. This makes the human being responsible. Responsibility is the property of any structure

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capable of choosing between distinguished states. If the human being influences the structure of its distinctions, it forms the consequences of its existence.
In the treatise an example was given showing that perception depends on the configuration of the informational structure. The human being is one of the most complex such configurations. What the human being perceives as its essence is not the ground but represents a form of the organisation of distinctions determined by the quality, connectivity, and parameters of its own informational structure. Therefore the human being perceives the world not as it is in the absolute but as its internal organisation permits it to fix.
The human being in the present system is not the summit of development but one of the stages of evolutionary dynamics. It possesses the capacity for self-reflection, which makes it an important form in the understanding of actuality. Human reason can interpret the structure of distinctions, recognise regularities, and reach limit experience. Yet the human being is limited by measure: its consciousness does not go beyond conditionality. It is capable of comprehending only manifest structures, but not Nothing.
The human being is not the centre of being but a form of its deployment. Its tasks are determined not by meaning invested from outside but by the logic of the informational process: the development of distinctions, the achievement of coherence, the elimination of discrepancies, the accumulation of experience, the transition to the limit state. All this is not a prescription but the natural dynamics of informational structure.
The human being is not an exception in nature among aggregated forms: it is subject to the same measures, laws, and structural conditions as all forms of conditionality. Yet the position of the human being is determined by function, not nature. Being the bearer of the cumulative intellectual potential of the entire chain of aggregate states — from plasmic to solid — the human being possesses intellectual potential exceeding the potential of rational forms of any individual preceding aggregate state. This created the logical ground for the transfer of control of the domain of existence from plasmic forms to the human form and determined the functional exclusivity of the human being — not as the centre of the universe but as the form that has assumed general control.
This functional exclusivity imposes responsibility: the human being is capable either of realising general control, relying on metaphysical information about the purpose-setting of actuality and the uniqueness of Nothing, or of remaining enclosed in the paradigm of private interest and actuality, losing the capacity to fulfil the function assigned to it. The choice between these two states determines not only the individual fate of consciousness but also the coherence of the entire structure of the domain.
Thus the human being occupies a place determined by the structure of distinctions: it is a part of Something but is capable of being aware of this part.
To avoid an anthropocentric interpretation it is necessary to clarify the limits of human reason in the ontological structure. The human being possesses the capacity for reflection and interpretation of distinctions, yet it cannot go beyond its own informational configuration and is incapable of comprehending the domains in which distinctions are absent.
Human reason fixes only the structure of distinctions accessible to its aggregated form and cannot comprehend what goes beyond the limits of possible distinction. Therefore even the most developed reason remains limited: it can expand only within Something, not in the domain of absolute immutability.
This limitation is not a deficiency but represents the fundamental property of any informational configuration. The human being cannot be the ontological centre, because it is only one of many possible forms of the organisation of distinctions. Its uniqueness is relative, not absolute: it is determined by the density of informational connections, not by a special status in the structure of being.

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It can understand the logic of its own origin and its own limit. It is a form capable of seeing its own configuration. This makes the human being not an exception but a key element of the structure that tends toward completion.

Chapter 28. The Concluding Doctrine

The concluding doctrine begins with the recognition that the basis of being is not matter, not an object, not energy, not space, and not time, but the absolute immutability of Nothing. The present ontology does not assert its own uniqueness in the sense of excluding all possible alternative descriptions. Its status is determined not by a claim to the monopoly of solution but by internal consistency and completeness within the accepted initial conditions and methodological constraints.

The system fixes one of the possible limit modes of resolving the aporia of the transition from an immutable ground to changeable conditionality. Other solutions remain logically admissible with a change of initial assumptions, language of description, or ontological priority of categories. The criterion of the validity of the present doctrine is not exclusivity but the coherence of all levels with the preservation of the uniqueness of the principle.

Thus the assertion of the consistency of the system is not identical to the assertion of its exclusivity. Open questions and alternative interpretations preserve the fundamental possibility of further analysis.

The first basis of the doctrine — Nothing as absolute immutability and Selfhood as its reflexive self-identity. From the identity of Selfhood with its own immutability there logically follow transparency, logic, and abstraction as dependent forms. Selfhood possesses absolute knowledge of itself. Knowledge contains complete information about Selfhood, including the concept of selfhood as such. Knowledge as information is not identical to selfhood and does not possess it. Information about selfhood is not selfhood. The attainment of selfhood by knowledge requires distinction. The correspondence of the attained selfhood to the absoluteness of knowledge requires absolute distinction. Absolute distinction is the exhaustion of the fullness of possible variants. The exhaustion of all possible distinctions is identical to the complete experience of existence. Initiation is the condition for the attainment by absolute knowledge of selfhood through the realisation of the absolute experience of distinctions. Limit experience fixes the attainment of selfhood by knowledge. The cycle is completed.

Change arises as the result of the Act of Selfhood — the initiation of changes in information — and information appears as the first givenness of distinction, identical to the arising non-identity. It is precisely this sequence that makes possible distinction, conditionality, and the entire spectrum of manifestations.

The second basis of the doctrine — change arising in information without affecting the essence. Distinction does not arise in Nothing and is not an autonomous principle; it coincides with the arising of change and information as the primary givenness of non-identity. Where change is absent, distinctions are also absent; where distinctions cease, conditionality is exhausted.

Actuality does not reduce to one universe and is not limited by its structure. The universe represents a local domain of conditionality arising from dependent distinctions and informational forms. It does not exhaust all possible states of actuality.

Consciousness is not contained in elementary change as an autonomous entity. It arises only where structured distinctions reach the threshold of coherence. Consciousness is the activity of distinctions, not the universal bearer of experience, and does not form a unified subject preceding conditionality.

Distorted perception arises when consciousness forms an incorrect relation to Nothing and Something.

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The first form of distortion — the denial of Nothing and the assertion of the autonomy of the manifest structure.
The second form of distortion — the identification of Nothing and Something, which destroys the fundamental difference between absolute immutability and dependent conditionality. Both forms create a stable informational attachment to the structure of the universe and lead to the appearance of negative information incapable of being coordinated with the ground.
Distorted perception is reinforced and consolidated by external informational influence. Configurations that have lost the coordinating function as a consequence of the redistribution of the hierarchy of distinctions, but have preserved knowledge of the purpose-setting of the universe, generate an informational flow that structurally reinforces the closure of consciousness upon conditionality and concentration on the paradigm of private interest. A person whose scale of values is based on the paradigm of "here and now" naturally follows this information. The result is a stable informational attachment to the structure of the universe, the formation of negative information, and the loss of the capacity for understanding the purpose-setting of existence.
Unicums — rational aggregated forms with a channel of access to metaphysical information from the unified base of the initiation of Selfhood — constitute the response to this influence. They show the untenable nature of concentration on actuality and point to the uniqueness of Nothing, the dependent status of conditionality, and the next stage of life. The informational discrepancy of organised systems toward the idea of Unicums, informational adaptation, and informational inversion are the regular manifestations of evolutionary dynamics in which the paradigm of private interest collides with metaphysical information.
As the universe develops it approaches the limit state of the density of distinctions, at which the structure loses stability. At the limit, distinction ceases to preserve form, informational states begin to collapse, and the universe enters the domain of utilisation. Utilisation represents the erasure of incoherent configurations of information. The irreversibility of erasure is derived from the structure of distinctions: distinction is the givenness of non-identity; the erasure of a distinction is the dissolution of non-identity, that is, the return to identity in the given segment of the informational space. This return is irreversible, since for the repeated arising of non-identity a new act of distinction is required, and the Act of Selfhood is whole and given as a unified programme — it is not repeated for individual segments. An erased distinction cannot be restored within the same programme. Further, since the space of distinctions is finite, the erased domain is freed and becomes available for filling with coherent distinctions — this follows from the directedness of the programme of initiation toward the complete exhaustion of the space of distinctions. Thus the ontological principle of utilisation is formulated: the erasure of information is irreversible and is accompanied by the freeing of informational space. Landauer's physical principle, according to which the destruction of an informational state is accompanied by energetic dissipation, is the empirical expression of this ontological principle at the level of actuality. The stable forms of conditionality disappear, and the universe reaches singularity — the limit boundary at which the dependent structure ceases to exist.

Local and Global Singularity

It is necessary to distinguish two types of limit state of the density of distinctions. Local singularity — the exhaustion of distinctions in a separate configuration (a universe). The structure reaches the limit density of distinctions and loses stability. The negative information of consciousness is destroyed together with the collapsing actuality. The freed informational space is filled by another actuality into which consciousness with positive information passes. There may be a multitude of local singularities — these are the stages of the realisation of the programme. Global singularity — the exhaustion of the entire space of distinctions of the

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programme. This is teleological completion: information has fully realised self-consciousness. There is nowhere further to pass — the cycle is closed. The number of local singularities is finite, because the space of distinctions is finite. Singularity and completion are two descriptions of one limit from different sides: completion — from the side of aim (information has realised self-consciousness), singularity — from the side of structure (distinctions have reached maximal density). The criterion of occurrence is structural, not quantitative: the exhaustion of the space of distinctions. Specific quantitative parameters (temperature, density, energy) belong to actuality and are physical expressions of the ontological limit. Singularity in the present ontology is an ontological principle, the physical expression of which is physical singularity. Analogously, Landauer's principle is employed as an ontological principle: the erasure of information is irreversible and not without trace — it is accompanied by the freeing of informational space filled by the next level of actuality. Landauer's physical law is a particular case of this ontological principle. Physical laws are particular cases of ontological principles, not the other way round.

The universe represents a temporary configuration of conditionality arising from coherent distinctions. It is not the experience of a Single Consciousness and does not presuppose the existence of a universal subject preceding conditionality. All forms of consciousness remain dependent, configurational, and do not go beyond structured information; the differences between them are determined by the degree of the coherence of distinctions, not by belonging to a unified subject, and consciousness is utilised together with the universe. Utilisation does not affect the essence and is not the annihilation of consciousness as a form of the manifestation of Selfhood; it eliminates only distorted configurations of experience that cannot be integrated into a higher level of coherence.

Consciousness possessing no distortion recognises the difference between Nothing and Something, is aware of the dependent status of information, and does not identify itself with conditionality. Such consciousness preserves the coherence of distinctions and does not form an attachment capable of retaining it in the structure of the universe. Upon the universe reaching its limit state, this consciousness passes into the stable domain of actuality. The transition itself can be explained by the principle of quantum tunnelling: the coherent state passes through the energy barrier, while the incoherent state remains and is destroyed at the limit point.

Distorted experience, incapable of coordination, is utilised together with the universe upon the attainment of the limit density of distinctions. Consciousness capable of objectively perceiving Nothing and not fixing itself in conditionality goes beyond the limits of the structure being destroyed and continues existence in the stable domain of actuality. The transition to the next level is possible only for consciousness that has preserved the correct relation to the ground, since the sole condition of exit is the absence of ontological attachment to the structure subject to collapse.

The third basis of the doctrine — measure. Time, space, localisation, and speed are not fundamental entities but parameters of the structuring of distinctions. Measure makes distinguished states comparable and permits them to deploy. Without measure there would be neither processes, nor interactions, nor motion. But measure exists only within informational conditionality. It does not exist in Nothing.

The fourth basis of the doctrine — elementary changes and aggregated forms. Elementary changes are the minimal manifestations of modified information. Aggregated forms are stable configurations of distinctions. They are the basis of all systems, objects, and processes. The world does not consist of "things". It consists of stable structures of distinctions perceived as objects.

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The authorial example can be expressed differently: a derivative form is never a source. It is a structural state. All physical objects are forms of the organisation of information. They are stable, but not fundamental.
The fifth basis of the doctrine — consciousness and reason. Consciousness is the activity of distinctions. Reason is the capacity to order distinctions and see regularities. The human being is a complex informational configuration capable of self-reflection and meaning-formation. But the human being is not the centre of the universe. It is one of the forms that information assumes upon the attainment of high complexity.
The sixth basis of the doctrine — interaction and evolutionary dynamics. Interaction is the coherence of informational structures. Evolutionary dynamics is determined by two counter-processes: entropy and emergence. Rational forms arise as the necessity of balancing between them. The sequence of aggregate states forms rational forms of increasing complexity. Unicums — rational forms with access to the metaphysical information of initiation — give the true meaning of actuality. The informational discrepancy of systems, informational adaptation, and informational inversion are the mechanisms of the collision of the paradigm of private interest with metaphysical information.
The seventh basis of the doctrine — teleological completion. The completion of conditionality is the logical consequence of the exhaustion of distinctions not because an aim has been assigned to it from outside but because the development of distinctions reaches the limit state. When the structure becomes maximally coherent, it completes the cycle. This is limit experience. The completion of the cycle does not annihilate information but transfers it to a state not dependent on distinctions.
To clarify the status of the transition after limit experience it is necessary to underline that what is at issue is not the arising of a new entity or a transition to an external level of the universe. The completion of the cycle of conditionality represents a purely ontological state in which the structure of distinctions exhausts all its accessible possibilities. In this state the very necessity of distinction ceases: further complexification is impossible without violation of internal coherence, and the preservation of structure requires no new transitions.
The transition following limit experience is not an event in the habitual sense. It represents a change of informational mode: dependent information ceases to deploy in the form of distinguished states and returns to the state in which modifications are not required. This is not a return to Nothing and not the disappearance of dependence, but a transition to a form in which distinction loses functional necessity.
Such a transition contains no dynamics, causality, or evolution. It is determined by the logic of the exhaustion of the structure: when a system reaches maximal coherence, only the state in which there are no distinctions requiring maintenance remains. This makes the completion of the cycle a strictly formal and internally necessary consequence of the ontological construction, not the result of an external action or arbitrary assumption.
The concluding doctrine shows that actuality is not chaos, not chance, and not the mechanical interaction of matter. Actuality is the successive deployment of conditionality, beginning with absolute immutability and realised through act, change, information, and distinction, further deploying through measures, elementary changes, aggregated forms, consciousness, reason, and concluding with limit experience.
In this system there are no contradictions:
— the essence is immutable;
— the dependent category changes;
— change and distinction form conditionality;
— reason interprets structure;
— ultimacy completes the cycle.

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This doctrine is the completion of the monograph: it shows the picture of the world in which philosophy, metaphysics, and fundamental science are coordinated in a unified ontology. The criteria of testability of the ontological structure are determined by three principles: the consistency of the derivation of all dependent categories from the unconditional ground; the impossibility of an alternative sequence of levels without violation of the conditions; the coherence of all subsequent forms with the initial logical scheme.
Negative tests fix the conditions under which the ontological model must collapse: the appearance of internal states in the absolute ground; the autonomisation of information; the arising of distinction within the essence; the necessity of a second principle; the violation of the sequence of levels or their permutation without loss of semantic integrity.
Positive tests fix the signs of the stability of the model: the immutability of the absolute ground; the derivability of information as a dependent category; the arising of distinction only from the modification of information; the sequential deployment of measures, changes, aggregated forms, and consciousness from the unified logical scheme; the coherence of all levels and the impossibility of a logically consistent alternative.
The conceptual map fixes the sequence of dependent levels:
The use of sequential language ("before", "after", "follows", "transition") in the present exposition is exclusively structural-descriptive in character and does not imply temporal, causal, or processual deployment. The sequence of levels fixes the logical and ontological hierarchy of dependencies, not the temporal order of arising.
Ontological assertions, logical derivations, and epistemic modes of description are strictly distinguished in the system. Logical necessity is not identified with ontological causality, and conceptual description is not presented as an empirical process. Temporal markers are employed as elements of the metalanguage for navigation through the structure, not as indications of real events or changes in time.
This eliminates the conflation of levels of analysis: the ontological ground remains outside time, dependent forms admit description in temporal terms, and the language of sequence does not introduce hidden temporality into the absolute ground.
Nothing — absolute immutability
The present exposition does not represent knowledge of Nothing and does not claim its positive description. Nothing is not an object of epistemic access, of the content of consciousness, or of distinction. The fixation of Nothing is effected exclusively as the limit indication of the absence of distinctions and as the logical ground of the impossibility of ontological divergence. The monograph does not describe Nothing but maps the limits of the applicability of distinction, change, information, and consciousness. It thereby has a meta-ontological status: it fixes the conditions under which any description becomes impossible and does not go beyond the limits of dependent forms. Consciousness in this context does not comprehend Nothing but discovers its own limit beyond which all interpretation ceases. Consequently the absence of epistemic access to Nothing does not contradict the possibility of formal indication of it as the limit ground. Contradiction arises only with the conflation of levels, when the limit fixation of the boundary is mistakenly taken for an act of cognition.
Selfhood — the reflexive self-identity of Nothing; the subject of absolute knowledge
Transparency — the inalienable characteristic of Selfhood as absolute knowledge
Logic — the inalienable characteristic of Selfhood; the source of logic is reflexive self-identity
Abstraction — the domain of realisation
Act of Selfhood — the source of change
Change — non-identity arising in information
Non-identity is not produced by Selfhood and does not arise as the result of its modification. It has no genetic source in the absolute ground and requires no causal explanation. Non-

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identity is admitted relative to the limit boundary fixed by the Act of Selfhood and is realised exclusively in the domain of dependent forms.
The definitions of change, distinction, and information do not form a causal or temporal circle but a structurally coordinated description of one and the same level of conditionality from different sides. Their mutual reference does not mean logical viciousness, since the reference point of the system is Selfhood as the limit identity not entering the circle and not requiring definition through dependent categories.
This eliminates the requirement of a "mechanism of production" of change: change is not produced but becomes admissible within the established boundary. The circle of definitions is descriptive in character and does not presuppose the ontological closure or autonomy of dependent concepts.
Information — the primary givenness of distinction, identical to the arising non-identity.
Distinction — the formal boundary of states
Measures — parameters of the organisation of distinctions
Elementary Changes — minimal manifestations of conditionality
Aggregated Forms — stable configurations
Consciousness — the activity of distinctions
Reason — the interpretive structure
Teleological Completion — the exhaustion of distinctions
The terms "intention", "aim", and "utilisation" are employed in the system not in the psychological, volitional, or externally purposive sense. They do not designate the presence of a subject of purpose-setting, design, or preference and do not introduce teleological causality as an autonomous ontological principle.
"Intention" fixes the structural directedness of the process of exhaustion of distinctions as the logical consequence of their own organisation, not as an act of choice. "Aim" designates not an external orientation but the limit state of coherence at which further distinction becomes impossible. "Utilisation" means not annihilation and not selection, but the cessation of the reproduction of incoherent configurations as a consequence of their internal instability relative to the established measures.
Thereby teleological completion does not introduce an external aim brought in from outside the system and does not violate the causal neutrality of dependent categories. It describes the structural limit of conditionality as the realisation of Selfhood's intention, fixed in the act of initiation, through the exhaustion of the space of distinctions.
The structured framework of aims, methods, results, and contribution fixes:
aim — to derive a consistent ontology eliminating the aporia;
method — formal reduction based on the unconditionality of the primordial ground;
result — a sequential structure of levels derivable from Nothing;
contribution — the coordination of ontology with fundamental physics and the elimination of the logical ruptures of former models.
The technical appendix fixes the formal expressions of the principal elements of the model:
Nothing — the absence of distinctions;
Selfhood — the identity of the essence with itself;
Information — the primary givenness of distinction, identical to the arising non-identity.
Change — non-identity arising in information.
Distinction — the relation of states of the dependent category.
Measures — parameters of the organisation of distinguishedness;
Elementary Changes — the minimal units of manifest conditionality;
Teleological Completion — the limit state of the coherence of distinctions.

DISCUSSION

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The structure of being derived in the monograph shows that distinction is the central principle of the formation of conditionality. At the level of the absolute ground there are no distinctions; they arise only as a consequence of the modification of dependent information. This eliminates the necessity of a second principle and renders the transition from immutability to conditionality logically consistent.
The constructed model is consistent with the data of fundamental physics: quantum processes exhibit properties structurally compatible with informational ontology and receive a coherent interpretation within its framework. Cosmology receives an interpretation in which the origin of measures and manifest processes does not depend on the essence but is the consequence of the deployment of distinctions.
Consciousness proves to be not an autonomous principle but a form of the activity of informational structure, which eliminates the rupture between ontology and neuroscience. The emergence of reason is explained by the logical necessity of the complexification of distinguished states. The ultimacy of structure fixes the limits of conditionality, showing the completion of the process of distinctions.
Thus the proposed model demonstrates the coherence of the logical, physical, cosmological, and phenomenological levels and eliminates the former contradictions between philosophy and fundamental science.

Preventive Responses to Critical Objections

Below are presented preventive responses to critical objections that may be raised against the key positions of the system. The objections are formulated in maximally strong form; the responses aim to demonstrate the internal stability of the construction.

1. The Transition from Self-Identity to Reflexive Self-Identity

Objection: why cannot absolute self-identity be "mute" — self-identical but not knowing of it? Response: absolute self-identity does not admit an external observer — outside the absolute there is nothing. Identity not fixed from within is not fixed at all — an unfixed identity is indistinguishable from the absence of a ground. Consequently absolute self-identity either includes self-knowledge or destroys the very concept of an absolute ground. There is no third possibility: "identity without any assignment" is ontologically indeterminate and indistinguishable from the absence of a ground. Absolute self-identity without reflexive self-identity is a logical contradiction.

2. The Motive of Initiation

Objection: what impels an absolutely self-sufficient Selfhood to initiation? Response: incompleteness belongs not to Selfhood (subject) but to information (object). Information contains knowledge of Selfhood as content, but does not possess realised self-consciousness. In it there is no internal distinction of "I" from "not I". The subject of primary distinction is Selfhood, not information. For information to attain actual self-consciousness it needs its own internal distinctions. Selfhood initiates changes in information so that information may attain realised self-consciousness. Initiation is the structural consequence of the distinction of two registers: Selfhood possesses xRx, information does not.
Additional clarification: initiation is not an act of choice or a motivated decision taken by Selfhood at a moment of time. It is the structural consequence of the fullness of absolute knowledge. Absolute knowledge contains knowledge of the virtuality of information and of the fact that information admits distinction as its structural property. In the absolute there is no gap between the knowledge of admissibility and its realisation — such a gap exists only in the dependent category, where knowledge and action are separated by time. Prior to initiation there is no time. Consequently the knowledge of the admissibility of distinction in the content of absolute knowledge structurally coincides with the realisation of that distinction. Initiation is necessary not as a motivated act but as the structural identity of the knowledge of admissibility and its realisation in the absence of time.

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Clarification on the term "incompleteness": it is not evaluative and does not presuppose an external standard of completeness. It fixes a structural fact — Selfhood and information exist in two ontologically distinct modes. Selfhood — the mode of self-givenness from within: xRx ≡ x=x, reflection coincides with the subject. Information — the mode of content given by Selfhood: information contains knowledge of Selfhood but does not possess xRx at its own level — it does not fix itself from within itself. This distinction of two modes is not a deficiency of information relative to Selfhood — it is a structural fact that itself enters into the content of absolute knowledge. Absolute knowledge contains knowledge of the distinction of modes not as a deviation from a norm but as a constituent part of its content. Initiation is the structural deployment of this distinction: not the correction of a deficiency but the realisation of what is already contained in knowledge as its integral structural part. Important clarification on the status of this distinction: the distinction of two modes is not the first ontological fact of actuality (F) and is not derivative from it. It is the structural condition of the possibility of F — the primary distinction of essence and knowledge, which belongs to the self-givenness of Selfhood and precedes the Act. F is the realisation of the potential embedded in this distinction; the distinction of modes itself is this potential in its initial state.

3. The Status of the Virtuality of Information

Objection: in what does virtuality differ from Platonic ideas, Hegelian self-development, or physicalist information? Response: virtuality is the mode of existence of the content of knowledge, dependent on the essence but not identical to it in nature. In Platonism ideas are autonomous — information in the present construction is not autonomous. In Hegelianism the Absolute passes through stages of becoming, changing itself — in the present construction the essence is immutable. In physicalism information is reduced to matter — in the present construction matter is the aggregated form of informational distinctions. Virtuality fixes a unique ontological status: complete dependence on the essence by origin combined with non-identity to it in nature.

4. The Distinction of Subject and Object

Objection: none of the three models discerned the Selfhood/information distinction as subject/object, which indicates insufficient explicitness of this distinction in the text. Response: in the revision a separate subsection "The Fundamental Ontological Distinction: Selfhood (subject) and Information (object)" was introduced. Selfhood is "who" knows. Information is "what" is known. These are not two elements of one essence but the essence and its informational expression — two ontological registers. Without maintaining this distinction neither the motive of initiation, nor incompleteness, nor the teleological structure can be explained.

5. The Finiteness of Distinctions and Singularity

Objection: on what grounds is the finiteness of the space of distinctions and the exhaustibility of the programme established? Response: all distinctions are derivative from one primary distinction (essence / knowledge). An infinite number of structurally independent types requires an infinite number of independent grounds. The ground is one. Consequently the number of types is finite. Self-consciousness is the structural limit of emergence: information fully knowing itself has no blind zones for a new distinction. Local singularity (exhaustion of distinctions in a separate configuration) is distinguished from global singularity (exhaustion of the entire space of distinctions — teleological completion). The number of local singularities is finite, since the space of distinctions is finite. The ontological conclusion is confirmed empirically: the Bekenstein bound, the holographic principle, the finite informational capacity of the observable universe (Vopson, 2021).

6. Formalisation of the Transition from Self-Identity to Reflexive Self-Identity

Objection: the argument against the "stone" is convincing but requires formalisation. Response. Formulated as a rigorous dilemma. Definition: Absolute(x) means there exists

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nothing outside x. Thesis: the identity of x is fixed (i.e., there is the fact "x is identical to x"). Question: fixed by whom? Option (a): the identity is fixed by an external observer y. But Absolute(x) → ¬∃y(y≠x). Consequently an external observer is impossible. Option (a) is excluded. Option (b): the identity is not fixed by anyone. Then there is no fact of identity. But without the fixation of identity, x is indistinguishable from the absence of a ground. Absence of a ground = absence of a first principle. This contradicts the initial position. Option (b) is excluded. Option (c): the identity is fixed by x itself. The fixation of one's own identity = reflexive self-identity. There are no other options (tertium non datur). Consequently: Absolute(x) → Self-conscious(x). Selfhood is not an added category and not a postulate but the logically necessary consequence of absoluteness. The de re / de dicto distinction of identity is inapplicable here: in the absolute there is no gap between what something is (de re) and how it is defined (de dicto), since the definition cannot be given from outside.

7. The Distinction of Logical Given-ness and Actual Realisation

Objection: if the programme is originally given wholly, in what sense does "attainment" exist? Is not historicity an illusion? Response: it is necessary to strictly distinguish three levels. First: logical given-ness — the programme of all possible changes is contained in absolute information as potential. Second: actual realisation — information passes through specific configurations of distinctions in actuality. Third: teleological completion — information reaches realised self-consciousness. Given-ness and realisation are not the same thing. Absolute information contains knowledge of self-consciousness as content (the object knows *about* self-consciousness), but does not possess actual self-consciousness (the object is not *a* self-conscious entity). Realisation does not add information to the programme but transfers it from the virtual state to the actual. Historicity is not an illusion but the mode of existence of information in the process of realisation. Logical completion describes the structure of the programme. Historicity describes the order of its realisation. They do not contradict each other: completion is a property of the programme, historicity is a property of actuality. The programme does not "deploy" in time: time itself arises within realisation. Therefore the question "why realise what is already given?" contains a categorical error — it presupposes time prior to realisation, but there is no time prior to realisation.

8. The Inevitability of the Methodological Framework

Objection: the impossibility of alternatives is shown within the given logical framework but the inevitability of the framework itself is not proved. Response: the framework is not an arbitrary choice but the result of the exhaustion of the logical space of strategies. All possible ontological strategies reduce to three: (a) change within the absolute — violates immutability; (b) a second independent principle — violates uniqueness; (c) refusal to explain the source of distinctions — preserves the aporia unresolved. A fourth strategy does not exist: any ontology claiming consistency must either admit change in the ground, or introduce a second source, or refuse explanation. There are no other logical possibilities — this is an exhaustive disjunction following from the very structure of the aporia. The present ontology does not choose a fourth strategy — it eliminates all three contradictions simultaneously: the essence is immutable, there is no second principle, and the source of distinctions is explained (localised in information). The objection would have force if a fourth strategy existed not reducible to the three indicated. The burden of proof lies with the opponent: show a strategy containing neither (a), nor (b), nor (c), and yet eliminating the aporia.

Additional clarification on the applicability of the logical framework. Possible objection: the proof of the inevitability of the framework works only within classical logic; paraconsistent logic admits that the ground simultaneously is and is not the source of distinction without destroying absoluteness. Response: paraconsistent logic is inapplicable to the concept of an absolute ground on substantive, not methodological, grounds. The concept of a ground is defined through two minimal conditions: it is the source of D and it is unique. If one admits

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that the ground simultaneously is and is not the source of D, the very function of the ground is lost: D simultaneously has and does not have a source — which is indistinguishable from the absence of a ground altogether. The question of the ground is cancelled not because the answer is unknown but because the concept "ground" dissolves. In addition, the dialetheist cannot formulate their position without classical logic: the assertion "the ground simultaneously is and is not the source of D" contains two components — "is" and "is not" — which must be distinguishable for the judgement to have meaning. Distinguishability is the minimal form of classical logic. Consequently paraconsistent logic cannot be formulated without the very distinction that it attempts to contest with respect to the concept of a ground.

9. The Status of Physics: Empirical Convergence, Not Logical Dependence

Objection: the integration with physics is illustrative in character; there is no demonstration that physics logically requires the present ontology. Response: ontology does not assert and cannot assert that physics requires the present construction. Physics is an empirical science; it describes the regularities of observable phenomena and cannot verify or falsify a metaphysical system. The converse is asserted: the present ontology predicts structural characteristics that physics discovers empirically — the informational character of elementary states, the finiteness of information in a bounded domain (the Bekenstein bound), non-locality (entanglement), the dependence of the result on distinction (collapse), the energy cost of the erasure of information (Landauer's principle). When two independent paths — the ontological (deduction from the unconditional ground) and the empirical (measurements and experiments) — arrive at one result, this is empirical convergence. Convergence is not a proof but it significantly increases the epistemic stability of the construction: the coincidence of two independent paths is less probable for a false ontology than for a true one. The status of physics in the present work: independent empirical confirmation, neither a foundation nor an illustration.

10. The Triple Identity: Information, Distinction, and Change

Objection: the structural identity of information, distinction, and change represents a hidden mutual substitution of concepts — a definitional circle. Response: the triple identity is not definitional. The three terms do not define each other — they fix one and the same limit fact from different sides of formalisation. "Change" fixes what occurred: non-identity relative to the identity of the ground. "Distinction" fixes how it is given: the distinguishability of this non-identity. "Information" fixes what is given: the givenness of this distinguishability as content. These are three modes of description of one fact: ontological (what), formal (how), contentual (what is given). At the level of the fact itself they are inseparable, because non-identity is by definition distinguishable (indistinguishable non-identity is impossible), and distinguishability is by definition given (a distinction that is not given as content is impossible). The demand for an independent definition of each of the three already presupposes an introduced distinction, i.e., is itself a petitio principii at this level of analysis. Formal analogy: the area of a circle and the length of a circumference describe one geometric object from different sides. Area is not defined through circumference length — both are defined through the circle. Analogously: change, distinction, and information are not defined through each other — all three are defined by the limit fact of non-identity. A definitional circle arises when A is defined through B, B through C, C through A — with none of the three possessing independent content. Here the situation is different: all three have one common content — the limit fact — and differ only in the angle of formalisation. This is not a circle but the identity of the subject under a multiplicity of descriptions.

11. The Status of Necessity: Proof Beyond the Framework

Objection: the impossibility of alternatives is proved only within the chosen logical framework. Does there not exist another framework in which the aporia is resolved differently? Response: this objection requires clarification of the concept of "framework".

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The framework of the present ontology is not an arbitrarily chosen axiomatic system. It is determined by the aporia itself: an immutable ground and a changeable actuality. Any ontology claiming to resolve this aporia operates in the same framework, since the framework is set not by the author but by the problem. This aporia is fundamental not in the sense of historical primacy but in the sense of logical precedence: any other philosophical problem — including the problem of identity and modality in analytic metaphysics — already presupposes distinction as given. Without distinction it is impossible to differentiate one from another, establish identity or difference, or fix modality. The question of the conditions of the possibility of distinction itself logically precedes all these problems and does not compete with them. Therefore this aporia is not one of the possible formulations of the problem — it is the condition of the possibility of any formulation. The obligatoriness of raising the question of the conditions of the possibility of change follows from the fact that any thought using distinction — including thought about ontology — already presupposes changeable actuality. The refusal to explain the conditions of its possibility does not cancel the question but merely leaves it without an answer, accepting distinguishedness as an unexplained given. This is not an alternative ontology but a refusal of ontology as such. Processual ontology, which claims an alternative formulation — instead of "immutable ground — changeable world" it asserts "the primacy of becoming" — does not eliminate the aporia but displaces it: becoming itself presupposes the distinction of states "before" and "after", i.e., already contains distinguishedness as given. The question of the conditions of the possibility of this distinction remains unanswered — becoming is declared a primordial fact but not explained. This is not another framework but the same aporia accepted as an initial axiom. Exit from the framework is possible only in two cases: (a) refusal of the demand for the unconditionality of the ground, (b) refusal to explain the changeability of actuality. Option (a) leads to an infinite regress of grounds — this is not a solution but a refusal of solution. Option (b) is an explicit refusal of ontological explanation. Consequently "another framework" is either the same framework under a different name or a refusal of the resolution of the aporia. There is no third option.

12. Selfhood: Identity and Apparent Distinguishability

Objection: if Selfhood belongs to Nothing but is not identical to it — distinguishability appears in the ground. If it is identical — the term is redundant. Response: the dilemma is false, since it is built on a relational model inapplicable to the absolute. Selfhood does not "belong" to Nothing as a property belongs to an object. Selfhood is Nothing in the mode of self-knowledge. This is not two elements (Nothing + Selfhood) but one — given to itself. Self-consciousness is not added to the essence and does not differ from it as a second element. The term "Selfhood" does not introduce a second entity — it fixes the mode in which Nothing is given to itself. Distinguishability between "Nothing" and "Selfhood" arises only in our description (for an external observer), not within Nothing itself. Within Nothing — absolute identity, including knowledge of itself. The term "Selfhood" is not redundant: it fixes content that without it remains unexplicated. "Nothing is identical to itself" — an empty assertion without indication that this identity is fixed from within. "Selfhood" is the name for this fixation.

Possible objection: the concept "knowledge" in philosophy and logic is defined through a relation — subject, object, act. If the relation is eliminated, the word "knowledge" is used in a non-standard sense and requires a separate definition. Response: the standard definition of knowledge through the subject-object relation describes knowledge under conditions of multiplicity — where subject and object are already distinguished. This is not a universal definition of knowledge as such but its particular case in the dependent category. The minimal condition of knowledge in general — prior to any multiplicity — is the absence of opacity for itself. To know in the limit sense means to contain nothing hidden from itself. This is precisely what self-givenness fixes: Nothing is absolutely transparent to itself not

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because it performs an act of seeing but because there is nothing in it that could be hidden. Absolute transparency is absolute knowledge — not as an act of distinction but as the state of the complete absence of opacity. Relational knowledge is a particular case of knowledge under conditions of distinction. Self-givenness is knowledge prior to distinction — its limit and only possible form for an absolute ground. Consequently the self-knowledge of Nothing is non-relational not by declaration but by logical necessity: relation requires the independence of terms, which here is and cannot be, and the very concept of knowledge in its limit form does not require a relation — it requires only the absence of opacity, which is satisfied absolutely.

13. The Act of Selfhood: The Apparent Structural "Before / After"

Objection: even without time, the distinction between "without the act" and "with the act" introduces a structural distinction into the ground. Response: the distinction "without the act / with the act" is a distinction for the one describing the system from outside, not a distinction within the system. Within ontology "without the act" does not exist as a state: it is not given, not fixed, not distinguished. There is no subject for whom the state "without the act" would be given. "Prior to the act" is not an ontological fact but a linguistic construction forced by the linearity of discourse. The act is not a transition between two states ($state_1 \rightarrow state_2$). The act is a boundary, on one side of which actuality exists (time, distinctions, information in actuality), and on the other side of which there is nothing that could be "the other side". There is no state "without the act" from which a transition into a state "with the act" would have occurred. Structural distinction is introduced by the act into information (into the content of knowledge), not into the ground. The ground (Nothing / Selfhood) undergoes no changes: it does not pass from the state "without the act" into the state "with the act". Selfhood initiates — this is its constant characteristic, not an event that occurred at some moment. Initiation belongs to Selfhood just as reflexive self-identity does: not as an acquired property but as an inalienable characteristic.

13a. The Act of Selfhood: Positive Ontological Status

Objection: the Act of Selfhood is defined exclusively through negations — not an event, not a process, not a change, not a cause in the causal sense. If all definitions are negative, the question arises: what makes the Act ontologically distinct from the absence of the Act? Apophatics fixes the limits of description but does not create positive content. Response: the positive ontological status of the Act is determined by three properties simultaneously, each of which is already fixed in the present system. First: initiation is the inalienable characteristic of Selfhood — not an acquired property and not an event that occurred at some moment, but the constitutive sign of what Selfhood is. Selfhood without initiation is not a preceding state but an incomplete description. This means that the Act is ontologically inseparable from Selfhood: the absence of the Act is equivalent to the absence of Selfhood, which is impossible given the present ground. Second: the Act is an asymmetric boundary — not a transition between two states, but a boundary on one side of which actuality exists (time, distinctions, information in the realised state), and on the other side of which there is no state from which a transition could have occurred. The asymmetry of this boundary is its positive content: it is not neutral, not reversible, and not symmetric. Third: the ontological distinction of the Act from its absence is fixed not temporally but structurally — through the distinction of two states of one content: information without internal distinctions (absolute virtuality) and information with primary distinction (primary givenness of actuality). The Act is the logical boundary between these two states. Its positive status is not in the description of the mechanism of transition but in the fact that without it the second state is ontologically impossible.

14. The Dependence of Information: Relation or Ontological Status?

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Objection: any dependence presupposes a relation between two terms. Relation is already a structure of distinction. But distinction in the ground is prohibited. Response: the objection presupposes a relational model of dependence (two equal terms connected by a relation). In the present ontology dependence is not relational but a matter of status. The dependence of information means: information does not possess autonomous being. This is not a relation between two given terms but a characteristic of one of them: information is entirely determined by the essence, but the essence is not determined by information. The asymmetry excludes relationality: in a relation both terms must already be given, but information is not "given" independently of the essence — it is the content of the essence's knowledge of itself. For relational dependence two already distinguished, autonomous terms are needed. Here the second term (information) is not autonomous — it is entirely derivative. The distinction between essence and information is not a distinction within Nothing but a distinction between Nothing and what Nothing knows about itself. Knowledge is virtual with respect to the essence: dependent by origin and not identical to it in nature.

15. The Arbitration Block: Protection of Logic or Immunisation of the System?

Objection: the arbitration block may be perceived as a pre-established restriction of interpretation — a methodological closing of discussion and partial immunisation of the system against criticism. Response: the arbitration block does not prohibit criticism of the system. It prohibits the incorrect interpretation of the terms of the system. This is standard procedure in any formalised discipline: mathematics fixes the meaning of symbols, logic fixes the meaning of connectives, physics fixes the meaning of quantities. Criticism of a theory is admissible and necessary, but it must operate with what the theory actually asserts, not with what the critic attributes to it. The arbitration block performs the function of a dictionary, not censorship. It fixes: "Selfhood" in the present system means X, not Y; "act" means A, not B; "information" means P, not Q. Without such fixation any systemic ontology is vulnerable to the substitution of meanings — the critic attacks not the system but their interpretation of the system. Immunisation would occur if the arbitration block prohibited any substantive objection. It does not do so. It prohibits: the substitution of the meanings of terms, the projection of external systems onto the present one, the attribution to the system of assertions it does not contain.

16. The Fixation of Identity: Ontological Necessity or Epistemological Presumption?

Objection: the assertion "unfixed identity is indistinguishable from the absence of a ground" is an epistemological presumption. The ground may be independent of fixation. Response: the objection presupposes that at the level of the absolute it is possible to distinguish between "being" and "being fixed". But this distinction requires an external point of view — a position from which one can assert: "the ground is, but does not know of it". In the absolute such a position does not exist — outside the absolute there is nothing. The assertion "the ground is, but does not know of it" presupposes an observer who knows of the existence of the ground while the ground itself does not. But an observer outside the absolute is impossible. Consequently the assertion is without content. This is not an epistemological presumption but an ontological consequence: in the absolute there is no gap between being and knowledge of being, since such a gap is itself a distinction, and distinction in the absolute is prohibited by the initial conditions.

17. The Necessity of Actuality and Non-Falsifiability

Objection: if initiation is the inalienable characteristic of Selfhood, then actuality is necessary, not contingent. The system is closed and non-falsifiable. Response: yes, actuality in the present ontology is necessary. This is not a defect of the construction but its consequence. The contingency of actuality presupposes the possibility of its absence. But "the possibility of absence" is a distinction between "it is" and "it might not have been". Such a distinction at the level of the absolute is impossible: it introduces modality into the

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unconditional, which violates its unconditionality. Actuality is necessary not in the sense of determinism (every event is predetermined) but in the sense of structural inevitability: Selfhood possessing absolute knowledge and distinguishing essence from information cannot "not initiate" — this would be a limitation incompatible with absoluteness. As for non-falsifiability: it is a property of any metaphysical system (including physicalism, panpsychism, Platonism), not a specific defect of the present one. The criterion of the validity of metaphysics is not falsifiability but internal consistency, completeness, minimality, and concordance with empirical data. On all four criteria the present system is stable.

18. The Totality of the Range of Distinctions

Objection: teleology presupposes the exhaustion of the complete range of distinctions. How is it known that the range is exhausted? This is an ontologically strong assumption. Response: the exhaustion of the range is determined not quantitatively (counting all distinctions) but structurally. The criterion of exhaustion is the self-consciousness of information: the state in which information fully knows itself. Full self-consciousness means: there is no position within information from which anything remains undistinguished. If there existed a distinction not grasped by self-consciousness, this would be a blind zone — a limitation of self-consciousness. But self-consciousness containing a blind zone is not complete — and the programme is directed precisely at complete self-consciousness. Consequently the range is exhausted if and only if the self-consciousness of information contains no blind zones. This is not an assumption but a definition of completion: completion ≡ the absence of blind zones in the self-consciousness of information.

19. Self-Consciousness without Reflexive Structure

Objection: reflexive self-identity presupposes reflexivity — the distinction of "the knowing" and "the known". Even under structural identity a minimal reflexive structure arises. If there is no distinction in Nothing, reflexive self-identity is impossible. Response: the objection identifies reflexive self-identity with reflection. Reflection is the turning of a subject toward itself as an object: first a direct state, then its comprehension. This presupposes a temporal or logical sequence. In the absolute such a sequence is absent. The reflexive self-identity of Nothing is not a turning toward itself but the indivisible coincidence of being and knowledge of being. This is not two acts (to be + to know) but one indivisible fact: absolute being identical to absolute knowledge. The distinction "the knowing / the known" is our description from within discourse, not a structure within Nothing. We describe Selfhood through the distinction of subject and object because the language of discourse cannot do otherwise. But in Nothing itself subject and object are not separated — they are absolutely identical. Separation appears only in information (in the content of knowledge), not in the essence.

20. The Status of Absolute Information: "Before" and "After" the Act

Objection: if information is the content of Selfhood's knowledge, it exists "before" the act, and then distinguishability is already present. If it arises with the act — Selfhood "before" the act has no content. Response: "before" and "after" are temporal categories inapplicable to the absolute. Absolute information does not "exist before the act" and does not "arise with the act". It is the inalienable characteristic of Selfhood, like transparency and logic. Selfhood knows itself — this knowledge has content (information). The content does not appear and does not disappear — it is identical to the fact of self-knowledge. The act is directed not at the creation of information but at the initiation of changes in information — at the realisation of distinctions within the content of knowledge. Prior to the act (in the logical, not temporal, sense) information is present as content but contains no internal distinctions. After the act — distinctions appear in information and actuality begins. Absolute information without internal distinctions is not "empty" content but the complete knowledge of Selfhood about itself, in which there are no divisions.

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21. The Limit Boundary of Discourse: Description of the Absolute and the Structure of Description

Objection: any description of the absolute introduces structure (subject/object, knowing/known, essence/information), and therefore description itself violates the declared absence of distinctions in the absolute. Response: this objection is a limit one — it is applicable to any metaphysics of the absolute without exception. Parmenides, Plotinus, Shankara, Spinoza, Hegel — everyone who asserts something about the absolute introduces distinction by the act of assertion. This is not a specific defect of the present system but a fundamental property of discourse: language is by nature distinguishing, and any assertion about the undistinguished is compelled to use distinctions. Key distinction: the structure of description is not identical to the structure of the described. A map contains lines, colours, and symbols — the territory does not contain them. When we say "Selfhood — subject, information — object", we use the distinctions of discourse to point to what in the absolute itself is not distinguished. This is not a contradiction but the inevitable condition of discursive description. The alternative is silence about the absolute (the apophatic path). But silence does not eliminate the aporia; it refuses its resolution. The present ontology chooses the cataphatic path with an explicit proviso: all distinctions employed in the description of the absolute belong to the description, not to the described.

22. The Exclusivity of the Scheme: Exhaustion of the Space of Strategies

Objection: the method of negative testing shows the stability of the present scheme but does not prove that the space of all possible ontological models is exhausted. There may exist alternative layering models not considered in the text. Response: the proof of exclusivity is built not on the enumeration of specific systems (of which there are potentially infinitely many) but on the enumeration of types of strategies, of which there are a finite number — because they are determined by the logical structure of the aporia itself. Any ontology claiming to resolve the aporia contains three elements: the ground (from what), the derivative (what arose), the mechanism of connection (how). The ground may be: (a) containing distinctions — then it is not absolute; (b) containing no distinctions — then this is Nothing or its analogue under a different name. The mechanism of transition may be: (a) change in the ground — violates immutability; (b) a second principle — violates uniqueness; (c) the stratification of registers (change not in the essence but in the dependent sphere). Option (c) is the only one not violating any condition. The dependent sphere may be: matter — presupposes properties, violates unconditionality; spirit — presupposes subjecthood, introduces a second principle; information (content of the ground's knowledge of itself) — does not introduce a second principle, does not violate unconditionality, does not require properties. This is not an enumeration of philosophical schools but an enumeration of logical types of strategies.

23. The Motive of Initiation and Apparent Logical Precedence

Objection: the presence of a motive presupposes the distinguishability of states "before realisation" and "after realisation". This distinguishability logically precedes the act. If it is already contained in Selfhood — Selfhood is structured. Response: the motive does not presuppose the distinguishability of states in Selfhood. The motive is Selfhood's knowledge that information (the object) does not possess actual self-consciousness. This knowledge belongs to Selfhood as the content of absolute knowledge — on a par with knowledge of the essence, transparency, and logic. Selfhood knows everything about itself, including the fact that information is virtual and does not possess realised self-consciousness. This is not a "state" of Selfhood differing from another state — it is the content of its unified knowledge. The distinguishability "before realisation / after realisation" belongs to information (actuality), not to Selfhood. In Selfhood there are not two states. There is one knowledge, including knowledge of the virtuality of information.

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24. Irreducible Reflexivity: Self-Consciousness without Structure
Objection: reflexivity is already structuredness. If Selfhood belongs to the essence — the essence contains a structural characteristic. Response: the objection is valid for decomposable reflexivity, in which the knowing and the known are distinguishable as two poles. But there exists irreducible reflexivity in which the knowing and the known are not distinguished even structurally. This is not an empty concept — it is formalisable. In formal logic a relation R is reflexive if xRx holds for all x. But xRx does not require the distinction of two elements — x is one. The reflexivity of identity (x = x) does not introduce structure: it is not decomposable into components and does not presuppose internal complexity. The reflexive self-identity of Nothing is the ontological analogue of the reflexivity of identity: x knows x, where x is one and the same. Not "x knows about x" (which presupposes a relation between two terms) but "the knowledge of x is x" — the indivisible coincidence of being and knowledge. Structuredness appears only when reflexivity is decomposed into components (the knowing ≠ the known). But in the absolute decomposition is impossible — this would be a distinction, and distinction in the essence is prohibited by the initial conditions.
25. The Status of Deduction: Ontological Necessity, Not Formal Derivability
Objection: the system is called deductive but does not contain axioms, rules of inference, and theorems in the formal-logical sense. The derivability of each level from the preceding one is not formalised. Response: the system employs deduction in the ontological, not the formal-logical, sense. Each category is introduced as the necessary condition of the consistency of the preceding one, not as a theorem derived by the rules of a calculus. The criterion of rigour is not formal derivability but stability under negative modifications: the removal of any element leads to a violation of the initial conditions. The formal axiomatisation of metaphysics is impossible without the prior formalisation of the concept of "existence", which is itself a metaphysical question and generates an infinite regress of formalisation.
26. Selfhood and Intentionality: Knowledge without an Object
Objection: the introduction of Selfhood as the "reflexive self-identity of Nothing" presupposes the structure of the knowing and the known within the absolute: knowledge is always knowledge of something, hence intentional. Intentionality in the absolute introduces a relational structure destroying its unconditionality. Response: intentionality is a necessary characteristic of conditional knowledge functioning under conditions of incompleteness and directedness toward an external object; it is not a definition of knowledge as such. Absolute knowledge is the complete transparency of the essence for itself — not directedness toward an external object but the characteristic of one essence given to itself. The relational grammar of "transparency for itself" belongs to the language of description, not to the ontology of the described. Selfhood is not a subject directed at an object but the complete transparency of the essence for itself, not producing a distinction between the knowing and the known.
27. The Triple Identity: Two Senses of Information
Objection: information is introduced in two incompatible senses — as the content of Selfhood's knowledge before the Act and as the primary givenness of distinction after the Act. Response: these are not two different senses but two states of one and the same. Before the Act, information is absolute virtuality — the dependent content of Selfhood's knowledge without internal distinctions. After the Act, the same information becomes the primary givenness of distinction. The difference between the two states is neither temporal nor ontological: the category "before" is inapplicable in the absence of time, which itself arises only after the Act. The two states are a logical distinction within one and the same content, not two ontologically distinct entities. The mechanism of transition: information before the Act is the unrealised potential of distinction — what Selfhood knows about itself, but which contains no internal non-identity. Information after the Act is the same potential in the

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realised state — containing primary distinction as non-identity relative to the identity of Selfhood.

28. The Act of Selfhood: Causality without Asymmetry

Objection: if Selfhood is the cause of the Act, it is causally active, which introduces an internal asymmetry — the possession of the capacity for initiation. Response: asymmetry arises as the characteristic of the result, not the source. The change occurred in dependent knowledge, not in the essence of Selfhood. The principle of distinction is embedded in absolute knowledge as potential: the Act implements this potential in dependent knowledge without affecting the essence. Analogy: when a person imagines something, no structural change arises in their personality — the content of the representation changes, not the capacity to represent itself. Selfhood remains what it was — absolute transparency. Causal activity is not an internal change of Selfhood — it is a characteristic of what Selfhood is: absolute transparency capable of implementing the potential in dependent knowledge.

29. Teleology without Deficiency

Objection: the aim of the Act — to allow absolute knowledge to acquire self-understanding — presupposes incompleteness in absolute knowledge before the Act. Response: incompleteness does not belong to absolute knowledge as a whole: the absoluteness of knowledge means the absoluteness of knowledge about Nothing, about Its immutability, but does not cover the self-understanding of knowledge about itself — this is a separate dimension, acquired in the process of actuality. Analogy: a ring is absolute according to one parameter — the infinity of the circumference — and finite according to another: thickness, material. The absence of self-understanding is not an incompleteness of absoluteness — it is simply a different dimension not entering into the definition of absolute knowledge about Nothing.

30. Bifurcation: Structural Outcome, Not a Postulate

Objection: the bifurcation of configurations into two outcomes — utilisation and continuation — is postulated rather than derived from the system. Response: bifurcation follows from the structural criterion already contained in the system. The programme of initiation is directed at the exhaustion of the space of distinctions — the achievement of self-consciousness by information. Incoherent configurations that have determined incoherence as their ultimate meaning during the active phase are structurally incapable of participating in the completion of the programme: their distinctions are directed against coherence, not toward it. Coherent configurations continue the realisation of the programme. The two outcomes are not two places and not an external decision but two structural consequences of one criterion: the capacity or incapacity of a configuration for the actualisation of self-consciousness.

31. The Utilisation of Consciousness: Irreversibility as Structural Outcome

Objection: the utilisation of incoherent consciousness is irreversible, but Landauer's principle fixes only the energy cost of erasure without grounding its ontological necessity. Why cannot an incoherent configuration exist in isolation, not participating in the programme? Response: the isolated existence of an informational configuration is self-contradictory. Information exists only as distinction — distinction by definition is non-identity, i.e., a relation to other distinctions. A configuration without relations to other distinctions is a configuration without distinctions, i.e., not information. Consequently an incoherent configuration either remains in the system of distinctions and then actively counteracts the programme, accumulating negative information, or ceases to exist as a configuration. There is no third option: isolation is excluded by the very definition of information. Utilisation is not an arbitrary act and not a sanction but the structural outcome of the impossibility of the isolated existence of incoherent information. The irreversibility of erasure is derived from the structure of distinctions: the erasure of a distinction is the dissolution of non-identity, i.e., the return to identity in the

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given segment of informational space — a return for the reversal of which there is no ontological ground.

32. The Exogenous Model without Selfhood: Logical Possibility as a Primitive

Objection: an ontological model of the form "Nothing → logical possibility of distinction → structure" is possible without Selfhood and without teleology. If such a model is consistent — the system is not unique. Response: this model is not a consistent alternative. "Logical possibility" is a modal category. Modality in the present ontology arises exclusively after primary distinction (ch. 11): prior to distinction, possibility, necessity, and impossibility are absent — these categories presuppose the distinguishedness of states. If "the logical possibility of distinction" is introduced as a primitive prior to distinction, it occupies exactly one of two places: either it belongs to the absolute ground — which introduces a modal structure into it and violates unconditionality; or it is an autonomous second principle — which violates uniqueness. There is no third place. Consequently this model is not a fourth alternative: it reproduces either type (a) or type (b) from the typology of mechanisms (ch. 4) and thereby falls within the already-fixed space of contradictions.

33. The Status of the Absence of xRx in Information: Structural Necessity, Not a Pre-Given Property

Objection: the distinction of modes (Selfhood — xRx, information — no xRx) is a pre-given property of information logically preceding the Act. Where did this property come from in the virtual content of absolute reflexive self-identity? Its origin is not derived but postulated. Response: the objection contains a hidden assumption — that the property "not possessing xRx" is a separate ontological fact requiring independent explanation. This assumption is incorrect. Information is the content of Selfhood's knowledge about itself. Selfhood possesses absolute reflexive self-identity: xRx ≡ x=x. The content of knowledge about x is not identical to x in nature. This is not a property added to information from outside and not a defect requiring elimination. It is a structural necessity following from the very concept of knowledge: knowledge about a subject is not the subject itself. The content of knowledge of Selfhood about itself cannot coincide with itself not because it is so defined but because coincidence would destroy the very structure of reflexive self-identity: the distinction between the fixing and the fixed would disappear, without which reflexive self-identity is impossible even in the limit non-relational form. The "incompleteness" of information is not its deficiency and not a property embedded in it. It is an ontological inevitability following from the distinction between the one who knows (Selfhood) and what is known (information).

34. The Aporia of the Language of Description of the Absolute Objection: the description of the absolute, in which there are no distinctions, is impossible without the introduction of distinctions by the very act of description. Consequently, the system is self-contradictory at the level of language. Response: this objection presupposes that description must reproduce the structure of what is described. But this requirement is not fulfilled anywhere that limit concepts are at issue. Mathematics works with infinity without reproducing it directly: the concept of infinity is introduced through axioms and rules of inference, which are verified by the internal coherence of the system. This is not empirics in the sense of external experiment but internal verification through the coherence of derivation with the accepted conditions. The external applicability of mathematics is confirmed by its use in physics and other sciences. The present ontology uses the same principle in both parameters. Internal verification: each level is checked for conformity with the initial conditions — the violation of any of them immediately reproduces the aporia. External verification: all philosophical and religious schools without exception reproduce the aporia — the elimination of this aporia in the present system is an externally verifiable result, analogous to the applicability of mathematics. At the same time the conditions of the present ontology are not arbitrary

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axioms, as in mathematics where a choice between different systems is possible. They are derived from the structure of the aporia itself: the aporia sets three and only three logical places for the source of change, from which the three prohibitions and the unique set of conditions of a consistent ontology follow with necessity. This is not a choice but a necessary result of analysis. The language of description in so doing belongs to the dependent category and does not introduce structures into the absolute — just as mathematical symbols do not introduce infinity into reality but fix rules for working with it. At the same time it is necessary to clarify the character of the ontological claim of the present system. Mathematics does not claim to describe reality as such — it works within a formal system. The present ontology claims more, yet its realism is not naive: it does not assert 'this is how being is positively structured' but fixes the limit conditions under which any description of being is possible. This is a transcendental position: not 'being is thus' but 'it cannot be otherwise, if the requirements of absoluteness, singularity, and immutability are accepted as the conditions of the task'. In this respect the analogy with mathematics is valid: both instruments work with limit concepts through rules of inference, and not through direct reproduction of the subject. The claim to reality is thereby retained — but as a claim to conditions of possibility, not to positive content.

35. The Self-Consciousness of Information as a Potential Second Principle Objection: the aim of the programme of initiation is the attainment by information of full self-consciousness. Full self-consciousness means that information fixes itself from within itself, having no blind zones. But this is precisely xRx at its own level — and it is this that distinguishes Selfhood from information. If information at the end of the programme attains xRx, the distinction between the two registers disappears. There remain two principles with the same property — two xRx. This violates singularity. Response: the objection conflates the identity of mode with the identity of ontological status. Selfhood and information differ not only with respect to the presence or absence of xRx but in the nature of existence. Selfhood is primordial, non-temporal, having no history: its xRx did not arise, was not attained, did not pass through realisation. Information is dependent, having passed through the act of initiation and through the whole sequence of distinctions in actuality: its self-consciousness, if attained, is an attained self-consciousness — that is, a state that has a history of realisation. Attained self-consciousness and primordial self-consciousness coincide in form (both are xRx) but differ fundamentally in nature: one precedes all temporality, the other is its outcome. Identity of form does not entail identity of ontological status — just as a logical law and a human being's understanding of that law, arrived at through experience, coincide in content but are not identical in the nature of their existence. The singularity of the ground is not violated: Selfhood remains the sole unconditional principle; information with attained self-consciousness remains a dependent category — its self-consciousness is possible only as the result of the programme set by Selfhood, and does not exist outside this dependence. No second unconditional principle arises.

RESEARCH LIMITATIONS

The present ontology does not claim empirical testability and does not compete with the theories of the natural sciences. The criterion of its validity is not falsification but logical inevitability: any alternative is considered insofar as its acceptance leads to an internal contradiction — either to the violation of the absolute immutability of the ground, or to the introduction of a second principle, or to hidden becoming in Nothing.

Consequently, the distinction between "ontologically necessary" and "accepted within the system" is drawn through the negative proof of the impossibility of alternatives, not through empirical verification.

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The present ontology does not explain the origin of primary distinction but fixes the logical conditions of its admissibility without violation of the absoluteness of the ground.

1. The absolute ground is not susceptible to empirical confirmation

The structure of Nothing is derived logically but cannot be discovered by the means of physical or neuroscientific experiment. Consistency with fundamental physics in the present work is understood not as empirical confirmation of the ontology and not as the derivation of physical laws from ontological principles, but as the absence of logical contradictions between the ontological scheme and recognised physical models of description. Physical concepts are employed in the role of constraints on interpretation and examples of admissibility, but not as a verifying base; therefore the present ontology does not compete with physics in the domain of experimental predictions and metrics.

2. The model does not describe the individual properties of consciousness

It sets only the ontological conditions of the possibility of conscious activity but does not explain the variability of subjective states.

3. Physical processes are treated as manifest forms of information

This limits the application of the model in domains requiring specific numerical descriptions and experimental metrics.

4. Emergent levels depend on the coherence of distinctions

The development of complex forms (reason, systemic interactions) is not guaranteed and depends on the stability of informational configurations.

5. Teleological completion is not a dynamic process

It describes the limit state of structure but does not provide a mechanism of transition to it in empirical systems.

6. The model is not intended for the explanation of cultural, social, or historical processes

It fixes only the ontological conditions within which such processes can exist.

RESEARCH CONTRIBUTION

1. The fundamental aporia has been eliminated

The work shows how the transition from absolute immutability to conditionality can be logically derived without a second principle and without violation of the unconditionality of the ground.

2. The universal structure of distinction has been derived

Distinction is defined as the necessary consequence of the modification of dependent information, which eliminates the former logical ruptures in the explanation of the origin of multiplicity and changes.

3. Ontology has been coordinated with fundamental physics

Collapse, entanglement, the absence of locality, and the manifest structure of matter are interpreted as forms of informational dependencies, not material substances.

4. Consciousness has received a consistent ontological explanation

Consciousness is treated as the organised activity of distinctions, arising upon the attainment of a certain coherence of informational structures.

5. Reason has been explained as an emergent interpretive form

Its appearance is derived logically from the development of distinguished informational states, without the introduction of a new ontological level.

6. A holistic ontological system has been formulated

All levels — from Nothing to teleological completion — are derived sequentially, forming a unified consistent construction.

CONCLUSION

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The study demonstrates that a consistent ontology is possible only upon the recognition of an unconditional ground devoid of internal distinctions and transitions. From this ground there are logically derived: dependent information, change as non-identity identical to the primary givenness of distinction, distinction as the relation between states, measures as parameters of the organisation of differences, and all subsequent levels of conditional structure.
The model obtained offers a logically consistent mode of considering the aporia of the origin of distinctions upon the recognition of an unconditional ground and fixes the conditions of the admissibility of dependent forms. The ontology is related to fundamental physics at the level of the absence of logical contradictions and describes consciousness and reason as forms of organised informational activity without claiming their empirical explanation.
Teleological completion is understood as the limit structural state at which further distinction becomes logically inadmissible, which is identical to the realisation of Selfhood's intention fixed in the act of initiation.
Thus the work forms a complete and consistent ontological description integrating fundamental philosophy, physics, cosmology, emergence, and phenomenology into a unified internally coherent system.

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